Contents

1 The ordered sound-change sequence **8**
1.1 Scope and orientation . . . 8
1.2 Numbering note . . . 8

2 Chapter 1. From Proto-Germanic to Proto-Northwest Germanic **9**
2.1 Historical interval . . . 9
2.2 What this chapter contains . . . 9
2.3 Scope and genealogical context . . . 9
2.4 A note on the rule names . . . 10
2.5 Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x* . . . 10
2.5.1 Historical discussion . . . 10
2.5.2 SC103. Proto-Germanic nasal loss before **x* (`PGmcNasalLossBeforeX`) . . . 10

3 Chapter 2. From Proto-Northwest Germanic to Proto-West Germanic **12**
3.1 Historical interval . . . 12
3.2 Scope and internal diversity . . . 12
3.3 Major changes . . . 12
3.4 A note on source terminology and subgrouping . . . 13
3.5 Rule names . . . 14
3.6 Early Northwest Germanic vowel developments . . . 14
3.7 Root-noun nominative **-z* loss . . . 14
3.7.1 Historical discussion . . . 14
3.7.2 SC096. Root-noun nominative **-z* loss (`RootNounNomZLoss`) . . . 15
3.8 Unstressed ai monophthongization . . . 15
3.8.1 Historical discussion of unstressed **ai* monophthongization . . . 15
3.8.2 SC014. Monophthongization of unstressed **ai* (PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization) . . . 16
3.9 Unstressed **a*-raising before final **m* . . . 16
3.9.1 Historical discussion . . . 16
3.9.2 SC005. Unstressed **a*-raising before final **m* (`PNWGmcAToUBeforeM`) . . . 16
3.10 Northwest Germanic lowering of long *ē* . . . 17
3.10.1 Historical discussion . . . 17
3.10.2 SC024. Lowering of stressed long *ē* (`PNWGmcLongELowering`) . . . 17
3.11 Early i-apocope . . . 18
3.11.1 Historical discussion . . . 18
3.11.2 SC006. Early i-apocope (`PWGmcEarlyIApocope`) . . . 18
3.12 Final **ō*-lowering before **r* . . . 18
3.12.1 Historical discussion . . . 18
3.12.2 SC007. Lowering of final bimoric **ō* before **r* (PWGmcFinalOrLowering) . . . 19
3.13 Coronal-w assimilation . . . 19
3.13.1 Historical discussion . . . 19
3.13.2 SC008. Assimilation of coronal consonants before **w* (PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation) . . . 19
3.14 Inherited short-vowel-plus-geminate-glide reanalysis . . . 20
3.14.1 Historical discussion . . . 20
3.14.2 SC031. Inherited short-Vww reanalysis (`OEWWSimplification`) . . . 20
3.15 *ij*-contraction in *friend* . . . 21
3.15.1 Historical discussion . . . 21
3.15.2 SC009. *ij*-contraction in *friend* (`PWGmcIjContraction`) . . . 21
3.16 West Germanic j-gemination . . . 21
3.16.1 Historical discussion . . . 21
3.16.2 SC010. West Germanic j-gemination (`PWGmcJGemination`) . . . 21
3.17 Syllabic j after final-vowel loss . . . 22
3.17.1 Historical discussion . . . 22
3.17.2 SC011. Syllabic **j* after final-vowel loss (`PWGmcSyllabicJ`) . . . 22

3.18 Simplification of the cluster *xs before a consonant . . . 22
3.18.1 Historical discussion . . . 22
3.18.2 SC028. Simplification of *xs before a consonant (PNWGmcPreconsonantalXLoss) . . . 24
3.19 lþ-voicing . . . 24
3.19.1 Historical discussion . . . 24
3.19.2 SC012. Northern West Germanic lþ-voicing (EAFLThVoicing) . . . 24
3.20 Dental hardening . . . 24
3.20.1 Historical discussion . . . 24
3.20.2 SC013. Dental hardening (PWGmcDentalHardening) . . . 25
3.21 Endingless *aw*: the regular straw branch . . . 25
3.21.1 Historical discussion . . . 25
3.21.2 SC111. Endingless *aw* fragment (PWGmcEndinglessAw) . . . 25
3.22 Consonant-conditioned lowering of stressed short i . . . 25
3.22.1 SC015. Consonant-conditioned lowering of stressed short *i (PNWGmcILowering) . . . 25
3.23 Northwest Germanic u-lowering . . . 30
3.23.1 Historical discussion . . . 30
3.23.2 SC017. Lowering of *u before following non-high vowels (PNWGmcULowering) . . . 31
3.24 Stressed monosyllable *ō-raising . . . 32
3.24.1 Historical discussion . . . 32
3.24.2 SC018. Raising of final stressed monosyllabic *ō (PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableORaising) . . . 32
3.25 Raising of final unstressed long *ō . . . 33
3.25.1 Historical discussion . . . 33
3.25.2 SC019. Raising of final unstressed long *ō (PNWGmcFinalLongORaising) . . . 33

4 Chapter 3. From Proto-West Germanic to Anglo-Frisian 36
4.1 Historical interval . . . 36
4.2 A necessary terminological caution . . . 36
4.3 A worked historical tree test . . . 36
4.4 The working account and why it is used . . . 36
4.5 Long vowels, diphthongs and the ancestral inventory . . . 37
4.6 Alternative cuts and their tree consequences . . . 38
4.7 Palatalization is not a single subgroup character . . . 39
4.8 What the runes date . . . 39
4.9 Major changes and their historical basis . . . 40
4.9.1 West Germanic rhotacism (SC003) . . . 40
4.9.2 Word-final *z deletion (SC020) and the three final-*z developments . . . 40
4.9.3 Completed English ai contraction (SC004, treated in Chapter 4) . . . 40
4.9.4 Anglo-Frisian brightening (SC043, treated in Chapter 4) . . . 41
4.10 Cascade vs. historical order in this chapter . . . 41
4.11 West Germanic final *z-deletion . . . 42
4.11.1 Historical discussion . . . 42
4.11.2 SC020. West Germanic final *z-deletion (EAFFinalZDeletion) . . . 42
4.12 Early apocope in unstressed words . . . 43
4.12.1 Historical discussion . . . 43
4.12.2 SC098. Early apocope in unstressed words (PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope) . . . 44
4.13 Northern monosyllabic final *z-loss . . . 44
4.13.1 Historical discussion . . . 44
4.13.2 SC097. Northern monosyllabic final *z-loss (MonosyllabicFinalZLoss) . . . 45
4.14 Monosyllabic lengthening before final *r* . . . 46
4.14.1 SC112. Stressed monosyllabic lengthening before inherited final *r* (PNWGmcMonosyllabicFinalRLengthening) . . . 46

4.15 West Germanic rhotacism . . . 46
4.15.1 Historical discussion . . . 46
4.15.2 SC003. West Germanic rhotacism (EAFRhotacism) . . . 47
4.16 *mn*-dissimilation . . . 47
4.16.1 Historical discussion . . . 47
4.16.2 SC022. Dissimilation of adjacent *mn* (PNWGmcMnDissimilation) . . . 47
4.17 Word-final *n*-loss . . . 48
4.17.1 Historical discussion . . . 48
4.17.2 SC023. Loss of word-final **n* after **ō* (PNWGmcNStemNLoss) . . . 48
4.18 Nasal-spirant lengthening . . . 48
4.18.1 Historical discussion . . . 48
4.18.2 SC026. North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law, first step (EAFNasalSpirantLengthening) . . . 49
4.19 Nasal-spirant loss . . . 50
4.19.1 SC027. North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law, second step (EAFNasalSpirantLoss) . . . 50
4.20 The hiatus-breaking *w* of the verba pura . . . 50
4.20.1 Historical discussion . . . 50
4.20.2 SC102. Generalized hiatus-breaking *w* after long *ā* (EAFHiatusWInsertion) . . . 51
4.21 North Sea Germanic nasalization of long *ā* before a nasal . . . 51
4.21.1 Historical discussion . . . 51
4.21.2 SC025. Nasalization of long *ā* before nasals (EAFLongANasalRounding) . . . 52
4.22 Anglo-Frisian rounding of the long nasalized low vowel . . . 52
4.22.1 Historical discussion . . . 52
4.22.2 SC104. Rounding of the long nasalized low vowel (EAFNasalizedLowRounding) . . . 53
4.23 North Sea Germanic fronting of long *ā* . . . 53
4.23.1 Historical discussion . . . 53
4.23.2 SC101. Fronting of long *ā* outside nasal and *w* environments (EAFLongAFronting) . . . 54

5 Chapter 4. From Anglo-Frisian to Old English 56
5.1 Historical interval . . . 56
5.2 Scope and dialect variation . . . 56
5.3 Chapter structure . . . 56
5.4 The English partial chains . . . 57
5.5 Early glide history and the English outcome . . . 58
5.6 Ordinary fronting, breaking and restoration . . . 59
5.7 Palatal consonants and the key–day problem . . . 60
5.8 Three different mutation and diphthongization arguments . . . 61
5.9 Quantity, reduction and the written surface . . . 62
5.10 Executable serialization and unresolved interfaces . . . 62
5.11 Sources . . . 62
5.12 Awj resolution and the English brightening of au . . . 63
5.13 Post-velar w-loss and loss of w before final i . . . 63
5.14 I-umlaut and West Saxon palatal diphthongization . . . 63
5.15 English stressed ai contraction . . . 64
5.15.1 Historical discussion . . . 64
5.15.2 SC004. English stressed ai contraction (EAFAiMonophthongization) . . . 64
5.16 Resolution of awj . . . 65
5.16.1 Historical discussion of the resolution of **awj* . . . 65
5.16.2 SC029. Resolution of **awj* to **auj* (OEAwwjResolution) . . . 65
5.17 English brightening of au . . . 66
5.17.1 Historical discussion of the brightening of **au* . . . 66
5.17.2 SC030. Brightening of **au* to **œu* (OEAuBrightening) . . . 66
5.18 Short pre-w diphthongs and the j-created glide chain . . . 67

5.18.1 Historical discussion . . . 67
5.18.2 SC033. J-created palatalized-glide reanalysis (OEEwLongDiphthong) . . . 67
5.19 Technical support: j-created glide compatibility . . . 68
5.19.1 SC106. Retained j-created glide compatibility (OEJWWSimplification) . . . 68
5.20 Technical support: palatalized-glide long-io realization . . . 68
5.20.1 SC110. Palatalized-glide long-io realization (OEJGlideIO) . . . 68
5.21 Quantity-distinct English diphthong realization . . . 68
5.21.1 Historical discussion . . . 68
5.21.2 SC032. Quantity-distinct diphthong realization (OEDiphthongLeveling) . . . 69
5.22 Endingless *aw* and the retained show proxy . . . 69
5.22.1 Historical discussion . . . 69
5.22.2 SC034. Retained show long-diphthong proxy (OEAwLongDiphthong) . . . 70
5.23 Former compound-syncope trace anchor . . . 70
5.23.1 SC037. Former compound-syncope trace anchor (OECompoundLinkingSyncope) . . . 70
5.24 Weak medial vocalism . . . 70
5.24.1 Historical discussion . . . 70
5.24.2 SC036. Weak medial vocalism (OEInterStressRaising) . . . 72
5.24.3 SC036. Light-initial weak raising (OELHWeakRaising) . . . 73
5.25 Combinative u-umlaut in wi-forms . . . 73
5.25.1 Historical discussion . . . 73
5.25.2 SC039. Combinative **u*-umlaut in *wi*-forms (OEWICombinativeUUmlaut) . . . 73
5.25.3 Historical limits of the represented account . . . 73
5.26 Final bare-*a* loss . . . 74
5.26.1 Historical discussion . . . 74
5.26.2 SC041. Loss of final bare **a* (PWGmcFinalBareALoss) . . . 74
5.27 Stem-final n-loss after long i . . . 75
5.27.1 Historical discussion . . . 75
5.27.2 SC064. Loss of stem-final **n* after long **ī* (NWGmcInStemNLoss) . . . 75
5.28 Surviving bimoric **ō* unrounding . . . 76
5.28.1 Historical discussion . . . 76
5.28.2 SC042. Unrounding of the surviving bimoric **ō* (PWGmcSurvivingBimoricOUnrounding) . . . 76
5.29 Technical support: retained unstressed fronting . . . 77
5.29.1 SC107. Retained unstressed contribution (EAFBrighteningUnstressed) . . . 77
5.30 Ordinary English fronting . . . 77
5.30.1 Historical discussion . . . 77
5.30.2 SC043. Fronting of low **a* outside nasal environments (EAFBrightening) . . . 78
5.31 Technical support: retained final-vowel representation . . . 78
5.31.1 SC108. Retained final-vowel representation (EAFBrighteningLongFinal) . . . 78
5.32 Breaking . . . 78
5.32.1 Historical discussion . . . 78
5.32.2 SC044. Breaking before *h*, *rC*, *lC*, and conditioned *w* (OEBreaking) . . . 79
5.32.3 SC044. Stress-sensitive short-i breaking (OEBreakingI) . . . 79
5.33 Velar-fricative palatalization . . . 80
5.33.1 SC045. Palatalization of velar fricatives beside front vowels (OEVelarFricativePalatalization) . . . 80
5.34 A-restoration . . . 80
5.34.1 Historical discussion of A-restoration . . . 80
5.34.2 SC046. Restoration of **a* before following back vowels (OEARestoration) . . . 80
5.35 Heavy-syllable nasal apocope . . . 80
5.35.1 Historical discussion of heavy-syllable nasal loss and secondary nasalization 80

5.35.2 SC047. Heavy-syllable nasal apocope of final *ą (OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope) . . . 81
5.36 Secondary nasalization . . . 81
5.36.1 SC048. Secondary nasalization before final *n (OESecondaryNasalization) . . . 81
5.37 Sievers-law syncope . . . 81
5.37.1 Historical discussion . . . 81
5.37.2 SC050. Sievers-law syncope (SieversLawSyncope) . . . 82
5.38 Palatalization of *sk to *sc . . . 82
5.38.1 Historical discussion . . . 82
5.38.2 SC051. Palatalization of *sk to *sc (OESkPalatalization) . . . 82
5.39 Class-distinct velar palatalization and fricative merger . . . 83
5.39.1 Historical discussion . . . 83
5.39.2 SC052. Singleton-fricative articulation (OEGFricativePalatal) . . . 83
5.39.3 SC052. K articulation and eventual reflex (OEVelarPalatalizationKFront) . . . 84
5.39.4 SC052. Retained stop paths (OEVelarPalatalizationStops) . . . 84
5.39.5 SC052. Combined articulation (OEVelarPalatalization) . . . 85
5.40 Pretonic front-vowel raising . . . 85
5.40.1 Inheritance and accentuation . . . 85
5.40.2 Manuscript distribution . . . 86
5.40.3 Regular reconstruction and prosodic domain . . . 87
5.40.4 SC035. Raising of pretonic *œ after a palatal fricative (OEPrefixAReduction) . . . 88
5.41 Post-velar w-loss . . . 89
5.41.1 SC053. Loss of *w after velars (OEPostVelarWLoss) . . . 89
5.42 West Saxon palatal diphthongization . . . 89
5.42.1 SC056. West Saxon palatal diphthongization (OEWsPalatalDiphthongization) . . . 89
5.43 Old English i-umlaut . . . 90
5.43.1 SC055. Fronting under i-umlaut (OEIUmlautFronting) . . . 90
5.43.2 SC055. Raising under i-umlaut (OEIUmlautRaising) . . . 90
5.43.3 SC055. Diphthongal outcomes under i-umlaut (OEIUmlautDiphthong) . . . 91
5.43.4 SC055. The composite i-umlaut rule (OEIUmlaut) . . . 91
5.44 Noninitial w-loss before unstressed i . . . 92
5.44.1 SC054. Noninitial *w-loss before unstressed *i/ī (OEWLossBeforeI) . . . 92
5.45 Technical support: late palatal diphthongization . . . 92
5.45.1 SC105. Retained late palatal-diphthongization approximation (OELatePalatalDiphthong) . . . 92
5.46 J-cluster coalescence . . . 92
5.46.1 Historical discussion . . . 92
5.46.2 SC057. Coalescence of velar + *j clusters (OEJClusterCoalescence) . . . 93
5.47 Back mutation . . . 93
5.47.1 Historical discussion . . . 93
5.47.2 SC059. Back mutation before labials and liquids (OEBackMutation) . . . 93
5.48 West Saxon palatal umlaut . . . 93
5.48.1 Historical discussion . . . 93
5.48.2 SC060. West Saxon palatal umlaut before *h-clusters (OEWsPalatalUmlaut) . . . 94
5.49 Weak-tail nasal loss . . . 94
5.49.1 Historical discussion . . . 94
5.49.2 SC061. Reduction of final nasal weak-tail endings (OEWeakTailNasalLoss) . . . 94
5.50 Ordinary nonhigh-vowel syncope . . . 94
5.50.1 Historical discussion . . . 94
5.50.2 Compound formation and comparative linking-vowel evidence . . . 95
5.50.3 SC114. Ordinary nonhigh syncope (OENonHighSyn) . . . 97
5.51 B allophony . . . 97

5.51.1 Historical discussion . . . 97
5.51.2 SC049. Distribution of *b after vowels and liquids (PGmcBAllophony) . . . 98
5.52 Early medial realization of unstressed shortening . . . 98
5.52.1 SC117. Medial component of SC072 unstressed shortening (OEMedLongShort) . . . 98
5.53 Quantitative high-vowel deletion . . . 99
5.53.1 Historical discussion . . . 99
5.53.2 SC063. Quantitative deletion of short unstressed high vowels (OEHighVowelApocope) . . . 100
5.54 Former syncope anchor and comparative evidence . . . 100
5.54.1 Historical discussion . . . 100
5.54.2 Independent historical stage controls . . . 101
5.54.3 SC065. Former general-syncope trace anchor (OEMedialSyncope) . . . 101
5.55 Early weak front-vowel unrounding . . . 102
5.55.1 Historical discussion . . . 102
5.55.2 SC115. Early weak-front-vowel unrounding component (OEHighLinkSyncope) . . . 102
5.56 L-adjacent syncope . . . 102
5.56.1 Historical discussion . . . 102
5.56.2 SC066. Later light-syllable pre-*l syncope (OELAdjacentSyncope) . . . 103
5.57 Secondary high-vowel annotation decoding . . . 104
5.57.1 SC116. Technical secondary high-marker decoding (OEHighStressDecode) . . . 104
5.58 Dental assimilation . . . 104
5.58.1 SC067. Dental assimilation in newly formed clusters (OEDentalAssimilation) . . . 104
5.59 Preconsonantal degemination . . . 105
5.59.1 SC068. Preconsonantal degemination before sonorants (OEPreconsonantalDegemination) . . . 105
5.60 Early o-shortening . . . 105
5.60.1 Historical discussion . . . 105
5.60.2 SC069. Early shortening of unstressed *ō before nasals (OEEarlyOShortening) . . . 105
5.61 Early unstressed fronting . . . 106
5.61.1 Historical discussion . . . 106
5.61.2 SC070. Early fronting of unstressed *a (OEUnstressedFrontingEarly) . . . 106
5.62 Late o-shortening . . . 106
5.62.1 SC071. Later shortening of unstressed *ō (OELateOShortening) . . . 106
5.63 Medial raising of shortened unstressed o . . . 107
5.63.1 SC099. Medial raising of shortened unstressed *o (OEMedUnstressedORaising) . . . 107
5.64 Final lowering of shortened unstressed o . . . 107
5.64.1 SC100. Final lowering of shortened unstressed *o (OEFinalUnstressedOLowering) . . . 107
5.65 Unstressed long-vowel shortening . . . 108
5.65.1 Historical discussion . . . 108
5.65.2 SC072. Shortening of unstressed long vowels (OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening) . . . 108
5.66 Unstressed ae-merger . . . 108
5.66.1 SC073. Merger of unstressed *æ with *e (OEUnstressedAEMerger) . . . 108
5.67 Medial weak front-vowel quality changes . . . 109
5.67.1 Historical discussion . . . 109
5.67.2 SC074. First medial unstressed-*i* lowering (OEMedUnstressedILowering1) . . . 110
5.68 Preservation of i before ng . . . 110

5.68.1 SC075. Preservation of medial unstressed **i* before **ng* (OEMedUnstressedILowering) . . . 110
5.69 Medial unstressed-u lowering . . . 110
5.69.1 SC040. Lowering of medial unstressed **u* (OEMedUnstressedULowering) . . . 110
5.70 Pretonic i-lowering . . . 112
5.70.1 Historical discussion . . . 112
5.70.2 SC076. Pretonic i-lowering (`OEPrefixIReduction`) . . . 112
5.71 Weak-tail reduction . . . 112
5.71.1 Historical discussion . . . 112
5.71.2 SC078. Reduction of remaining weak-tail vowels (OEWeakTailReduction) . . . 112
5.72 J-loss after heavy syllables . . . 113
5.72.1 Historical discussion . . . 113
5.72.2 SC079. Loss of **j* after heavy syllables (`OEJLossAfterHeavy`) . . . 113
5.73 Final geminate simplification . . . 113
5.73.1 SC080. Simplification of final geminates (OEFinalGeminateSimplification) . . . 113
5.74 J-strengthening after front diphthongs . . . 114
5.74.1 Historical discussion . . . 114
5.74.2 SC081. Strengthening of **j* after front diphthongs (OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong) . . . 114
5.75 Intervocalic j-vocalization . . . 114
5.75.1 SC082. Bounded inherited-j normalization (OEIntervocalicJVocalization) . . . 114
5.76 Unstressed ei-contraction . . . 115
5.76.1 SC083. Contraction of unstressed *ei* (`OEUnstressedEIContraction`) . . . 115
5.77 Intervocalic h-loss . . . 115
5.77.1 Historical discussion . . . 115
5.77.2 SC085. Loss of intervocalic **h* (`OEHLoss`) . . . 116
5.78 Contraction after h-loss . . . 116
5.78.1 SC086. Contraction of the resulting hiatus (`OEContraction`) . . . 116
5.79 R-metathesis . . . 117
5.79.1 Historical discussion . . . 117
5.79.2 SC087. Metathesis of **r* with a following short vowel (OERMetathesis) . . . 118
5.80 Late unstressed suffix raising . . . 118
5.80.1 Historical discussion . . . 118
5.80.2 SC089. Late suffix consumer (`OELateUnstressedAgSuffix`) . . . 119
5.81 Technical support: postmutation fricative merger . . . 119
5.81.1 SC109. Postmutation merger serialization (OEPalatalFricativeMerger) . . . 119

6 Chapter 5. Old English orthography and the written surface 120
6.1 Historical interval . . . 120
6.2 Scope . . . 120
6.3 Sources . . . 120
6.4 West Saxon palatal-glide spelling before back vowels . . . 120
6.4.1 Historical discussion . . . 120
6.4.2 SC016. West Saxon palatal-glide spelling before back vowels (OEWsPalatalGlide) . . . 121

7 References 122

1 The ordered sound-change sequence

1.1 Scope and orientation

The sequence follows the executable reconstruction from its early Germanic developments through the Old English written surface.

Rhotacism, brightening, breaking, umlaut, and apocope alternate with narrowly conditioned changes whose relative order rests on particular witness words.

The evidence ranges from broadly attested sound laws to lexical constraints that establish only one chronological boundary.

1.2 Numbering note

SC numbers remain stable legacy identifiers, not chronological positions. Each published entry has one authoritative source. The book automatically follows the individual stages of the canonical executable reconstruction; neither filenames nor chapter membership can override that order.

This is the order adopted by the executable reconstruction, not a claim that every pairwise historical chronology has been independently proved. Adjudication records distinguish demonstrated chronology, stage-entailed relations and computational serialization. Chapter boundaries and titles remain editorial; they divide the sequence without rearranging its entries.

Explicitly retained technical explanations are published at their executable positions without becoming adjudicated historical sound laws.

SC038, SC062, and SC084 mark technical or prosodic stages rather than sound changes; SC113 annotates stress-foot context and is not a published law. SC077 is unused.

2 Chapter 1. From Proto-Germanic to Proto-Northwest Germanic

2.1 Historical interval

This chapter covers developments that took place within the Proto-Germanic period, from the inherited consonant system to the first changes that separate the Northwest Germanic line from the rest of the Germanic family.

The reconstruction labelled Proto-Germanic here is the common ancestor of Gothic, North Germanic, and West Germanic, reconstructed through the classical comparative method from attested descendant languages. The label Proto-Northwest Germanic designates the hypothetical node linking the ancestors of North Germanic (Old Norse and its relatives) and West Germanic (Old English, Old High German, Old Saxon, and Old Frisian among others), to the exclusion of Gothic and the other East Germanic varieties.

2.2 What this chapter contains

Chapter 1 contains one reader-facing sound-change section: the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x* (`SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX`), with compensatory lengthening and nasalization of the preceding vowel. Its results are shared by every daughter language, Gothic included, so the change belongs to Proto-Germanic itself and precedes every Northwest Germanic and West Germanic development treated in the chapters that follow (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7).

Another historically Proto-Germanic rule, the positional allophony of Proto-Germanic **b* (`SC049 PGmcBAllophony`), executes late in the computational cascade because the alternation interacts with environments shaped by intermediate rule applications; its section therefore appears in Chapter 4, where the divergence between cascade placement and historical stage is noted explicitly.

One other historically Proto-Germanic change, Gm-simplification (`SC002 PGmcGmSimplification`), is documented in the book-entry plan and its literature dossier confirms the source base is narrow (two lexical families: **draugma-* 'dream' and **taugma-* 'team'; (Kroonen 2013, 101, 511)). A reader-facing section for SC002 awaits a stronger explanatory source base and is not yet assembled in the reader-facing sequence.

A generative counterpart to the handbook accounts is Barrack's formal cascade from Proto-Germanic to West Saxon, which states the nasal-loss development as its Proto-Germanic rule 119 (Barrack 1975, 42–43). Barrack's rule numbers are anchors to Campbell's paragraph numbering, which he names as his principal data source (Barrack 1975, 21), and his ordering statements are formal, not chronological: ordering between rules "only implies a logical relationship—in no sense a chronological relationship" (Barrack 1975, 34). His cascade therefore corroborates the handbook conditioning for this change without constituting independent dating evidence, and it keeps the Proto-Germanic law distinct from the later Ingvaeonic nasal-spirant development, which he states separately as rule 121 (Barrack 1975, 44).

2.3 Scope and genealogical context

Changes in this chapter are pan-Germanic in scope: they apply to ancestral forms that feed both the North Germanic and West Germanic descendants, or they represent internal Proto-Germanic processes visible across the Germanic family.

The boundary between Proto-Germanic and Proto-Northwest Germanic is not sharp in the textbook literature. Ringe and Taylor treat many of the traditionally "Proto-Germanic" changes as part of a shared innovation package that is diagnostically older than North–West Germanic divergence but not necessarily earlier than the separation of the East Germanic line (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 1–30). For book purposes, the distinction matters primarily because it separates the features inherited uniformly from all Germanic from those shared selectively by North and West Germanic to the exclusion of Gothic.

2.4 A note on the rule names

The CAPR rules implemented in this chapter carry names beginning with `PGmc`. Those names are intended as stable internal identifiers, not as claims about the precise historical stage of every rule so labelled. A rule named `PGmcX` may in some cases be a later development that affects only the West Germanic or Northwest Germanic branch. Each entry's source-supported historical analysis takes priority over both its identifier and its chapter placement; the latter follows executable order, not an independent historical-stage map.

2.5 Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x*

2.5.1 Historical discussion

The oldest change treated in this book is common to the whole family. In the group **-nx-* the nasal consonant was lost, the preceding vowel was lengthened in compensation, and that lengthened vowel was nasalized. Its results are shared by every daughter language: Gothic *þeihan* 'thrive', *brāhta* 'brought', *þūhta* 'seemed' stand beside Old High German *dīhan* 'thrive', *brāhta, fūht* 'damp' and Old English *þēon* 'thrive', *brōhte* 'brought', *þūhte* 'seemed', *fūht* 'damp' (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7). Because no daughter keeps the nasal, the change belongs to Proto-Germanic itself, and it precedes every Northwest Germanic, West Germanic, North Sea Germanic and Anglo-Frisian development described in the chapters that follow.

Only **a*, **i* and **u* occur in this position. Germanic had already raised **e* to **i* and **o* to **u* before a nasal followed by a consonant, so the mid vowels are absent from the input (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1).

The vowel that the change creates is long and nasalized, and it is not yet rounded. Fulk emphasizes that the lengthened vowels remained nasalized for a considerable time, well past the close of the Northwest Germanic period, since the nasalized low vowel produced in this way went on to develop to *ō* in Anglo-Frisian and did not fall together with the Old English *ā* that came from **ai* (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1). The comparative material makes the same point directly: Gothic, Old Norse, Old High German and Old Saxon all reflect the Proto-Germanic nasalized low vowel as unrounded *ā*, and only Old English and Old Frisian show *ō* (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). Ringe describes Proto-Germanic **hanhaną* as **[xą̄xaną]* and observes that its low vowel was rounded, along with the other nasalized low vowels, in the northernmost West Germanic dialects (Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7). That rounding is a separate and much later change, and it is treated in the chapter on the rounding of the long nasalized low vowel.

Barrack's formal cascade states this development as his Proto-Germanic rule 119 (Barrack 1975, 42–43) and, in agreement with the comparative argument above, keeps it distinct from the later North Sea law, which he states separately as Ingvaeonic rule 121 and explicitly orders after 119 (Barrack 1975, 44). His rule numbers are anchors to Campbell's paragraph numbering (Barrack 1975, 21), and his orderings are formal rather than chronological (Barrack 1975, 34), so the agreement concerns the identity and conditioning of the two laws, not an independent dating.

2.5.2 SC103. Proto-Germanic nasal loss before **x* (`PGmcNasalLossBeforeX`)

```
define PGmcNasalLossBeforeX Ctx([
    [
    {*a} -> {*ã} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},
    {*i} -> {*ī} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},
    {*u} -> {*ū} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},
    {*á} -> {*ã} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},
    {*í} -> {*ī} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},
    {*ú} -> {*ū} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x}
] .o. [
    EnglishStarNasal -> 0 || _ {*x}
]
]);
```

The rule performs the three parts of the change together: it lengthens the vowel, it marks the lengthened low vowel as nasalized, and it then removes the conditioning nasal. The low vowel is written **ą̄* and the high vowels are written **ī* and **ū*, because the nasality of the high vowels has no further consequence: they go on to develop exactly as the inherited long **ī* and **ū* do (Campbell 1959, 47, §121). The nasality of the low vowel is carried forward because its later fate depends on it. In the executable definitions, ã is the single-symbol encoding of long nasalized **ą̄*, not a different or short vowel. The historical notation in the discussion retains its explicit length mark.

The corpus witnesses both branches of the rule. The high branch is **fúnxstiz* 'fist', which becomes **fūxsti* 'fist' and, after the loss of **x* before the cluster in SC028 PNWGmcPreconsonantalXLoss, gives Old English *fȳst* 'fist'. The long vowel of Old High German *fūst* 'fist', Dutch *vuist* and German *Faust* shows that the word belongs here and to no later law (Kroonen 2013, 160). The rule also supplies the **xst* cluster on which the loss of **x* before a consonant operates, so the two stand in a feeding relation.

The low branch is **θánxtē* 'thought', the preterite of the verb 'to think', whose principal parts are reconstructed as **þankijanǫ* 'to think', **þanhtē* 'thought', **þanhtaz* 'thought (past participle)' with the nasal still standing before the fricative (Ringe 2017, 281; 2017, 136). Here the rule yields **θą̄xtē* 'thought', and the nasalized low vowel is later rounded by SC104 EAFNasalizedLowRounding to give Old English *þōhte* 'thought'. This is the form the handbooks themselves cite for the Anglo-Frisian rounding of the vowel produced here (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1). It does not enter the loss of **x* before a consonant, in which respect it differs from 'fist', so the fricative survives to the surface and the word displays the vowel history alone.

3 Chapter 2. From Proto-Northwest Germanic to Proto-West Germanic

3.1 Historical interval

This chapter covers the sound changes that took place in the proto-language shared by the West Germanic languages — Old English, Old Frisian, Old Saxon, Old High German, and Old Dutch — before the individual languages diverged. The starting reconstruction is Proto-Northwest Germanic (PNWGmc), the hypothetical common ancestor of North Germanic and West Germanic together; the ending reconstruction is Proto-West Germanic (PWGmc), the immediate common ancestor of the West Germanic languages specifically.

3.2 Scope and internal diversity

Changes in this chapter are not all equally pan-West-Germanic in scope. They may be grouped broadly as follows:

Northwest Germanic innovations (shared by both North and West Germanic): innovations in the unstressed vowel system, certain final-syllable vowel changes, and selected consonant cluster simplifications. Their historical scope must be established from comparative evidence, not from executable identifiers.

Proto-West-Germanic innovations (shared within West Germanic but not in North Germanic): the cluster of morphological and phonological changes that distinguish Old English, Old High German, Old Saxon, and Old Frisian from Old Norse. They include early apocope rules, certain consonant assimilations, and the West Germanic gemination of consonants before `*j`.

3.3 Major changes

The chapter opens with the root-noun nominative `*-z` loss (SC096), the generalization of ending-less nominatives through the athematic consonant stems, complete before Proto-West Germanic: none of the West Germanic daughters shows any ending in this class (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118). It is the earliest of the three historically distinct final-`*z` developments; the other two (SC020 and SC097) open Chapter 3.

Barrack's formal cascade covers the same final-syllable territory with a family of rules keyed to Campbell's paragraphs: rhotacism and the loss and retention of final **z* appear as rules 404a–e (Barrack 1975, 101–2), and the final-syllable reductions as the 331 series, including final **a* syncope as West Germanic rule 331.4b (Barrack 1975, 78). He grades the evidence candidly — the material for 404b, which deletes the rhotic before a voiced dental with compensatory lengthening to derive *mēd* 'reward', he calls "very sporadic", and he refers the rival development that yields *meord* to his rule 139zc (Barrack 1975, 101–2) — and his orderings among these rules are formal rather than chronological (Barrack 1975, 34). The crosswalk in the Barrack dossier records where these statements agree with, and where they subdivide differently from, the SC096/SC020/SC097 split adopted here.

The unstressed **ai* > **ē* development (SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization) is one of the widespread Northwest Germanic vowel shifts. Unstressed dative-singular and strong-adjective plural endings provide examples of monophthongization and merger with inherited unstressed **ē*. Ringe and Taylor distinguish this broad correspondence from the more questionable claim of a single completed Proto-Northwest Germanic event (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 25–26). The stressed monophthongization is treated separately under SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization.

The later SC015 PNWGmcILowering concerns stressed first-syllable **i*, not further unstressed-vowel reduction. Its following-vowel hypothesis has traditional authority, but its comparative regularity and precise consonantal conditioning remain disputed. The section compares vowel-conditioned and consonant-conditioned accounts and explains the provisional restrictions of the current implementation (Campbell 1959, 43, §§114–116; Fulk 2018, 56–57; Hill 2017, 149–58).

The West Germanic consonant changes of this chapter — j-gemination (SC010), early i-apocope (SC006), coronal-w assimilation (SC008), and related rules — represent the most productive phonological territory for the CAPR derivations. They feed a large proportion of the distinctive consonant clusters of Old English. Handbooks vary in exactly how they group and name these changes (Campbell 1959, sects 404, 406; Hogg 1992a, 71, §4.11 (held 2011 reissue)).

Coronal assimilation also supplies the geminate in *fēower* 'four' and *ēow* 'you', before inherited short-vowel-plus-geminate-glide reanalysis. SC031 OEWWSimplification now represents that earlier development, not an unrestricted late deletion. The resulting diphthong-plus-glide sequence is inherited by later English realization; j-created and singleton paths remain distinct (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66; Campbell 1959, 45–47).

The quoted definitions use `Ctx(...)` to carry selected sentence context outside the segmental operation. It is computational transport, not a reconstructed segment or an additional sound law. Lexical accent, sentence stress and phonological-word finality are separate: the early high-vowel-loss account requires a heavy syllable in a sentence-unstressed, phonologically final word, not simply the absence of an acute. Ordinary evaluation selects strong-final citation context; the explicit weak-final selection for *ēow* is discussed with SC098 PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 55, 57–58).

The nasal spirant corridor (SC026–SC027), treated in Chapter 3 at its cascade position, illustrates a type of change common in historical grammars of the "Ingvaeonic" or "North Sea Germanic" area: nasals disappear before voiceless fricatives, with compensatory vowel lengthening (Campbell 1959, sects 462–463; Hogg 1992a, 56, §3.14 (held 2011 reissue)). The CAPR model splits this into two ordered steps to make the vowel effect computationally tractable; the book prose explains that split against the handbook tradition, which typically presents the change as a single process.

Chapters in this part of the book follow the executable reconstruction's adopted serialization, not an independently demonstrated total historical chronology. Several rules that carry `PWGmc` labels — final bare-`*a` loss (SC041), surviving bimoric `*ō` unrounding (SC042), and Sievers-law syncope (SC050) — execute later in the cascade and are therefore presented in Chapter 4, where their individual sections discuss their historical stage labels. Conversely, one rule with a West Saxon label, the palatal-glide rule (SC016), is an orthographic rule of the written surface: it executes after the Old English orthography stage and is presented in Chapter 5.

3.4 A note on source terminology and subgrouping

The literature uses several partly overlapping stage labels for this period:

- Northwest Germanic: the node uniting North and West Germanic.
- Proto-West Germanic: the node uniting only the West Germanic languages.
- North Sea Germanic or Ingvaeonic: a proposed subgroup within West Germanic covering Old English, Old Frisian, and Old Saxon (and sometimes Old Low Franconian), sharing certain innovations over a broader area.
- Anglo-Frisian: a narrower proposed subgroup linking only Old English and Old Frisian.

These labels are not always used consistently across sources. Ringe and Taylor are cautious about reconstructing a discrete Proto-West-Germanic node (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 50–55). Campbell notes that many of the "West Germanic" shared features could alternatively be treated as parallel developments rather than common inheritance (Campbell 1959, sects 1–5).

CAPR uses `PWGmc` and `NWGmc` as organizing labels for this chapter without claiming to have settled all questions about West Germanic subgrouping. Changes that appear in the literature under "Ingvaeonic" labels but affect the Old English–to-Proto-Germanic derivation chain are treated here as late expressions of the same West Germanic developmental period unless existing CAPR dossier research specifically argues for Anglo-Frisian or English-specific placement.

3.5 Rule names

Most CAPR rules in this chapter carry names beginning with `NWGmc` or `PWGmc`; the reformulated inherited-glide rule retains its older `OE` identifier. These names are stable internal identifiers. A name beginning with `NWGmc` does not guarantee that the change is exclusive to Northwest Germanic, and a name beginning with `PWGmc` does not guarantee that it is absent from North Germanic. The historical analysis in each sound-change section takes priority over the name prefix.

3.6 Early Northwest Germanic vowel developments

These two developments affect different parts of the vowel system. SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAi-Monophthongization monophthongizes unstressed **ai*; SC015 PNWGmcILowering represents the disputed lowering of stressed short **i*. This thematic comparison does not make their separated rule sections adjacent or identify them as successive stages of unstressed-vowel reduction.

3.7 Root-noun nominative **-z* loss

3.7.1 Historical discussion

The athematic consonant stems — the "root nouns" of the handbooks — attached the nominative-singular marker directly to a consonant-final root, and the Proto-Germanic outcome of that collision is genuinely uncertain. Ringe gives the consonant-stem nominative ending as zero, **-z*, or possibly **-s*, and states plainly that the distribution is unrecoverable for monosyllabic stems (Ringe 2017, 306, §4.3.4). His own paradigm tables carry the uncertainty into print: the nominative of 'foot' appears as "fōts? (fōs?)", while 'mouse' is plain **mūs*, its expected extra sibilant already absorbed by degemination (Ringe 2017, 149, 313). Ringe and Taylor repeat the same three-way agnosticism — the root-noun nominative "either ended in **-s* or **-z*, or was endingless" (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 28, §2.3.1).

The dictionary traditions encode this situation in different notations, and the differences are conventions of citation rather than competing claims of fact. Orel prints morphologically explicit nominatives with final *-z* across the whole class: **bōkz* 'book', **gansz* 'goose', **lūsz* 'louse' (Orel 2003, 52, 126, 252). Kroonen cites the same words as bare stems or endingless forms, **bōk-* and **gans-* (Kroonen 2013, 71–72, 168–69), and Kluge/Seebold print a third variant with voiceless *-s*, as in **bōks* 'Buch' (Kluge 2011, 158). Bammesberger shows why the marker is nonetheless real: for voiced-final stems the overt nominative **-z* is positively reconstructible — **burgz* (Gothic *baúrgs*), **frijōndz* (Gothic *frijonds*) — even though **fōt-z* is "phonotaktisch kaum denkbar", and in West Germanic the ending simply "fiel es ab" (Bammesberger 1990, 190–92, §8.2.3.1). CAPR retains Orel's morphologically explicit forms as its inputs precisely because they record the inflectional marker whose fate this rule describes.

The three focal words are only superficially parallel. The root-final *s* of 'louse' is itself an extension of **luw-* on the model of 'mouse' (Bammesberger 1990, 195, §8.3). For 'goose', Szemerényi's lengthening would give a Proto-Indo-European nominative **ǵʰanss* > **ǵʰān*, after which the Proto-Germanic nominative was rebuilt with a final voiced sibilant, **ganz*, reanalyzed within the paradigm (Bammesberger 1990, 196, §8.3; Kroonen 2013, 168–69). 'Book' preserves a plain obstruent-final root. What unites them is not a single phonetic history but membership in a paradigm class that generalized the endingless nominative.

The branch evidence dates and localizes that generalization. Gothic keeps its sibilant throughout the class (*baúrgs*, *nahts*, *reiks*) (Fulk 2018, 165–66, §§7.26–7.27). Old Norse redistributes the ending morphologically: masculine root nouns keep *-r* (*fótr*), feminines are endingless (*nótt*, *geit*), while the vocalic-stem feminines *kýr*, *sýr*, *ær* retain *-r* from **-z* with R-umlaut (Fulk 2018, 167, §7.28; Bammesberger 1990, 192–93). West Germanic alone is uniform: there was "no ending in PWGmc, as none of the daughters exhibits any" (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118, §3.4). Fulk supplies the mechanism: Szemerényi's law removed the nominative sibilant after sonorant-final stems, and endinglessness then spread analogically through the class (Fulk 2018, 143, §7.2). The development is therefore best understood as a morphological generalization enacted differently in each

branch — absolute in West Germanic, consonant- and gender-conditioned in North Germanic, absent in Gothic — rather than as one exceptionless sound law.

This change is distinct from the two later final-*z developments. It was complete before Proto-West Germanic, whereas the loss of *-z in unstressed syllables (SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion) is itself a Proto-West Germanic change: polysyllabic consonant-stem nominatives such as *fadurz 'father' — and, in this corpus, *frijōndz 'friend', *melukz 'milk', and *mēnōþz 'month' — kept their ending into Proto-West Germanic and lost it there in an unstressed syllable (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). The still later northern loss of *-z in stressed monosyllables (SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss) affects vowel-final monosyllables like *hwaz and does not touch the consonant-final root nouns at all, whose ending was gone long before.

3.7.2 SC096. Root-noun nominative *-z loss (`RootNounNomZLoss`)

```
define RootNounNomZLoss Ctx([
    [{*z} -> 0 || .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]*
    ↪  EnglishStarVocalic+ [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _
    ↪  .#.]
]);
```

The rule deletes word-final *z after a consonant in a monosyllable. Three claims of different kinds meet here and must be kept apart. The historical claim is morphological: the nominative-singular ending was lost in the athematic root-noun class, so that this one paradigm cell came to lack its marker — a development complete before Proto-West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118, §3.4). The lexical claim belongs to the dictionaries: Orel's citation forms, which supply the corpus inputs, print that marker explicitly as *-z* in *bōkz, *flauxz, *gansz, and *lūsz (Orel 2003, 52, 105, 126, 252). The executable statement is neither of these but a computational proxy for them: 'delete word-final *z after a consonant in a monosyllable'. It is not proposed as a Proto-Germanic sound law; it earns its place only because every form the corpus submits to the morphological development is a consonant-final monosyllable, so the narrow phonological statement covers the class exactly. Four corpus derivations witness the rule, each yielding its expected Old English outcome: PGmc *bōkz 'book' yields OE bōc 'book', *gánsz 'goose' yields gōs 'goose', *lūsz 'louse' yields lūs 'louse', and *fláuxz 'flea' yields flēah 'flea'. Should the corpus ever acquire a consonant-final monosyllable in *-z that is not a root-noun nominative, the proxy and the morphology would come apart, and the rule would need to be re-scoped; the project's regression tests pin the firing population to exactly these four words so that any fifth firing forces that adjudication rather than passing silently.

The rule applies at the head of the English line, before SC009 PWGmcIjContraction. That ordering is fixed by the identity of the process rather than by a wrong form: contraction turns the polysyllabic *frí́jōndz 'friend' into a monosyllable, and if the root-noun rule applied after contraction it would capture *friundz — yet the ending of 'friend' survived into Proto-West Germanic and fell in an unstressed syllable, the change described under SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Because both rules delete the same segment, moving this rule later changes no Old English output; the early placement keeps the derivation of 'friend' aligned with the historical account rather than with an accident of the cascade.

Negative controls behave as the morphology predicts. Stressed monosyllables whose *z follows a vowel — the domain of the later northern change — do not meet the post-consonantal environment. Medial *z is untouched and remains available for rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism): PGmc *déuzą 'deer' still yields OE dēor 'deer' with its rhotacized medial consonant.

3.8 Unstressed ai monophthongization

3.8.1 Historical discussion of unstressed *ai monophthongization

Ringe and Taylor describe the widespread monophthongization of unstressed *ai to a long mid vowel, largely merging with inherited unstressed *ē. Their examples include final dative-singular and nonfinal inflectional syllables. They nevertheless question a single completed

Proto-Northwest Germanic merger: Runic evidence suggests that some unstressed diphthongs survived later than others (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 25–26). The stressed development of **ái* to **ā* is treated separately as SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization.

3.8.2 SC014. Monophthongization of unstressed **ai* (PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization)

```
define PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization Ctx([
    [
    {*ai} -> {*ē}
]
]);
```

The dative-singular endings span **spánnai* ‘span’ and meed **mízdai* ‘meed’ carry this change; both give a final **ē*. If SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization is delayed until after SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, the **ē* is no longer present for shortening, so PGmc **spánnai* ‘span’ yields †*spannē* rather than expected OE *spanne* ‘span’. This shows that SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization must come before SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening in the modeled sequence.

3.9 Unstressed **a*-raising before final **m*

3.9.1 Historical discussion

Campbell notes that unstressed *u* is especially well preserved before *m*, with dat.pl. *-um* and related endings as the clearest evidence (Campbell 1959, 156, §373). Fulk likewise includes the development of early unstressed **o* to *u* before *m* among the similarities shared by North and West Germanic (Fulk 2018, 16, §5.2).

I restrict the change to unstressed vowels in inflectional material because the strongest evidence concerns noninitial unstressed material before final **m*. Final **m* conditions the raising.

3.9.2 SC005. Unstressed **a*-raising before final **m* (PNWGmcAToUBeforeM)

```
define PNWGmcAToUBeforeM Ctx([
    [
    {*a} -> {*u} || EnglishStarVocalic EnglishStarConsonant+ _ {*m} ({*i})?
     ↪  ({*z})? .#.
]
]);
```

Here the witness word and the comparative evidence serve different purposes. If raising is delayed until after SC017 PNWGmcULowering, PGmc **skúldramiz* ‘shoulders’ yields †*sċoldrum* rather than expected OE *sċuldrum* ‘shoulders’; earlier placements converge on the expected output. The scope of the change is established by inflectional evidence across multiple paradigm types: a-stem dative plural ON *dǫgum* ‘days’, OE *dagum* ‘days’, OS *dagun* ‘days’, OHG *tagum* ‘days’, beside Gothic *dagam* ‘days’; strong-adjective dative singular ON *góðum* ‘good’, OE *gōdum* ‘good’, OS *gōdum* ‘good’, beside Gothic *godamma* ‘good’ (OS also shows variant forms gōdumu and -un); and first-plural present ON *berum* ‘we carry’, OHG *berumēs* ‘we carry’, beside Gothic *baíram* ‘we carry’. Across these sets, North/West Germanic shows unstressed *-um* where Gothic preserves *-am*. The derivation of *sċuldrum* ‘shoulders’ supplies a CAPR ordering witness for the relative chronology, but the cognate set for ‘shoulder’ does not contribute comparative evidence for the rule’s historical scope.

3.10 Northwest Germanic lowering of long *ē*

3.10.1 Historical discussion

Proto-Germanic **ē₁* (the long mid vowel of PIE origin, as against the later **ē₂*) split East Germanic from the rest of the family. Gothic keeps a mid vowel, written ⟨e⟩, in *gadēþs* ‘deed’, *slēpan* ‘to sleep’, *mēna* ‘moon’, and *jēr* ‘year’, while Norse and all of West Germanic show a low vowel, as in Old Norse *ráða* ‘to consider, to advise’, *láta* ‘to let go, to allow’, *ár* ‘year’, *nál* ‘needle’, Old High German *tāt* ‘deed’, *slāfan* ‘to sleep’, *jār* ‘year’, *māno* ‘moon’, Old Saxon *dād* ‘deed’, *slāpan* ‘to sleep’, *jār*. Ringe and Taylor assemble the comparative set and reconstruct a Northwest Germanic sound change **ē₁* > **ā* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 11–13). The change is directly dated by the earliest epigraphy. The Early Runic accusative *mākija* ‘sword’ (beside Gothic *mēkeis* ‘sword’) already shows ⟨a⟩ in the second half of the second century AD (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 12), and the a-rune likewise writes the stressed reflex in the Opedal stone’s *swestar* ‘sister’ (Stiles 2017, 4). Loanwords borrowed into Sami from early Proto-Scandinavian point the same way. Lid showed that the root vowel of Sami *mānno* ‘moon’, Proto-Germanic **ē* as in Gothic *mēna*, “had gone over to *ā* before the word was borrowed into Sami”, and adduced the parallel Sami *saððo* ‘bran’ beside Proto-Nordic **sāðō* from **sēðō-*, Old Norse *sáð* ‘bran’ (Lid 1952, 238). This is Sami borrowing from Proto-Scandinavian, so it dates and localizes the *ā* stage in the North; its application to West Germanic rests on the daughter correspondences above.

The change affected stressed syllables only. Ringe and Taylor restrict it explicitly: unstressed **ē* did not lower but was eventually shortened, as in **fadēr* > **fader* ‘father’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 13, and p. 147); in the runic material the unstressed final vowel of *faþiR* ‘father’ has already merged with **-i* (Stiles 2017, 4). Within stressed syllables, however, the lowering was unconditioned: it applied before nasals exactly as elsewhere, and Ringe and Taylor accordingly print the intermediates **mānō* ‘moon’, **mānōþ-* ‘month’, and **spānuz* ‘spoon’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 11). The later, dialectally narrower fates of this **ā* — fronting in the North Sea area when oral, rounding when nasalized — are separate sound changes treated in their own chapters.

The reconstruction of the intermediate value is disputed. The objection is an old one: Bennett observed that the received account obliges Gothic to move *ē* to *ǣ* and back to *ē*, and the non-West-Saxon dialects and Old Frisian to run through *ē* > *ǣ* > *ā* > *ǣ* > *ē*, “with no apparent agreement among the languages and no discernible phonological trend”, and that the Proto-Germanic *ǣ* is on that account preserved directly nowhere (Bennett 1950, 232–33, 235). In its place he proposed that the backing to *ā* began in the north of the Germanic homeland and spread southward, never reaching Gothic in the east or Anglian and Frisian in the west, so that West Saxon *ǣ* is a retention of the intermediate stage rather than a re-fronting (Bennett 1950, 234–35). Fulk argues in the same direction on modern evidence: the Northwest Germanic vowel was a low front **ǣ*, retained unchanged in Anglo-Frisian, with the backing to *ā* of Norse and inner West Germanic a separate areal development spreading northward from Upper German territory; on that reading the runic ⟨a⟩ spellings write a front [æː] for which the futhark had no better grapheme (Fulk 2018, 60–61, §4.6). Campbell is deliberately noncommittal, finding the **ā* stage “tempting to assume, though not definitely demonstrable” (Campbell 1959, 50–51, §§128–129). Ringe and Taylor answer with the lengthened place-adverbs *þǣr* ‘there’ and *hwǣr* ‘where’, whose front vowels are most naturally the output of fronting applied to a back **ā* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 13–14). The present model adopts the two-step reconstruction while recording that the alternative remains live.

3.10.2 SC024. Lowering of stressed long *ē* (`PNWGmcLongELowering`)

```
define PNWGmcLongELowering Ctx([
    [
    {*é} -> {*ā}
]
]);
```

The rule reads the stressed tier **é* only, in keeping with the stress restriction; unstressed **ē*, as in **fadēr* ‘father’, is left for the unstressed-shortening rules of the Old English stage and never lowers. No segmental environment is imposed: nasal forms such as **mḗnōþz* ‘month’ and

spénuz ‘spoon’ pass through **mānōþ-* and **spānuz* on their way to *mōnaþ* ‘month’ and *spōn* ‘spoon’, exactly as reconstructed by Ringe and Taylor (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 11).

The rule stands near the head of the cascade, before the genuinely West Germanic innovations such as early *i*-apocope, **ij*-contraction, and *j*-gemination — the placement follows from the dating: the second-century runic evidence puts the lowering among the earliest Northwest Germanic developments, well before the changes that separate West Germanic from Norse. Its output **ā* is consumed much later in the cascade by SC102 EAFHiatusWInsertion, SC025 EAFLongANasalRounding, and SC101 EAFLongAFronting: if the lowering is instead displaced after those rules, **mḗnōθz* ‘month’ yields †*mānaþ* rather than OE *mōnaþ* ‘month’, **skḗpą* ‘sheep’ yields †*sċāp* rather than *sċēap* ‘sheep’, and **sḗaną* ‘to sow’ never acquires the hiatus-filling *w* of *sāwan* ‘to sow’. Within the cascade no earlier boundary has been demonstrated; the second-century runic attestation supplies the absolute dating.

3.11 Early i-apocope

3.11.1 Historical discussion

Sievers/Brunner treats the early loss of final **i* after unstressed syllables as established by the fact that these endings no longer trigger later i-umlaut in Old English, and Ringe and Taylor make the same point through the pathway to *geoguþ* ‘youth’ (Brunner 1965, sects 145–146; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 141). Campbell’s *dugup* ‘troop’ and *geogup* ‘youth’ examples belong to the same pattern (Campbell 1959, sect. 332).

The ending vowel disappears in a weak suffixal environment early enough to block later umlaut. This anti-umlaut chronology distinguishes the change from later final-vowel losses.

3.11.2 SC006. Early i-apocope (`PWGmcEarlyIApocope`)

```
define PWGmcEarlyIApocope Ctx([
    [
    {*i} -> 0 || PGmcStarStressedVowel PGmcStarConsonant+ PGmcStarVocalic
     ↪  PGmcStarConsonant+ _ .#.,
    {*i} -> 0 || PGmcStarStressedVowel PGmcStarConsonant+ PGmcStarVocalic
     ↪  PGmcStarConsonant+ _ {*z} .#.
]
]);
```

The absence of umlaut in *geoguþ* ‘youth’ provides the historical argument for early deletion. The ordered derivation supplies a different test: if apocope is delayed until after SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong, PGmc **skáwōθi* ‘shows’ yields †*sċēaweþ* rather than expected OE *sċēawaþ* ‘shows’.

Early i-apocope must therefore precede the long-diphthong development. Moving it earlier within the tested range leaves every output unchanged; its early date rests on the anti-umlaut evidence, not on a lower boundary supplied by the witness words.

3.12 Final **ō*-lowering before **r*

3.12.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor separate two points here: a broader shortening of vowels before word-final **r* in unstressed syllables (for which kinship **r*-stems such as PGmc **fadér* > PWGmc **fader* are a key diagnostic), and the specific **ō*-before-**r* development needed here (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 58–59). The direct lexical witnesses for **ō* in that environment are two independent etyma: PGmc **fedwōr* ‘four’ with WGmc reflexes OE *fēower* ‘four’, OFris *fiuwer* ‘four’, OS *fiuwar* ‘four’; and PGmc **watōr* ‘water’ with OE *wæter* ‘water’.

The rule is historically secure but narrow: final or pre-final **ō* before word-final **r*. The clearest evidence remains concentrated in the `four` and `water` material. No broader environment for **ō* is attested.

3.12.2 SC007. Lowering of final bimoric **ō* before **r* (PWGmcFinalOrLowering)

```
define PWGmcFinalOrLowering Ctx([
    [
    {*ō} -> {*a} || _ {*r} .#.
]
]);
```

OE *wæter* ‘water’ reveals why lowering must precede SC043 EAFBrightening. If SC007 PWGmcFinalOrLowering is delayed until afterwards, PGmc **wátōr* ‘water’ yields †*water* rather than expected OE *wæter* ‘water’: brightening can affect the vowel only after lowering has created its input. Moving the change earlier within the tested range alters no output.

The witness thus supplies a terminus ante quem at brightening but no earlier boundary. Comparative support for the **ō*-before-**r* rule comes from the two lexical witnesses **fedwōr* ‘four’ and **watōr* ‘water’ and their WGmc reflexes; kinship **r*-stems belong to the broader pre-**r* shortening context, not to a direct **ō* > **a* control. Within CAPR, *wæter* ‘water’ is the form that establishes ordering before brightening. No broader lowering of **ō* is attested.

3.13 Coronal-w assimilation

3.13.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor treat the assimilation of **dw* and **zw* to **ww* as a shared Proto-West-Germanic innovation supported by one example of each input cluster (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 56–57; Stiles 1985, 89–94). The **dw* example is the numeral ‘four’: PGmc **feðwor* (Gothic *fidwor*) → WGmc **fewwar* → OE *fēower*, Old Frisian *fiuwer*, Old Saxon *fiuwar*. The **zw* example is the second-person plural pronoun, where two oblique case forms show the change: acc./dat. PGmc **izwiz* (Gothic *izwis*) → OE *eow*, Old Frisian *iu*, Old Saxon *iu*, OHG *iu*; and gen. Ringe and Taylor’s PGmc **izweraz* (Gothic *izwara*) → OE *eower*, OHG *iuwer* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 56). Stiles discusses the same pronominal material using his own reconstruction conventions and explicitly treats Gothic *izwara* among the relevant comparanda (Stiles 1985, 89–94). These two case forms belong to a single pronominal paradigm, not to two independent etyma.

The historical support rests on a small witness set. Both coronal inputs assimilate before **w*, but the evidence for each cluster is confined: the numeral alone supplies the **dw* instance, and the oblique case forms of the second-person plural pronoun supply the **zw* instance. Both clusters are now witnessed in the corpus: ‘four’ for **dw*, and ‘you’ — selected in its dat.(-acc.) plural cell **izwiz* — for **zw*, deriving through **iwwi*, apocopated **iww*, to OE *ēow* ‘you’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, §3.1.1; Fulk 2018, sect. 8.3, pp. 204–205).

3.13.2 SC008. Assimilation of coronal consonants before **w* (PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation)

```
define PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation Ctx([
    [
    {*d} -> {*w} || _ {*w},
    {*z} -> {*w} || _ {*w}
]
]);
```

OE *fēower* ‘four’ exposes a feeding relation: coronal assimilation creates the **ww* input of the early reanalysis in SC031 OEWWSimplification, yielding the diphthongal intermediate before later English realization. Ringe and Taylor explicitly give the coronal-assimilation and glide-reanalysis sequence (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42). The earlier displacement result belonged to the superseded late **ww*-deletion proxy and does not by itself predict the result of displacing the reformulated early operation.

The numeral fixes that relative order. The pronoun now fixes a second one: assimilation must precede rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism). The *z* of **izwiz* stands between vowel and **w*; had rhotacism applied first, it would have produced †*irwiz*, from which OE *ēow* 'you' can never be derived. The executable cascade composes the assimilation well before rhotacism, and the corpus derivation of *ēow* 'you' fails if the two are reversed. 'Four' remains the sole **dw* witness and the sole source of the coronal-assimilation → *ww*-simplification ordering constraint. The earlier boundary of the assimilation remains undetermined.

3.14 Inherited short-vowel-plus-geminate-glide reanalysis

3.14.1 Historical discussion

Inherited geminate glides after short vowels underwent reanalysis in Proto-West Germanic: the first glide became the offglide of a diphthong, while the second remained consonantal. This is not simply deletion of one *w*, and it is not the later English realization of the new diphthong. Ringe and Taylor distinguish those histories explicitly; Fulk specifies the short-vowel environment ((Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 171–75; Fulk 2018, 117)).

Coronal assimilation feeds the change in *fēower* 'four' and *ēow* 'you': SC008 PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation supplies the geminate that becomes *eu+w* or *iu+w*. Inherited geminates also supply the histories of *ċēowan* 'chew', *dēaw* 'dew' and *hēawan* 'hew'. The resulting diphthongs enter the separate English realization described under SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling ((Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 172–75; Campbell 1959, 45–47)).

Homorganic *uww* requires a separate quantity decision. We adopt Ringe and Taylor's preferred long-*u* account for *sċūwa* 'shadow', but retain their qualification of its evidence rather than treating the quantity as independently certain. Hypothetical inherited long-vowel-plus- *ww* sequences are not additional reconstructed witnesses: the held description specifies inherited geminates after short vowels. The parallel inherited *jj* development is independently governed and is not changed here ((Ringe and Taylor 2014, 65–66; Fulk 2018, 117)).

3.14.2 SC031. Inherited short-Vww reanalysis (`OEWWSimplification`)

```
define OEWWSimplification Ctx([
    [
    {*a} {*w} {*w} -> {*au} {*w},
    {*á} {*w} {*w} -> {*áu} {*w},
    {*e} {*w} {*w} -> {*eu} {*w},
    {*é} {*w} {*w} -> {*éu} {*w},
    {*i} {*w} {*w} -> {*iu} {*w},
    {*í} {*w} {*w} -> {*íu} {*w},
    {*u} {*w} {*w} -> {*ū} {*w},
    {*ú} {*w} {*w} -> {*ū} {*w}
]
]);
```

The transport wrapper carries an independently selected sentence context outside the segmental rewrite; it adds no reconstructed sound and does not condition the reanalysis. Acute and unmarked spellings are notation variants, not alternatives in sentence stress. The retained executable name likewise does not determine the historical stage.

The modeled position after coronal assimilation and before j-gemination is a representative serialization that keeps inherited/coronal-created geminates distinct from the subsequently created j-path. It is not a newly proved strict chronology between the whole events. *Hīeġ* 'hay' and reconstructed West Saxon strew retain the separately adjudicated SC029 OEAwwjResolution path. *Hīew* 'hue' has distinct j-created reanalysis at SC033 OEEwLongDiphthong and long-io realization at SC110 OEJGlideIO. The retained SC106 OEJWWSimplification compatibility operation is no longer fed by hue ((Campbell 1959, 45–47; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 173, 250)).

For you, early *iu+w* now reaches SC098 PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope. Its weak-final context, not the former presence of literal *ww*, licenses apocope before mutation. Earlier

source-backed reanalysis thus coexists with genuine prosodic conditioning rather than an output-restoring segment proxy ((Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 55, 57–58)).

3.15 *ij*-contraction in *friend*

3.15.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor describe a change of **ijo* to **iu* in the ancestor of *friend*, with the pathway PGmc **frijōnd-* (Gothic *frijonds*) → PWGmc **friund* → OE *frēond*, Old Frisian *frīund*, Old Saxon *friund*, Old High German *friunt* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 62). The same source immediately warns that the **ijo* sequence is unique enough that wider generalization is inadvisable (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 62). Luick (printed p. 118) notes that *iu* generalised within several *j*-stem paradigms through a related but differently conditioned loss of *j*, but does not supply a second example of the exact stressed **ijo* sequence (Luick 1914--1940, 118).

The change concerns a rare sequence attested only in the **frijōnd-* etymon and cannot safely be generalized into a broadly productive rule.

3.15.2 SC009. *ij*-contraction in *friend* (`PWGmcIjContraction`)

```
define PWGmcIjContraction Ctx([
    [
    {*i} {*j} {*ō} -> {*iu} || _ EnglishStarConsonant,
    # Stressed variant (stress preserved):
    {*í} {*j} {*ō} -> {*íu} || _ EnglishStarConsonant
]
]);
```

Only the **frijōnd-* etymon tests this contraction. If the rare **ijō* sequence survives until after SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling, PGmc **fríjōndz* 'friend' yields †*friund* rather than expected OE *frēond* 'friend'; moving contraction earlier within the tested range changes no output.

That single contrast places SC009 PWGmcIjContraction before diphthong leveling but gives no lower boundary. It cannot establish a productive sound law beyond the **frijōnd-* etymon, precisely the reservation made by Ringe and Taylor.

3.16 West Germanic j-gemination

3.16.1 Historical discussion

Fulk treats West Germanic consonant gemination before `*j` after a short vowel as a regular development and illustrates it with forms such as OE *settan* 'set' and *lecgan* 'lay' (Fulk 2018, 127, §6.15).

The change applies specifically after a short vowel before **j*, not to geminate consonants generally.

3.16.2 SC010. West Germanic j-gemination (`PWGmcJGemination`)

```
define PWGmcJGemination Ctx([
    [
    {*p} -> {*p} {*p} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*b} -> {*b} {*b} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*t} -> {*t} {*t} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*d} -> {*d} {*d} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*k} -> {*k} {*k} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*g} -> {*g} {*g} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*f} -> {*f} {*f} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*s} -> {*s} {*s} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*m} -> {*m} {*m} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
```

```
    {*n} -> {*n} {*n} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*l} -> {*l} {*l} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*ŋ} -> {*ŋ} {*ŋ} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    {*x} -> {*x} {*x} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},
    # *w is an ordinary member of the same law. Campbell §407 p. 167:
    # "every consonant except r being affected after short syllables...
    # The forms in which w is doubled are dealt with in §120.2."
    # Ringe & Taylor p. 53: "it appears that that cluster too underwent
    # gemination in PWGmc." The geminate this creates is the input that
    # SC029 later resolves. Fulk §4.10 n. 1 dissents; see
    # audits/sc010-w-gemination-and-hay-depth-adjudication.md.
    {*w} -> {*w} {*w} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j}
]
]);
```

OE *nett* ‘net’ fixes the order because the syllabic-*j* development would remove the glide that conditions gemination. If SC011 PWGmcSyllabicJ precedes SC010 PWGmcJGemination, PGmc **nátją* ‘net’ yields †*nete* rather than expected OE *nett* ‘net’. Earlier movement of gemination changes no output.

The chronology is phonologically transparent: the consonant must geminate before **j* ceases to be consonantal. The witness establishes no earlier boundary.

3.17 Syllabic j after final-vowel loss

3.17.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor state directly that after final unstressed `*a` and `*ą` were lost, postconsonantal `*j` became syllabic `*i`, with outcomes behind OE *here* ‘army’ and *rice* ‘kingdom’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 46).

The sources establish the development, although the lexical evidence supplies little independent support for its position. Its scope is postconsonantal j, not high-vowel vocalization generally.

3.17.2 SC011. Syllabic **j* after final-vowel loss (`PWGmcSyllabicJ`)

```
define PWGmcSyllabicJ Ctx([
    [
    {*j} {*a} -> {*i} || EnglishStarShortVowel EnglishStarConsonant _ .#.,
    {*j} {*ą} -> {*i} || EnglishStarShortVowel EnglishStarConsonant _ .#.
]
]);
```

The same PGmc **nátją* ‘net’ witness supplies the only firm boundary. Placing SC011 PWGmcSyllabicJ before SC010 PWGmcJGemination yields †*nete* rather than expected OE *nett* ‘net’; moving it later changes no output.

Comparative evidence establishes postconsonantal **j* to syllabic **i* after final unstressed **a* or **ą* loss, with *here* ‘army’ and *rice* ‘kingdom’ as outcomes. The lexicon adds only that vocalization followed gemination, not where it falls among subsequent changes.

3.18 Simplification of the cluster **xs* before a consonant

3.18.1 Historical discussion

The change treated here is narrow. When **x* stood before **s* and that **s* was itself followed by a further consonant, the **x* was lost and the cluster was reduced. Campbell states the rule in exactly these terms, that when a consonant follows, **xs* becomes *s*, and he illustrates it with *wæstm* ‘growth’ and *wæsma* ‘growth’ beside *weaxan* ‘to grow’, and with Northumbrian *sesta* ‘sixth’ beside West Saxon *siexta* (Campbell 1959, 170, §417). Brunner gives the same statement and adds that the following consonant may be *j* as well as a true obstruent, citing *nēosian* ‘to

visit', *þīsl* 'pole', *wæsma* and *wæstm* (Brunner 1965, 184, §221.2). Bülbring formulates it as a pre-English change and is careful to say that it held as a rule, with exceptions (Bülbring 1902, 215, §527).

The cluster that the change requires is a specific one, and two neighbouring clusters show that the restriction is real. Where **xs* stood with no consonant after it, the **x* was not lost at all. It survived long enough to cause breaking and then hardened to the sound written *x*, that is [ks], as in *fox* 'fox', *siex* 'six', *weaxan*, *oxa* 'ox' and *fleax* 'flax' (Campbell 1959, 170, §416). Where **x* stood before a single consonant it was likewise kept. Campbell observes that once **xs* had become [ks], the only group in which **x* still stood before a voiceless consonant in earliest Old English was **xt*, and that this group remained, as in *feohtan* 'to fight', *miht* 'might', *niht* 'night' and *sōhte* 'sought' (Campbell 1959, 186, §464). The contrast is attested outside English as well. Old High German and Old Saxon *lastar* 'reproach' comes from **laxstra-* with the **x* lost before **st*, while Old English *leahtor* comes from **laxtra-* with the **x* kept before **t* (Campbell 1959, 170, §417).

The change is not Proto-Germanic. Gothic keeps the **h* of this cluster in *bi-niuhsjan* 'to spy out' and *saihsta* 'sixth', so the loss must be later than the separation of Gothic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157–58). Campbell reports the loss from the whole West Germanic area and from North Germanic as well, citing Old Norse *ísl* 'axle' and *nýsa* 'to investigate', Old Saxon *weslon* 'to exchange', *wastum* 'growth' and *niustan*, and Old High German *niusen* 'to try' (Campbell 1959, 170, §417). Ringe and Taylor set out the same comparative material and reach a more guarded conclusion. They derive Proto-Germanic **niuhsijanǫ* through Proto-West Germanic **niusjan* to Old English *nēosan* 'to seek out, to visit', and **sehstō* to Northumbrian *sesta*, and they take the Old Saxon agreement in *wastum*, *thisla* and *niusian* to show a shared northern West Germanic change. Against that they weigh the competition between *þixl* 'pole' and *þīsl* 'pole' in early Mercian, the survival of **x* in *eaxl* 'shoulder' from **ahslu*, and the retention in Old High German *sehsto* and *dihsala*. Their conclusion is that the **h* was lost, possibly variably and possibly only in some dialects, when two or more consonants followed, and that the loss may have been in part a parallel development in the diverging Northwest Germanic dialects (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157–58). The existence of the change is therefore secure while its exact date and extent are not, and the rating given here reflects that division.

Two chronological anchors are available. Ringe and Taylor place the loss after the Proto-West Germanic syncope of **-CijV-*, since it is that syncope which brings the **s* and the **j* of **niuhsjan* together (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157). They place it before breaking, observing that the undiphthongized vowels of *wæstm* 'growth' and *þīsl* 'pole' can be accounted for only by supposing that these **h* were lost before breaking took place (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 158). The rule is stated between those two points.

One witness in this collection undergoes the change. Proto-Germanic **funxstiz* 'fist' reaches the rule as **fūxstiz*, the long vowel having been produced by the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x* described in SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX. The cluster **xst* is then reduced to **st*, and the word continues to Old English *fȳst* 'fist'. The comparative set for this particular word is West Germanic throughout, with Old Frisian *fēst* 'fist', Old Saxon and Old High German *fūst* 'fist', Dutch *vuist* and German *Faust* (Kroonen 2013, 160; Orel 2003, 157). Neither Gothic nor Old Norse preserves a reflex of it, so the word bears on the domain of the change rather than on its date.

The word *thought* is the control. Proto-Germanic **θánxtē* also passes through SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX, which leaves **θāxtē*, but the **x* there stands before a single **t* and not before **s*, so the present rule does not touch it and Old English has *þōhte* 'thought' with its *h* intact. The pair *fist* and *thought* reproduces within this collection the same contrast that *lastar* and *leahtor* show across the West Germanic languages.

The relation between the two rules should not be overstated. The earlier rule does supply the cluster that this one simplifies, but the order of the two is established by their stages and not by any word in this collection. If the present rule were stated first, *fist* would still reach *fȳst* 'fist', because removing the **x* from **funxstiz* leaves a nasal before *s*, and that nasal is removed with compensatory lengthening by the North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law. The outcome is overdetermined, and the chronology rests on Gothic *bi-niuhsjan* 'to spy out' and *saihsta* instead.

3.18.2 SC028. Simplification of **xs* before a consonant (PNWGmcPreconsonantalXLoss)

```
define PNWGmcPreconsonantalXLoss Ctx([
    [
    {*x} -> 0 || _ {*s} EnglishStarConsonant
]
]);
```

The **s* in the structural description carries the whole weight of the rule. Without it the rule would delete **x* before any two consonants, and it would then wrongly remove the first element of a geminate **xx* before **j*, where Old English in fact has *hliehhan* 'to laugh' with the geminate written *hh* (Campbell 1959, 186, §464). The rule fires on *fist* and on no other word in this collection, and it leaves *fox*, *six*, *wax*, *flax* and *ox* untouched, as it must, along with *thought*, *fight*, *night*, *light*, *might*, *knight*, *fright* and *wight*.

The implementation name retains an older description of the rule and will be brought into line in a separate pass.

3.19 *lþ*-voicing

3.19.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor treat word-internal **lþ* > **ld* as a regular sound change in northern West Germanic and illustrate it with forms such as *fealdan* 'fold', *beald* 'bold', *wuldor* 'glory', and *gylden* 'golden' (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–71). Campbell gives a similar West-Germanic-facing formulation with examples such as *fealdan*, *wuldor*, *beald*, *gold* 'gold', and *feld* 'field' (Campbell 1959, 169, §414).

The comparative evidence supports *lþ* > *ld* most clearly in northern West Germanic, not as an unqualified pan-PWGmc development.

3.19.2 SC012. Northern West Germanic *lþ*-voicing (`EAFLThVoicing`)

```
define EAFLThVoicing Ctx([
    [
    {*θ} -> {*d} || {*l} _
]
]);
```

The `field`, `fold`, `gold`, and `wold` families preserve **lþ* to **ld*, but none dates the change against a neighboring rule. Every output remains unchanged when the voicing is moved in either direction.

Comparative reconstruction therefore establishes northern West Germanic *lþ* > *ld*, but the witness forms fix no date. Neither a pan-PWGmc attribution nor an exact local placement follows from the evidence presented here.

3.20 Dental hardening

3.20.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor state directly that in PWGmc voiced dental fricative `*ð` became stop `*d` in all positions (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 43).

The change is systemic across early West Germanic and extends beyond any one lexical family.

3.20.2 SC013. Dental hardening (`PWGmcDentalHardening`)

```
define PWGmcDentalHardening Ctx([
    [
    {*ð} -> {*d}
]
]);
```

Dental hardening has systemic scope: voiced fricative **ð* became stop **d* throughout early West Germanic. Moving SC013 PWGmcDentalHardening earlier or later changes no output.

Comparative evidence establishes the sound law; the present lexicon leaves its exact position approximate.

3.21 Endingless *aw*: the regular straw branch

3.21.1 Historical discussion

The inherited nominative/accusative **stráwą* loses its final ending and vocalizes resulting final *w*, giving **strau*. Ordinary English diphthong development then produces reconstructed **strēa*. Attested *strēaw* ‘straw’ instead combines that long diphthong with *w* restored from inflected forms; the long nucleus also spreads into those forms. The regular free simplex and short obliques are explicitly unattested. The compound *strēaberige* ‘strawberry’ preserves the endingless branch, but is not substituted for an attested free noun (Campbell 1959, 46–47, 232–33; Brunner 1965, 49, 110, 204–5; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172–73, 387).

The model keeps attested *strēaw* ‘straw’ as its comparison and produces regular reconstructed **strēa*: this is an explicit mismatch. The fragment below combines final-vowel loss and ensuing vocalization. Its narrow matcher does not make general final-vowel loss *w*-conditioned.

3.21.2 SC111. Endingless *aw* fragment (`PWGmcEndinglessAw`)

```
define PWGmcEndinglessAw [
    {*a} {*w} {*ą} -> {*au} || _ .#. ,
    {*á} {*w} {*ą} -> {*áu} || _ .#.
];
```

The ordinary *au* product feeds SC030 OEAuBrightening and SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling, not the retained show proxy SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong. The early holding site is compatible with the source’s West Germanic history, not evidence for strict relative order against unrelated dental hardening (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172–73).

3.22 Consonant-conditioned lowering of stressed short i

3.22.1 SC015. Consonant-conditioned lowering of stressed short **i* (PNWGmcILowering)

3.22.1.1 A disputed Germanic correspondence Old English *nest* ‘nest’ and *wer* ‘man’ have long occupied a disproportionate place in the history of Germanic vowels. Their mid vowels appear to continue earlier short **i*, yet many words with apparently comparable endings retain a high vowel. The question is not whether lowering occurred somewhere, but which conditions explain its distribution, and whether the relevant developments belonged to a common ancestor or separate daughter histories. Campbell identifies only these nouns and isolated *spec* ‘bacon’, beside *spic* ‘bacon’, as clear English evidence for the traditional formulation (Campbell 1959, 43–44).

The account adopted here lowers stressed short **i* immediately before inherited **r*, tautosyllabic **z*, or **st*. It follows Hill’s consonant-conditioned proposal, not a general assimilation to the following vowel. This is a working reconstruction with unequal evidential support for its components: the rhotic environment is strongest; the sibilant environments are more difficult. Its value

lies in relating positive correspondences to independently important negative evidence, not in making every inherited formation unproblematic (Hill 2017, 153–58).

3.22.1.2 The vowel-conditioned tradition Streitberg states a common-Germanic lowering before a following **a* or **ā*, blocked by intervening **j* or a nasal followed by another consonant. The latter qualification matters: a single nasal is not automatically a blocker. His presentation already acknowledges extensive analogical disturbance. Hirt likewise connects lowering with a following low or mid vowel, but qualifies its geographical unity and admits unknown conditions. Neither author offers an uncontested exceptionless distribution (Streitberg 1896, 56–57; Hirt 1931--1934, 45–46).

Luick is more guarded for English: lowering appears in only some formations and seems dependent on additional conditions not yet recovered. Campbell preserves the short statement while separating the much more regular lowering of **u* in SC017 PNWGmcULowering. The apparent parallel between the two vowels is historically important, but parallel notation does not establish identical conditions or chronology. Fulk retains a serious role for vowel-conditioned lowering and subsequent levelling, particularly the elimination of lowered vowels from paradigms (Luick 1914--1940, 108–9; Campbell 1959, 43–44; Fulk 2018, 56–59).

There was consequently no single traditional consensus subsequently overturned by one discovery. Lloyd's survey distinguishes authors who accepted a common change, those who restricted it to dialectal prehistories, and those who merely registered the forms or denied the law. That history cautions against treating every reconstructed **e* as an endorsement of the same vowel-harmony mechanism. The inference from a correspondence to a particular conditioner must be argued independently (Lloyd 1966, 738–39).

3.22.1.3 Why the following vowel is insufficient Class I strong-verb participles supply a major difficulty. Short **i* survives before a non-high participial vowel where the parallel class II formation commonly shows lowered **u*. The contrast cannot be removed simply by noting that participles belong to paradigms: a proposed restoration must identify the source of the restored vowel and explain its distribution. Lloyd challenges precisely those morphological premises, rather than denying that analogy exists (Lloyd 1966, 739–40; Hill 2017, 150–52).

The uninflected adverbs are harder still. OHG *hina* 'hence', *hinana* 'from here', and *nidana* 'from below' retain high vowels before non-high continuations without an ordinary case paradigm from which **i* could be restored. Fish vocabulary supplies another independent class: PGmc **fiskaz* 'fish' and **wiskō* 'wisp' preserve **i* before **sk*. Changing their inflection after the event does not itself explain the inherited root vocalism (Lloyd 1966, 741–42; Hill 2017, 152, 154–55).

3.22.1.4 Hock's defence of lowering Hock's detailed reply must nevertheless be distinguished from a mere assumption of analogy. He accepts an inherited contrast between **e* and **i* before **u* in Norse and English, and in certain monosyllables, while still defending lowering before low vowels. Complete phonemic merger and conditioned lowering are therefore different claims: rejecting the former does not refute the latter. His later raising before **u* is geographically restricted to the continental languages, not projected indiscriminately into their common ancestor (Hock 1973, 328–29, 345–46).

For class I participles, Hock identifies the *i*-timbre of the present, rather than simply the preterite plural, as the restoring model; he also appeals to differentiation from other strong classes. Hill directly challenges this account on quantity: the proposed present model has long **ī*, whereas the participles require short **i*. Selective restoration of timbre without quantity needs its own historical justification. Cercignani and Fulk nevertheless continue to allow present-stem influence, so the dispute is not settled by citing agreement on phonemic distinctness (Hock 1973, 340–41; Hill 2017, 151–52; Cercignani 1980, 130; Fulk 2018, 58–59).

Hock also confronts the adverbs, proposing different formative histories and subsequent levelling, and adducing OE *heonan* 'hence' and *neoðan* 'from below' alongside the high-vowel forms. Those are comparative hypotheses, not evidence that every relevant suffix or restoration has

been established. In particular, Ringe and Taylor note that Old English *eo* for expected *io* can result from a much later merger; Hill likewise distinguishes later Norse developments. The surface vowels alone cannot date a shared ancestral lowering (Hock 1973, 342; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 35, n. 17; Hill 2017, 152, n. 24).

For ‘fish’, Hock proposes an original i-stem transferred to the a-stems only after lowered vowels had become phonemic. That is a specific alternative history, but the stem transfer and its date require independent support; Cercignani explicitly questions this explanation. Hock’s final appeal to nominative/vocative syncretism likewise supplies a proposed mechanism for nominal doublets, not an independently fixed chronology. His own defence and the later objections are part of the case for evaluating particular histories rather than treating analogy as either universally available or universally excluded (Hock 1973, 343–45, p. 349, n. 29; Cercignani 1979, 77–78; 1980, 131).

Cercignani’s defence of distinct **i* and **e* phonemes addresses a related but different proposition: phonemic opposition does not exclude a conditioned lowering. His criticism concerns the extension of one distribution and date across Germanic. In particular, the Norse restriction after preceding **k/g* cannot simply be transferred to West Germanic. Ringe and Taylor also separate the southern West Germanic lowering before labial and velar obstruents from the widely shared nest and man correspondences. An independent continental development therefore cannot be assumed to establish a general ancestral rule (Cercignani 1979, 75–76, 82; 1980, 129–31; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 33–36).

3.22.1.5 Hill’s consonantal environments Hill redirects attention to the immediately following consonant. Before tautosyllabic **z*, the principal comparisons include PGmc **iz* ‘he’, **hiz* ‘this here’, and **mizdōn* ‘reward’. The last belongs with OE *meord* ‘reward’ and *mēd* ‘reward’, whose consonants and quantities subsequently diverge. Their mid vowels need not have been induced by a later low vowel: the monosyllabic pronouns are especially significant because they remove that presumed determinant (Hill 2017, 153).

Before **st*, **nistan* ‘nest’ supplies the central example. Its **e* is compatible with both accounts when a non-high ending is reconstructed, so it does not by itself choose the conditioner. The contrast with retained **sk* is more informative than nest alone. The comparative formation also supports an earlier high vowel: Kroonen relates the noun to the downward particle and the zero grade of ‘sit’. Nevertheless, one exceptionally clear noun is a thin foundation for the full productivity of an **st* law (Kroonen 2013, 391; Hill 2017, 153–55).

Before **r*, early **wiraz* ‘man’ is compared with OE *wer*, ON *verr* ‘man’, and Gothic *wair* ‘man’. Lloyd himself allows a special rhotic influence despite rejecting general a-umlaut. Howell’s account of Gothic breaking adds phonetic plausibility: rhotics, especially coda rhotics, commonly lower neighbouring vowels. But recurrence of a natural phonetic process is not proof of a single inherited event. Gothic could have lowered independently, and its breaking can obscure an older distinction between high and mid inputs (Lloyd 1966, 744, n. 9; Hill 2017, 156; Howell 2024, 81–82, 90–91).

Gothic consequently has a double evidential role. Its distribution can illuminate the phonetic environment of lowering, while its own breaking makes some comparisons historically ambiguous. A Gothic mid-vowel reflex before a rhotic is compatible with an earlier lowered vowel, but it is also compatible with an inherited high vowel affected by Gothic breaking. The correspondence cannot choose between those histories without additional chronological evidence. Hill’s proposal gains its force from combining the Gothic facts with West Germanic quantity and consonantal correspondences, not from treating Gothic spelling as a transparent record of one ancestral vowel. Conversely, the possibility of a Gothic innovation does not compel an independent innovation in every other daughter. A common development remains an explanatory hypothesis where its conditions and relative chronology can be defended. The inherited rhotic, the later rhotacized sibilant and the short versus long vowel must therefore be compared separately, rather than counted as interchangeable instances of the same environment (Hill 2017, 149, 156–58; Howell 2024, 81–82).

Hill further proposes that later i-mutation conceals some earlier lowering. His lowered Northwest Germanic **nęstijana* ‘to nest’ and **lęstiz* ‘skill’ can return to high vowels before a following

high-front trigger. Here the later raising has a specific phonological cause; it is not an unspecified repair assigned separately to every exception. The same account must nevertheless establish that the trigger existed in the relevant historical formation. Identical final high vowels alone cannot demonstrate the two-stage history (Hill 2017, 153).

3.22.1.6 Lowering and the length of 'here' The most consequential chronological proposal concerns OE *hēr* 'here'. Hill begins with early **hir*, parallel to the deictic adverbs 'where' and 'there', and argues for the sequence **hir* > **her* > **hēr*. His closer mid-vowel notation distinguishes the lowered result from an automatic identification with inherited **ē₁*. If monosyllabic lengthening had occurred first, an additional lowering of long **ī* would be needed, without the same independent support (Hill 2017, 148–49, 156–58).

On Hill's interpretation, lowering before **r* must therefore precede the lengthening. His broader argument treats West Germanic monosyllabic lengthening and aspects of Gothic breaking as potentially partly Proto-Germanic, making an early shared chronology a serious hypothesis. The conclusion is conditional, however: the source of the long vowel, the reconstruction of the short precursor and the identity of the lengthening must all be accepted. Ringe and Taylor discuss alternative ablaut and later-development interpretations. The modern correspondence does not uniquely force Hill's sequence (Hill 2017, 149, 156–58; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 36–37).

Nor does the argument date every consonantal component. Even if **hir* > *her* is established before lengthening, neither **z* nor **st* participates in that derivation. Their absolute dates require their own evidence. Likewise inherited **r* is distinct from **r* subsequently created by rhotacism: a later surface rhotic cannot simply be projected backwards as the conditioner of an earlier law (Hill 2017, 153–58; Crist 2002, 3–6).

3.22.1.7 Twine: a genuine difficulty for the sibilant condition OE *twīn* 'twine' and High German *zwirn-* present the sharpest difficulty. Orel reconstructs masculine **twiznaz*; Kluge–Seebold gives **twizna-* and distinguishes the early verbal and nominal attestations. The modern long vowel is not evidence for inherited long **ī*. A short-vowel formation containing **zn* is supported independently of the lowering hypothesis (Orel 2003, 414; Kluge 2011, 1021).

Two familiar histories preserve its timbre: **twizna-* > *twirna-* by rhotacism, and **twizna-* > *twīna-* through loss and compensatory lengthening. De Vaan explicitly connects those treatments with assimilation as another outcome of **zn*; Campbell groups *twīn* 'twine' with lengthening after sibilant loss. If early lowering instead produces **twezna-*, neither rhotacism nor loss restores the high vowel: **twerna-* and **twēna-* remain different predictions. The conflict is not merely orthographical (Campbell 1959, 166, §404; Vaan 2016, unpaginated, paragraphs "Verwante vormen" and "Zowel").

Kilday offers a specific alternative: the English word may be borrowed, with a linen-related semantic history and possible verbal borrowing before nominal back-formation. That proposal is worth considering because it has an argument independent of the present rule. It is not thereby proved. Moreover, removing English from the inherited evidence would not explain away the High German high vowel. Crist's lowering-before-loss-before-rhotacism chronology makes the incompatibility particularly clear when applied to the same inherited **izn* sequence (Kilday 2024, 1, 4–5; Crist 2002, 3–6).

Twine must therefore remain counterevidence, not be assigned a convenient exceptional exclusion. A syllable-sensitive account might distinguish some sequences, but the proposed syllabification would need independent historical support. The fact that a consonant follows *z is not itself proof that this sibilant had precisely the tautosyllabic status required by Hill's phonetic generalization (Hill 2017, 153; Orel 2003, 414).

3.22.1.8 Numeral adverbs: conditional rather than discharged OHG *zwiro* 'twice', *zwiror* 'twice', and *driror* 'thrice' raise a related question. Their prehistory is less secure than that of twine. Kroonen gives **twis* and alternatives **twiswar* *twizwar*; Orel also preserves different sibilant formations. Fulk starts from **twis-wōz*. These cannot be reduced to one certain bare

**twiz* simply because a later form contains a rhotic (Hirt 1931--1934, 116; Kroonen 2013, 530; Orel 2003, 414; Fulk 2018, 275).

The etymological discussion of *driror* explains final *-or* through comparative-adverbial remodelling and considers a **wa*-formation. That explains neither the root vowel nor automatically the first rhotic; its own **þrizwa-/twizwa-* retains a potentially relevant sibilant. A history with **sw*, one with intervocalic **z*, and one with coda **z* before **w* test different conditions. These adverbs are thus unresolved conditional controls, not three independent refutations and not three exceptions already disposed of by analogy (Lloyd et al. 1998, cols 784, s.v. driror; Noreen 1923, 309; Campbell 1959, 287).

3.22.1.9 The Norse participle and the disputed leather word The participle of ON *bíða* ‘await’ is *beðinn* ‘awaited’, also cited as *beðenn* ‘awaited’, not an attested **biðinn* ‘awaited’. Noreen considers a lowered ending and influence from the participle of ‘bid’; Seebold allows regular lowering but prefers the latter connection. Fulk treats the lowering interpretation seriously and denies that the analogy has been demonstrated. This isolated low-vowel participle is therefore evidence the consonantal account must confront, but it does not establish a general inherited vowel-conditioned law for all class I participles (Noreen 1923, 326, 332; Seebold 1970, 94–95; Fulk 2018, 58–59, 286).

OHG *irh* ‘chamois leather’ potentially contradicts lowering before **r*. Hill favours an existing loanword interpretation; Kroonen reconstructs **irha-* ‘he-goat’ within a wider comparative family. The alternatives concern lexical ancestry, not merely the operation of a vowel law. If the relevant formation is inherited, its high vowel needs an explanation. Borrowing cannot be declared certain solely because it would remove a counterexample (Hill 2017, 156, n. 30; Kroonen 2013, 270).

3.22.1.10 Learn and the limits of paradigm reconstruction OE *leornian* ‘learn’ alternates with *liornian* ‘learn’; OHG *lernēn* ‘learn’ likewise stands beside *lirnēn* ‘learn’. The comparative base is **lizn-*, but a single uncontroversial inherited paradigm has not been recovered. Jasanoff reconstructs a class III history and explicitly considers a lost third-singular **lizniþ* as a possible source of high-vowel forms. Hill instead emphasizes earlier lowering followed by mutation in appropriately extended stems. Both arguments depend on morphology not recoverable from the infinitive alone (Kroonen 2013, 340; Orel 2003, 247; Jasanoff 1973, 865, 868; Hill 2017, 153, n. 25).

The inherited high vowel and the later *io* spelling must be distinguished. Breaking can represent the continuation of a high vowel, but that high vowel could itself have resulted from mutation after an earlier lowering. Conversely, the existence of *leorn-* does not establish every reconstructed mutation trigger or levelling direction. Traditional dialect descriptions illuminate the distribution, not a simple opposition between conservative Northumbrian and innovative West Saxon: early West Saxon also has *liorn-*. Later weak-class remodelling further complicates the inherited cells (Campbell 1959, 48, 59, 125; Jasanoff 1973, 865, 868; Tarsi and Laker 2026, 42–43).

CAPR selects *leornian*, imperative *leorna* ‘learn!’, and third-singular *leornaþ* ‘learns’. These have independent textual support: Ælfric’s Treatise supplies an infinitive after *scealt*, Deuteronomy has the singular command, and Bede has *leornað* ‘learns’ with a singular ‘whoever’ subject. The dental spelling in the last is normalized without changing its vowel or cell. These are selections among attested forms, not three independent etymologies or proof that every *liorn-* history has been explained (Crawford 1922, 71, 351; Miller 1891, 380).

3.22.1.11 Adoption and its chronological limits The evidential asymmetry is itself informative. A law whose only argument were the absence of exceptions in a small English sample would have little comparative force. Here the positive correspondences belong to several different formations: pronominal stems, a verbal family, a reward noun and the inherited nest word. Their consonantal overlap is more specific than the mere presence of a non-high vowel somewhere to the right. Conversely, the class I participles and the uninflected adverbs test the old following-vowel condition without automatically entering any of the proposed consonantal en-

vironments. The same examples thus have different diagnostic value under the two hypotheses (Lloyd 1966, 739–45; Hill 2017, 153–56).

Later raising must be argued with corresponding precision. A visible high-front trigger can make a low intermediate compatible with a later high reflex; it does not prove that lowering happened. Once the trigger has been lost or transferred across a paradigm, morphological evidence must establish its former presence. That is why a mutation-masked derivative can be a useful compatibility control while the proposed learn paradigm remains uncertain. Neither should be treated as an unlimited mechanism for restoring the high vowel of every counterexample. The distinction preserves testable content in the consonantal hypothesis rather than immunizing it against comparison (Hill 2017, 153; Jasanoff 1973, 865, 868).

The unified rule is adopted because it relates important positive and negative correspondences without requiring general vowel-conditioned lowering and unspecified restoration in each resisting class. Its strongest historical foundation remains the rhotic component. The reward and pronoun families support the sibilant component, but twine remains a real difficulty; the productivity of the *st* component is less securely demonstrated beyond nest. Explanatory economy is not permission to erase those differences (Hill 2017, 153–58; Lloyd 1966, 739–45).

```
define PNWGmcILowering Ctx([
    {*i} -> {*e} ||
        .#. EnglishStarConsonant* _
        [{*z} [EnglishStarConsonant | .#.]
         | {*s} {*t}
         | {*r}],
    {*í} -> {*é} ||
        .#. EnglishStarConsonant* _
        [{*z} [EnglishStarConsonant | .#.]
         | {*s} {*t}
         | {*r}]
]);
```

The definition affects the first short-vowel nucleus, with acute and unmarked forms treated in parallel; it does not lower long **ī*. Its following consonants, not the next vowel or the presence of an earlier velar, determine application. Preconsonantal or word-final **z* is an explicit approximation to tautosyllabicity. It must not be mistaken for independent evidence about every **zn* sequence. The Northwest Germanic placement is a qualified working reconstruction; the possible earlier date of the rhotic component remains separate.

The selected reward dative **mízdai* is not the nominative **mizdōn*; their shared root is the relevant lowering witness. In *nest*, the inherited formation and *st* are central. Selected thistle lowers before *st* and later returns to a high vowel through mutation, illustrating a concealed intermediate without proving all proposed concealed histories. Masculine PGmc **weþruz* ‘wether’ already has **e* and therefore supplies no *i*-lowering evidence (Hill 2017, 153; Kroonen 2013, 370, 391, 584; Orel 2003, 459–60).

Finally, *world* contains the inherited ‘man’ element: Ringe and Taylor’s **weraldiz* already has **e*. An earlier-vowel compound representation cannot independently prove lowering before SC036 OEInterStressRaising. The consonantal account has no following-vowel trigger for interstress raising to remove. The compound is compatible with the selected history, not a unique chronological discriminator. Neither it nor the conditional *hēr* ‘here’ argument establishes a total order for all three lowering environments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 326; Orel 2003, 462; Hill 2017, 156–58).

3.23 Northwest Germanic u-lowering

3.23.1 Historical discussion

Northwest Germanic lowered **u* to **o* when the following syllable contained a non-high vowel. Campbell describes the change and lists *ġeoc* ‘yoke’ among its regular outcomes (Campbell 1959,

42–43, §115); Fulk gives the same word as a standard example — “OIcel. ok, OE geoc, OHG joh beside juh and OS juk” — and notes the paradigmatic alternation between lowered and unlowered stems that the conditioning produced (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3). A word-initial **j* does not block the change: the blocking effect of *j* concerns only a consonantal *j* standing between the target vowel and the conditioning vowel, as in the class I weak verbs of the *cnyssan* ‘strike’ type (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3). Ringe and Taylor accordingly reconstruct the Proto-West Germanic paradigm of ‘yoke’ with the lowering applied (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 129).

Regular corpus witnesses include *ġeoc* ‘yoke’, *nosu* ‘nose’, *sċofl* ‘shovel’, and *sorg* ‘sorrow’. Where the following syllable kept a high vowel the lowering did not apply, as in *ġeoguþ* ‘youth’, whose root *u* survived (Brunner 1965, 64–65, §92.1).

Regular lowering does not imply that every attested inherited word preserves the lowered vowel. The masculine noun rust ‘rust’ is a lexical residue: selected PGmc **rústaz* ‘rust’ regularly predicts **rost* ‘rust’. Orel’s alternative **rustō* ‘rust’ gives the same lowered root; his masculine alternative is independently supported by Ringe (Orel 2003, 309; Ringe 2017, 247–48). Since **frústą* ‘frost’ regularly gives forst ‘frost’, a general *-st-* exemption is unwarranted. The retained *u* remains unexplained, alongside the other retained-*u* cases such as *bucc* ‘buck’, *fugol* ‘bird’, *wulf* ‘wolf’ and *wulle* ‘wool’; their consonantal environments do not establish a general replacement law (Campbell 1959, 43, §115; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 27–34). The lowering law is retained; its non-high conditioning class includes nasalized long **ǭ*, not just oral **ō*. The independently reconstructed accusative **wullǭ* therefore lowers just as the nominative **wullō* does under the preferred chronology (Ringe 2017, 242–43). This does not merge either ending with trimoric **ô*. The rust lexical discussion distinguishes the selected masculine citation, Orel’s alternative and diagnostic paradigm constructions.

3.23.1.1 The second root of rainbow The independent noun *boga* ‘bow’ supplies an important comparison. Its short *o* continues inherited *u* lowered before a following non-high vowel; Kroonen identifies the noun as a masculine n-stem derived from ‘bend’. Colman explicitly gives this early explanation of *boga*, while Ringe and Taylor include its ancestor among the lowering examples (Kroonen 2013, 82; Colman 2011, 95–96; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 27–29).

CAPR extends the same assimilation to the subordinate-stressed root in **régna-bùgô* ‘rainbow’. The reconstruction retains primary accent on ‘rain’ and subordinate accent on ‘bow’; these are reconstructed prosodic properties, not manuscript accent marks. The proposed development begins **régna-bùgô* > **régna-bògô* > **régnabogô*, followed by palatalization of the first velar and the ordinary ending developments to *reġnboga* ‘rainbow’. The early non-high ending still conditions lowering. The resulting *ò* is decoded by the existing technical stress operation; the first-member vowel survives until SC114 OENonHighSyn, giving **réjnbogô*. Positional realization of underlying *b* is computed after that loss, without a new late fricative-to-stop sound law. Neither early lowering nor syncope requires an optional rewrite.

The general early change is source-backed; its extension to this precise compound and its reconstructed secondary accent is CAPR’s phonological inference. The authorities do not print the complete accented derivation (Campbell 1959, 43, §§115–116; Hogg 2011, 54–55, §§3.10–3.11; Fulk 2018, 56–57, §4.3). Analogy from the independent noun is conceivable but is not independently demonstrated here. The significant consequence is chronological: *rainbow* already has *o* before SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering. It therefore cannot establish that secondary stress had to disappear before that late lowering.

Colman’s moneyer-name evidence remains a genuine qualification. *Buga* beside *Boga*, including coin spellings with both vowels, cannot be dismissed by exempting names from sound change. Transmission to die-cutters and the interpretation of individual spellings complicate phonological and dialect attribution. The ordinary noun’s regular early history does not by itself resolve the name’s retained vowel (Colman 2011, 95–98).

3.23.2 SC017. Lowering of **u* before following non-high vowels (PNWGmcULowering)

```
define PNWGmcULowering [Ctx([
```

```
    [
    {*u} -> {*o}
        || .#. EnglishStarConsonant* _
           [EnglishStarConsonantNoJ - EnglishStarNasal]
           EnglishStarConsonantNoJ* EnglishStarNonHighVowel,
    {*ú} -> {*ó}
        || .#. EnglishStarConsonant* _
           [EnglishStarConsonantNoJ - EnglishStarNasal]
           EnglishStarConsonantNoJ* EnglishStarNonHighVowel
    ]
]) .o. Ctx([
    {*ù} -> {*ò}
        || _
           [EnglishStarConsonantNoJ - EnglishStarNasal]
           EnglishStarConsonantNoJ* EnglishStarNonHighVowel
])];
```

The plain and acute clauses lower the first nucleus; the grave clause recognizes subordinate root stress without lowering ordinary unstressed medial *u*. Each uses a consonantal interval without **j*; the immediately following consonant must not be nasal. This literal guard is not a claim that every nasal anywhere in the interval blocks the historical process. Fulk distinguishes tautosyllabic and heterosyllabic nasal environments (Fulk 2018, 56).

The lowering feeds the much later West Saxon palatal-glide spelling (SC016 OEWsPalatalGlide): the *o* that the scribes wrote in *ġeoc* 'yoke' is the output of this change, so PGmc **júką* 'yoke' passes through **joką* on its way to the attested spelling (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 129). If lowering is placed after SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising, selected **núsō* 'nose' yields †*nusu* rather than expected *nosu*, PGmc **skúflō* 'shovel' yields †*sċufl* rather than expected *sċofl* 'shovel', and PGmc **súrgō* 'sorrow' yields †*surg* rather than expected *sorg*. These are conditional computational consequences, not independent proof that those paradigms underwent no levelling. CAPR provisionally prefers lowering before final raising because it regularly accounts for these low-root forms without additional, individually unproved analogical generalizations. Nose already involves earlier stem remodelling, and the retained high vowels of wool and love remain a genuine cost of that preference. The main comparison of Fulk, Ringe and Taylor, and Stiles, including the Runic evidence and the plausible but unproved nominative-generalization account of wool, is in SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising.

3.24 Stressed monosyllable **ō*-raising

3.24.1 Historical discussion

Campbell treats the development of final accented *ō* to *ū* in stressed monosyllables directly, with the familiar outcomes behind *cū* 'cow', *hū* 'how', *tū* 'two', and *bū* 'both' (Campbell 1959, 47, §122).

The change is historically secure, but the tested forms determine no close relative position for it. Its input is final **ō* in a stressed monosyllable.

3.24.2 SC018. Raising of final stressed monosyllabic **ō* (PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableORaising)

```
define PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableORaising Ctx([
    [
    {*ō} -> {*ū} || .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]* _ .#.
]
]);
```

Campbell's *cū* 'cow', *hū* 'how', and *tū* 'two' establish final stressed monosyllabic **ō* > **ū*.

Reversing SC018 PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableORaising with neighboring changes leaves every output unchanged. The sound change is secure, but its exact position in the early history of long vowels rests on the handbooks.

3.25 Raising of final unstressed long **ō*

3.25.1 Historical discussion

Final unstressed oral bimoric **ō* became short **u* in Northwest Germanic. The qualification matters: oral **ō*, nasalized **ǭ* and trimoric **ô* were not interchangeable endings. Ringe and Taylor distinguish the first two developments explicitly; Fulk also distinguishes the quantities when reconstructing the endings (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 15–16, 58–60; Fulk 2018, 82–86, 155–56).

The nominative singular **wullō* 'wool' and accusative singular **wullǭ* are independently reconstructed by Ringe. Their distinct endings must survive the comparison even when a later paradigm levels the root vowel (Ringe 2017, 242–43). Likewise, an oral vowel followed by **z* was not yet word-final. These distinctions explain both the scope of raising and its interaction with later loss.

3.25.2 SC019. Raising of final unstressed long **ō* (PNWGmcFinalLongORaising)

```
define PNWGmcFinalLongORaising Ctx([
    [
    {*ō} -> {*u}
        || EnglishStarVocalic
           [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.
    ]
]);
```

The preceding vowel and consonants select a polysyllabic input. The distinct stressed-monosyllable development is retained separately in SC018 PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableO-Raising; it is not absorbed into this unstressed ending law.

3.25.2.1 Lowering before raising: the preferred account Fulk argues that *scolu* 'troop, shoal', from **skulō*, requires lowering of the root before final **ō* became **u*. If raising had already removed the non-high conditioner, an unchanged nominative would retain root **u* (Fulk 2018, 56). CAPR provisionally follows this order: SC017 PNWGmcULowering, then final oral raising. It regularly gives the low roots of *nosu* 'nose', *sċofl* 'shovel' and *sorg* 'sorrow', rather than requiring a later root-vowel generalization for each selected form.

This is an argument from explanatory economy, not from the number of matching outputs. Fulk supplies the direct *scolu* argument; the comparison of its explanatory costs with the other selected paradigms is CAPR's assessment. The witnesses are not equally independent. *Nosu* already depends on an earlier remodeled zero-grade stem beside the comparative **nasō-*; it is not an untouched inherited nominative (Kroonen 2013, 383; Campbell 1959, 43, §115). For *sċofl* 'shovel', Luick also infers an earlier high-root doublet, **scufel*, beside *scofel* 'shovel'; that inference makes an alternating paradigm credible but does not establish its direction of levelling (Luick 1914--1940, 105–6, §78). The comparative formations of shovel and sorrow support the selected short-vowel stems, not a directly attested early English levelling operation (Orel 2003, 347; Kroonen 2013, 493). The preferred sequence avoids those additional operations, but it does not thereby explain every retained high vowel.

3.25.2.2 Raising before lowering: a coherent alternative Stiles expressly places final **ō* raising before a-umlaut of **u* (Stiles 2012, 45). Ringe and Taylor explain how *wull* 'wool' and *lufu* 'love' could preserve a nominative root **u* by generalizing it through a paradigm whose other cells had lowered **o*; they also leave open genuine exceptions (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 32). With the nasal accusative correctly recognized, the alternative has the following regular consequences. The table gives reconstructed sound-law predictions, not unattested forms promoted to attestations.

Paradigm	Lowering before raising	Raising before lowering
Wool: nominative / accusative	**woll* / **wolle*	**wull* / **wolle*
Love: nominative / accusative	**lofu* / **lofe*	**lufu* / **lofe*
Shoal: nominative / accusative	**sċolu* / **sċole*	**sċulu* / **sċole*

The inherited ending opposition follows Ringe's reconstructed paradigm and the independently described ō-stem inflections; it is not a special ending invented to rescue wool (Ringe 2017, 242–43; Fulk 2018, 154–56). Under earlier raising, nominative-to-oblique generalization can account for attested *wull* and *lufu/lufe* 'love'. Conversely, generalization of the lowered oblique root can account for *scolu* without replacing its nominative ending. The same possibility exists for nose, shovel and sorrow. Neither particular direction is directly witnessed in the reconstructed early English paradigms.

There is independent evidence that levelling occurred: Ringe and Taylor discuss early *Holtijaz* and the daughter and ox paradigms, while Stiles distinguishes conditioned Runic forms from analogical generalizations (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 33–34; Stiles 2012, 47–48). That establishes the mechanism's credibility, not its occurrence in every inconvenient lexeme. Continental *skola* is not an untouched nominative control either: Fulk describes accusative-ending generalization into the nominative in Old Saxon and Old High German (Fulk 2018, 154–55). Thus his *scolu* argument is strong only conditional on the inherited nominative root not having been remodeled. It does not refute Ringe and Taylor's phonologically coherent wool account.

There is a further lexical caution: Fulk elsewhere calls *scolu* 'host' a loan from Latin *schola* 'school', whereas his chronology argument expressly starts from inherited **skulō* (Fulk 2018, 47, n. 1, 56). These analyses cannot silently supply independent confirmation of one another. The comparison here evaluates his inherited analysis.

The balance nevertheless favors retaining lowering first as a working account: several independently selected low-root forms follow without additional, individually unproved levelling. Wool and love remain its real explanatory cost. Ringe and Taylor's alternative is plausible but unproved, not a demonstrated error. Analogy belongs to the separately argued history of a paradigm, not to the exceptionless sound laws.

3.25.2.3 What the Runic evidence dates Fulk cites *horna* 'horn' on the Gallehus horn, about 400, for lowering and *waritu* 'I write' on the Järsberg stone, about 450, for final oral raising (Fulk 2018, 56, 82). These are separate positive chronological bounds. An occurrence of raising around 450 does not establish that it began after 400. Nor does a written final *o* in another inflection establish retention of oral bimoric **ō*: nasalization, quantity and a following consonant must first be identified. Stiles's treatment of the Runic distribution also requires distinguishing conditioned realization, phonemicization and analogical extension (Stiles 2012, 47–48, 54–60). No new general revaluation law follows from those distinctions.

Fulk's note cites Ringe and Taylor on lowering and final **-az* loss, not as an explicit rebuttal of their wool explanation (Fulk 2018, 57, n. 1; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 27–34). Stiles predates their book. Luick discusses alternation and rejects a proposed labial protection law using regular low-root counterexamples; Campbell and Bülbring list retained-high-vowel cases (Luick 1914--1940, 104–6, §§77–79; Campbell 1959, 43, §115; Bülbring 1902, 45–46, §116). None of these checked passages supplies our exact comparative economy argument. No specific later criticism or defence was verified in the bounded literature search; this is not a claim of novelty or of its absence from all scholarship. The Campbell and Bülbring passages remain text-checked rather than newly certified against original images.

3.25.2.4 Final consonants and later ending reduction In **rástōz* 'rest', **z* protects oral **ō* from this raising. After SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion, the newly final long vowel can undergo SC042 PWGmcSurvivingBimoricOUnrounding and later fronting and shortening, yielding *ræste* 'rest'. Moving raising after final consonant loss wrongly exposes that vowel and gives **rast* instead.

This relation is retained separately; qualifying the lowering/raising comparison does not weaken it.

Nasal **ǭ* does not raise here. Its later reduction yields the accusative ending in **wolle*; the current serialization carries the nasal symbol to that reduction rather than claiming that nasality historically lasted until then. The genitive alternatives must also remain distinct: Ringe and Taylor reconstruct bimoric **-ōz*, where Fulk argues for trimoric **-ôz* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 59, 299; Fulk 2018, 155). The trimoric genitive's complete pathway remains unmodeled; it is not silently replaced by a bimoric genitive or covered by the present nasal-vowel repair.

4 Chapter 3. From Proto-West Germanic to Anglo-Frisian

4.1 Historical interval

This chapter covers the sound changes that occurred after the Proto-West Germanic period and before, or during the emergence of, the specifically English line. The starting reconstruction is Proto-West Germanic; the end point is the Anglo-Frisian ancestor required by the model's historical tree. Its existence and the identification of its innovations are separate questions. Its inventory must be reconstructed from conditioned laws and daughter chronologies, not from the traditional subgroup label alone.

4.2 A necessary terminological caution

The title of this chapter uses "Anglo-Frisian" as an organizing historical concept. That choice requires an explicit qualification.

The scholarly literature uses several overlapping terms for this developmental period:

- North Sea Germanic and Ingvaeonic: labels used by some scholars for a proposed subgroup comprising Old English, Old Frisian, and Old Saxon (or more narrowly, Old English and Old Frisian only). The innovations associated with this label — especially the nasal spirant changes and certain vowel developments — are sometimes described as diffusion rather than shared inheritance (Bremmer 2009, 24–27, 126–28).
- Anglo-Frisian: a label used specifically for the Old English / Old Frisian branch, or for innovations shared between the two languages. Its use presupposes a tighter relationship between English and Frisian than between either and Old Saxon.
- Proto-Anglo-Frisian (PAF): the strongest interpretation, positing a discrete reconstructed common ancestor for Old English and Old Frisian specifically. This is the position of Ringe and Taylor, who reconstruct a PAF stage between Proto-West Germanic and Proto-Old-English (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 54–68).

CAPR requires a discrete Anglo-Frisian ancestral node. This does not guarantee that every traditionally associated innovation is inherited from it, or exclusive to English and Frisian. A broader innovation can already be present in its input; similar daughter outcomes can also result from independent events. Authors' diffusion interpretations remain accurately attributed, but they cannot resolve an incompatible chronology within CAPR's ordered tree (Versloot 2017, 302–19; Bremmer 2008, 284, 292–93).

4.3 A worked historical tree test

If a supposed shared innovation obligatorily follows a daughter-only change in Frisian which English never underwent, it cannot occupy the common stem under those premises. Either the ordering or scope premise must change, the innovation happened independently, or the apparently identical events are historically different. The required ancestor is not removed.

Campbell reconstructs Frisian au contraction before ordinary fronting; Goblirsch instead proposes a shared diphthong followed by Frisian stress shift and contraction (Campbell 1939, 91, 104; Goblirsch 1991, 17, 20–21). The daughter-only event is a predecessor in the first account and a follower in the second. The second is compatible with sharing, but does not attest the reconstructed Frisian intermediate. Surface agreement, compatibility with inheritance, compelled parallelism under premises, and unresolved history must therefore remain distinct judgments.

4.4 The working account and why it is used

The English reconstruction adopted as a working scaffold is the conventional account developed by Campbell and critically refined by Ringe and Taylor. It distinguishes inherited long vowels from the long vowels produced by diphthong contraction, and it treats fronting, breaking, restoration and mutation as conditioned phonological developments. That scaffold is useful because it

specifies contrasting inputs and intermediate states, not because one author's authority decides the history (Campbell 1959, 52–53, 60–72; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–73, 215–37).

The comparative specialists test particular load-bearing premises. Campbell's argument about English and Frisian fronting, Versloot's runic interpretations and Goblirsch's proposed lost Frisian diphthong do not form one automatically compatible package (Campbell 1939, 90–91, 104; Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318; Goblirsch 1991, 17–21). Where an alternative changes the inherited inventory or the identity of an event, it must be evaluated as that alternative, not inserted into the conventional chain without its premises.

CAPR implements regular sound laws. Prosodic and phonological conditions may distinguish environments, but lexical diffusion, grammatical categories and individually selected exceptions cannot repair a contradiction. Paradigm remodeling and borrowing may affect which historical form a lexical entry represents; they are not thereby conditions on a sound law. This methodological choice is distinct from faithfully reporting an author's different theoretical account.

Barrack's West Saxon cascade supplies a formal generative restatement of parts of this interval. He states the Ingvaeonic nasal-spirant development as rule 121, locating it in the Old English/Old Frisian area with Old Saxon retaining free variation, with *ōþer* 'other' among his witnesses (Barrack 1975, 44); the fronting-and-rounding complex appears as rules 130a–c (Barrack 1975, 47–48); and a loss of **i* after **w* is marked "apparently Anglo-Frisian" as rule 406 (Barrack 1975, 104). Two cautions from the Barrack dossier apply throughout. First, his changes are modelled as windows of free variation with overlapping phases — his worked example is precisely the retraction/breaking overlap of rules 143a–b yielding attested *æll*/*all*/*eall* variation (Barrack 1975, 21–23, 53–54) — so his rule boundaries do not map one-to-one onto CAPR's categorical laws. Second, his orderings are formal, not chronological (Barrack 1975, 34), and cannot by themselves settle the stem-versus-daughter placement questions this chapter has just outlined.

4.5 Long vowels, diphthongs and the ancestral inventory

The inherited-long contrast is central. On the conventional reconstruction, inherited oral long **ā* has already acquired a front quality when English stressed **ai* completes its development to a new back **ā*. Otherwise the new vowel should share the inherited vowel's fronting. Ringe and Taylor formulate this as a relation between temporal milestones: inherited-long fronting must be well under way before contraction completes. They allow overlap; a serial implementation is not proof that the changes occupied disjoint periods (Campbell 1939, 90; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170).

The inherited vowel itself is disputed. Fulk's retained-front reconstruction does not require precisely the same earlier backing and re-fronting as Ringe and Taylor's account. That is a disagreement about the input inventory, not a small adjustment to the position of an otherwise identical rule (Fulk 2018, 60–61; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 10–13). Nielsen also proposes a different causal relation between contraction and long-vowel restructuring, allowing co-occurrence rather than imposing the conventional strict sequence (Nielsen 2001, 514–16, 521).

Luick's proposed fronted-ai path is a further alternative, not an observed intermediate series. His conjecture is **œe* > **œə* > **œa* > **ā*; the middle offglide is schwa. Campbell rejects that explanation, but the rejection is not an independent observation that such a phonetic path is impossible (Luick 1914--1940, 132–33; Campbell 1939, 90, n. 3). The inherited-long and secondary-long histories must consequently remain separate even where later mutation makes their final vowels converge.

Nasal environments require another distinction. Nasalization, loss of a nasal with compensatory lengthening, rounding and eventual merger are not one event. The nasalized input can escape an oral-fronting law before its later rounded outcome is established. A shared final vowel therefore does not place every substep at the same ancestral node (Bremmer 2009, 24–27; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142–46).

The following table specifies the relevant inventory questions at a conservative ancestral cut. It is a working reconstruction, not a newly adjudicated full phoneme inventory. Earlier West

Germanic developments can be inherited at this cut without being exclusively Anglo-Frisian innovations.

Input class	Conservative working ancestral state	English daughter consequence	Remaining premise
Inherited oral long vowel	Front long vowel under the conventional account	Subsequent dialectal and palatal treatment	Earlier back versus retained-front input
Nasal long vowel	Distinguished from the oral long vowel	Rounding and merger must be dated separately	Which nasal substeps precede the cut
Stressed ai	Retained diphthong before completed English contraction	Secondary back long vowel, eligible for later mutation	Runic interpretation and any limited ancestral onset
Ordinary short non-nasal a	Unfronted at this conservative cut	Ordinary English fronting	Daughter contraction before fronting
Inherited au	Not identified with completed English or Frisian outcome	English front element and later offglide development	Identity with ordinary short fronting
Supported inherited Vww classes	Adopted West Germanic a/e/i-ww reanalysis; separate homorganic uww quantity	Later English diphthong realization, not inherited English surface vowels	Qualified long-u shadow account; j-created classes remain separate
Velars and palatal tendencies	No blanket completed assibilation is stipulated	Class-specific daughter histories	Articulation, cutoff and merger are distinct

The evidence underlying these qualifications is component-specific (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 170–73; Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318; Laker 2007, 167–84). The table does not assign inherited-short fronting to the stem merely because the node is called Anglo-Frisian.

The inherited-glide component is now implemented rather than left as a possible future decomposition. SC031 OEWWSimplification belongs to the earlier West Germanic account discussed in Chapter 2: short nonhomorganic **Vww* gives **Vuw*, with retained consonantal **w*; homorganic **uww* separately gives long **ūw*. The latter follows Ringe and Taylor's preferred but qualified shadow analysis. These earlier products can be inherited at the Anglo-Frisian node without placing the later English long diphthongs there. The selected sentence context for early apocope is independent of the segmental reconstruction and of lexical accent (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 55, 57–58, 65–66, 171–75; Fulk 2018, 117).

4.6 Alternative cuts and their tree consequences

A more expansive common-stem reconstruction is possible only with different premises. In Luick's account, participation of the diphthong nucleus in fronting can coexist with a conjectured later Frisian development. In Goblirsch's account, a common fronted au diphthong precedes Frisian stress shift and contraction. Both require historical intermediates whose existence must be argued, not obtained from the name of the subgroup (Luick 1914--1940, 130–33; Goblirsch 1991, 17, 20–21).

Proposed common-stem content	Required premise	Conditional consequence
Inherited-long restructuring, but retained ai and short a	Completed English contraction is later	Compatible conservative cut

Proposed common-stem content	Required premise	Conditional consequence
Ordinary short fronting	Its secure predecessors can also occur before the split	Excluded if daughter-only English contraction obligatorily precedes it
Shared fronted-au development	Frisian stress shift/contraction follows that development	Compatible in Goblirsch's account, not proof of inheritance
Shared consonantal palatalization	Corresponding consonant classes and necessary predecessors are genuinely identical	Unresolved; apparent similarities do not settle all layers

Campbell's English chain makes the second row especially consequential: if completed contraction is English-only and ordinary fronting must follow it, the latter cannot be inherited from the common stem. The corresponding English and Frisian frontings are then parallel under those premises. Changing a disputed premise can change that conclusion, but cannot remove the required ancestor (Campbell 1939, 90–91; Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318).

4.7 Palatalization is not a single subgroup character

A palatal articulation can precede phonemic contrast, and the productive cutoff of a conditioning process can precede its eventual assibilated reflex. Fricative-g merger with j is different again. Geminate and postnasal stops, singleton fricatives, k, h and sk must not be treated as one dated change simply because later spellings look palatal (Hogg 1979, 100–111; Laker 2007, 167–68, 175–84).

The shared-palatalization hypothesis must therefore identify which layer is inherited. A daughter-specific predecessor can exclude a completed component from the stem without excluding every earlier articulatory tendency. Conversely, removing an argument against sharing establishes compatibility, not that one common event actually occurred (Laker 2007, 175–84). The vowel diphthongization following initial palatals is another event; Luick explicitly distinguishes the similar Frisian and English outcomes (Luick 1914--1940, 162–63).

The English implementation now distinguishes singleton palatal fricatives from gg/ng stops and adopts postmutation fricative merger as a working account (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–4; Fulk 2018, 130–32). Hogg's objection remains explicit (Hogg 1979, 102–11). This daughter account does not select a complete ancestral inventory, exclude every shared early articulatory tendency, or date stop affrication from an eventual written reflex.

4.8 What the runes date

An inscription dates a written object. A sound-change terminus additionally requires the reading, etymology, linguistic affiliation and relation of the grapheme to phonetic or phonemic structure. The interpretation of the Caistor inscription as retaining ai and the interpretation of Frisian retention are consequential but conditional (Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318). Waxenberger likewise distinguishes early allophonic mutation from later phonemicization and lacks immediate runic evidence for every short-vowel split (Waxenberger 2019, 63–74).

No one calendar date is therefore attached here to every change described as Anglo-Frisian. The English discussion that follows starts from the working inventory and makes its necessary daughter developments explicit. Canonical classification, preferred reconstruction and an unresolved component are kept distinct until individual adjudication.

4.9 Major changes and their historical basis

4.9.1 West Germanic rhotacism (SC003)

The medial change of *z to *r in environments such as **déuzaz* 'deer', **xúrdaz* 'hoard', and **líznōjaną* 'learn' is historically a post-Proto-West-Germanic development. Ringe and Taylor argue that rhotacism was not inherited from Proto-Northwest Germanic and was not uniform within West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 52, 98, 102). Crist separates this change explicitly from the deletion of word-final *z and argues that rhotacism must follow the deletion rules (Crist 2001, 104–6; 2002, 1, 4). Bammesberger gives the standard Old English–facing summary: *z yielded *r in intervocalic position but was generally lost in final position (Bammesberger 1992, 39).

The executable identifier EAFRhotacism is retained for stability, not as independent evidence of historical stage or scope. The preceding source discussion motivates the post-Proto-West-Germanic account; the chapter's placement follows the adopted executable sequence.

4.9.2 Word-final *z deletion (SC020) and the three final-*z developments

The loss of word-final *z is not one process but three historically distinct developments, and this chapter contains two of them. The central one, SC020, is the Proto-West Germanic loss of *z in unstressed syllables, seen in forms such as **rástōz* 'rest (nom.sg.)' and stated for the whole branch by Ringe and Taylor (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45); Crist's analysis distinguishes it both from the earlier NWGmc changes and from the later narrower Ingvaeonic deletion rules (Crist 2002, 1, 4). Earlier still, the consonant-stem root nouns had generalized endingless nominatives before Proto-West Germanic (SC096, Chapter 2). Later, and only in the north, *z was lost in stressed monosyllables with compensatory lengthening (SC097, this chapter); the southern dialects instead retained and rhotacized it. The standard handbooks confirm the West Germanic deletion in general terms: Bammesberger gives a clean statement that Germanic *z is generally lost in final position (Bammesberger 1992, 39); the three-way division refines those summaries rather than contradicting them.

The CAPR rule for the unstressed loss is still named EAFFinalZDeletion, an identifier that predates the restaging of the change to Proto-West Germanic; the name is retained as a stable identifier pending a global renaming pass, and the historical stage recorded in the staging metadata takes priority over the name prefix. SC020 and rhotacism jointly account for the fate of the remaining *z, but their sections are separated by intervening executable stages. Their thematic connection does not determine their publication positions.

4.9.3 Completed English ai contraction (SC004, treated in Chapter 4)

The English outcome of stressed/root **ai* is **ā*. Versloot distinguishes an early velar-conditioned Frisian contraction from later non-velar treatment, with mutation and delabialization intervening (Versloot 2017, 302–9, 316). His wave account is an author's interpretation, not CAPR's own genealogy. CAPR now places completed English contraction on the daughter branch, while preserving the distinct possibility of a narrower conditioned ancestral onset (Campbell 1939, 90–91; Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318). This local decision does not select every component of the ancestral inventory.

The current SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization models English contraction after SC101 EAFLongAFronting. The new ai-derived **ā* escaped the earlier fronting of inherited oral **ā*; Campbell states that inference and Ringe and Taylor retain it (Campbell 1959, 52–53, §132; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–70). Soul provides another implementation boundary at interstress raising, not the sole historical argument or proof of inherited contraction.

Fulk offers a materially different reconstruction. He allows fronting of the nucleus before contraction and prefers a surviving **œi*, with back-vowel restoration and subsequent English generalization of an unfronted paradigmatic alternant yielding **ā*. Paradigms with consistent **j* conditioning need not participate in that restoration (Fulk 1998, 143–45). This is not Campbell's completed-contraction argument in different terminology: it preserves a different intermediate and invokes paradigmatic levelling. Ringe and Taylor's warning that diphthong nuclei need not

behave like the plain short vowel likewise qualifies, rather than independently proves, Campbell's ordering (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–75). CAPR retains the conventional regular phonological scaffold; adopting Fulk's alternative would require a separate assessment of its conditioned alternations and the evidence for levelling.

Fulk's reconstruction demonstrates that several objections to shared Anglo-Frisian developments are not decisive under his premises, not that those developments have been proved inherited. His final displayed sequence is specifically Northumbrian, with qualifications for other English dialects, and is not a complete West Saxon chronology (Fulk 1998, 153). He explicitly calls his reconstruction biased toward the Anglo-Frisian hypothesis, finds no compelling reason for placing palatalization so early apart from that interpretation, and states that the hypothesis is not proved (Fulk 1998, 154). Those reservations are part of his conclusion, not objections supplied only by later critics.

The unstressed development `*ai > *ē` (in final and nonfinal syllables) is a separate and earlier Proto-Northwest Germanic change (SC014), discussed in Chapter 2; its corpus witnesses are the dative-singular endings of `span` (**spánnai* 'span' > *spanne* 'span') and `meed` (**mízdai* 'meed' > *meorde* 'meed').

4.9.4 Anglo-Frisian brightening (SC043, treated in Chapter 4)

The fronting of low **a* to **æ* outside nasal environments is traditionally called Anglo-Frisian brightening. The name does not establish one inherited event. It executes later in the cascade than the changes of this chapter, so its full section appears in Chapter 4; it is introduced here because it anchors the "Anglo-Frisian" label that names this period. Campbell gives the classical statement: "By a very early change Prim. Gmc. `a > æ` in OE and OFris. when not followed by a nasal consonant" (Campbell 1959, 52, §131). The traditional name also appears in modern comparative treatments; it does not independently establish a shared event (Fulk 2018, 72–73).

The change is notable for what follows it: OE Breaking presupposes the fronted input; OE a-Restoration partially undoes it in back-vowel environments. The three-change sequence is the conventional English working account, but its components and conditioning remain individually arguable. Versloot proposes restricted early fronting and late e-breaking; final forms can coincide under front-and-restore and never-front histories (Versloot 2026, 123, 125–28, 131–35).

Campbell notes that English and Frisian may not simply reflect one undifferentiated shared prehistoric event, and Ringe and Taylor leave open whether the wider spread of fronted outcomes happened mainly on the continent or in Britain (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 60–62). CAPR's implementation treats the stressed English component separately from the retained unstressed and final-vowel representations.

The completed ordinary stressed component is now characterized on the English daughter under Campbell's conventional working chain (Campbell 1939, 90–91; 1959, 52–53). Ringe and Taylor's diphthong-nucleus objection remains explicit (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–75); earlier restricted ancestral tendencies are not excluded. English plain-a/au process identity is distinct from inherited stem identity, and their current serialization is retained. The unstressed and final-vowel contributions are not assigned the same date from this argument. This local adoption does not select the complete ancestral inventory.

4.10 Cascade vs. historical order in this chapter

The sections follow executable serialization so that derivations are inspectable. That order is not an independently demonstrated total historical chronology. The broader final-z loss, later northern loss and rhotacism are distinguished by their actual environments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45; Crist 2002, 1, 4).

Earlier-stage proxies remain in this editorial corridor. The cluster change represented by SC022 PNWGmcMnDissimilation and final-n loss represented by SC023 PNWGmcNStemNLoss are classified as Common Germanic/Proto-Germanic despite retained name prefixes (Fulk 2018, 121; Ringe 2017, 101–3). The retired unstressed-o raising is not an active member. Book order, computational position and historical stage must remain separate.

4.11 West Germanic final *z-deletion

4.11.1 Historical discussion

Word-final *z in unstressed syllables was lost in Proto-West Germanic. Ringe and Taylor state the change for the whole branch and illustrate it with the nominative plural **dagōz* > **dagō* and the consonant-stem nominative **fadurz* > **fadur*, noting that the ending is lost after consonants as well as after vowels (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Crist's handout formulates the same development and its Ingvaeonic sequels (Crist 2002, 2, §§5–6). The change is pan-West-Germanic, not specifically Ingvaeonic: every West Germanic daughter shows the loss, and the Frienstedt comb inscription *kaba* < **kambaz* 'comb' (c. 250–300 CE) supplies early epigraphic confirmation (Fulk 2018, 25, n. 1).

The conditioning segment is specifically the voiced sibilant *z, never *s: Ringe and Taylor's near-minimal pair of nominative singular **dagaz* > **dag* beside genitive singular **dagas*, which keeps its sibilant into Old English *dæġes*, shows that the change reads the Verner voicing distinction (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 212, §6.1). Where the handbooks disagree about whether a given ending had **-s* or **-z* — as for the nominative plural **-ōz* — the disagreement matters directly to whether this rule applies (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 115–16, §4.2.1).

This is the middle of three historically distinct final-*z developments, and Ringe and Taylor explicitly separate it from the later loss in stressed monosyllables, citing Crist's demonstration that they are two changes (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Earlier, the consonant-stem (root-noun) nominatives of monosyllables had already generalized endinglessness before Proto-West Germanic (SC096 RootNounNomZLoss), so forms like **bōkz* 'book' never reach this rule with their marker intact. Later, and only in the north, *z was lost in stressed monosyllables with compensatory lengthening (SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss); the present rule leaves stressed monosyllables untouched. Older accounts that grouped all of these under one loss of final *z, such as Campbell's, are superseded by this three-way division (Campbell 1959, 166). Barrack's cascade stands closer to the older grouping: his rules 404a–e treat rhotacism and the losses and retentions of *z/R as one West Germanic family (Barrack 1975, 101–2), with the deletion of R after a vowel as rule 404c (Barrack 1975, 102), and he states final **a* syncope separately as West Germanic rule 331.4b (Barrack 1975, 78). His subdivision thus cuts the material differently from the three-way division adopted here; since his rule numbers are Campbell paragraph anchors and his orderings formal rather than chronological (Barrack 1975, 21, 34), the difference is one of analysis, not of additional evidence against the Ringe–Taylor–Crist sequence.

At the boundary with Chapter 2's Northwest Germanic sequence, the derivation of *ræste* 'rest' shows that final *ō-raising (SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising) must precede this rule: raising applies to **-ō* but not to **-ōz*, whose final vowel is still sheltered by the sibilant when raising runs (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 15–16, 24). On the later side, Ringe and Taylor order the loss of *z before the loss of word-final bare **-a*, since **dagaz* first becomes **daga* and only then **dag* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 45–46, §3.1.2).

4.11.2 SC020. West Germanic final *z-deletion (`EAFFinalZDeletion`)

```
define EAFFinalZDeletion Ctx([
    [{*z} -> 0 ||
    .#. ?* EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic | {*ô}] ?* _ .#.,
    .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]* EnglishStarVocalic+
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.]
]);
```

The rule deletes word-final *z in unstressed syllables, stated through two environments. The first clause covers polysyllables, where the final syllable of these corpus forms is unstressed: this is the ordinary case, with 110 corpus derivations, such as PGmc **bárdaz* 'beard' on its way to OE *beard* 'beard' and **rástōz* 'rest' on its way to *ræste* 'rest'. The second clause covers post-consonantal *z in monosyllables. By the time this rule runs, SC096 RootNounNomZLoss has already removed the genuine root-noun nominative endings, so the only form reaching the

second clause is **frījōndz* ‘friend’, contracted to monosyllabic **frīundz* by SC009 PWGmcIjContraction; its ending, like that of **fadurz*, stood in an unstressed syllable when the Proto-West Germanic change applied and so belongs here rather than to the root-noun development (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Stressed monosyllables ending in vowel plus **z* meet neither clause and are left for SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss.

The polysyllabic environment counts trimoric vowels as nuclei as well as bimoric vowels. Ringe and Taylor’s contrast between the trimoric nominative plural ending in **gebōz* and the bimoric genitive singular ending in **gebōz* requires loss of **z* in both, without merging their quantities: the former leads to OE *ġiefa* ‘gifts’, the latter to *ġiefe* ‘of a gift’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 59). The extra trimoric symbol in the first environment represents this quantity distinction; it does not extend the rule to stressed monosyllables.

The chronology of word-final **z*-loss is unusually well delimited: *ræste* ‘rest’ supplies its early boundary, while later weak syllables supply its late boundary.

Before SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising, PGmc **rástōz* ‘rest’ yields †*rast* rather than expected OE *ræste* ‘rest’. After SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering, PGmc **bébruz* ‘beaver’ yields †*befro* rather than expected *befer* ‘beaver’, PGmc **kwéðuz* ‘cud’ yields †*cwedo* rather than expected *cwedu* ‘cud’, and PGmc **félθuz* ‘field’ yields †*feldo* rather than expected *feld* ‘field’, alongside eight other newly failing rows. Final *z*-loss therefore follows SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising and precedes SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering.

The **rástōz* ‘rest’ derivation fixes the local relation to SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising. The distant boundary at SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering shows only that word-final **z*-loss precedes the later weak-syllable sequence; its placement within that wider interval follows the handbook chronology after final **ō*-raising.

4.12 Early apocope in unstressed words

4.12.1 Historical discussion

Alongside the regular loss of word-final short high vowels in third syllables (SC006 PWGmcEarlyIApocope), Ringe and Taylor identify a second, earlier apocope: “Short high vowels were also lost after heavy syllables in unstressed words” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58, §3.1.4). The two laws must not be conflated. Fully stressed disyllables kept their final **-i* long enough to cause i-umlaut — OE *ġiest* ‘guest’ < **gastiz* and *fȳr* ‘fire’ < **fūri* require exactly that survival (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 55, §3.1.4) — whereas words that carried no sentence stress lost the vowel already in Proto-West Germanic.

The conditioning is prosodic. Like Verner’s law, the change is governed by accent: it applied in words unstressed in the sentence, and its apparent exceptions are systematic, not sporadic. Forms such as OE *ymbe* ‘around’ and OHG *umbi* kept their final vowel because, as Ringe and Taylor observe, proclitics “were not phonologically word-final” and so stood outside the environment altogether (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58, §3.1.4). Sentence-level accent placement therefore decides which sandhi variant each daughter language continues, and doublets across the family reflect the stressed and unstressed sentence forms of the same word — regular sandhi, not lexical diffusion.

The diagnostic witness is the second-person plural pronoun. Ringe and Taylor print the Proto-West Germanic form as a doublet: PGmc **izwiz* (Gothic *izwis*) → **iwwi* (by SC008 PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation and the loss of final **z*, SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion) → PWGmc **iuwi* ~ **iuw* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, §3.1.1). Old English continues the apocopated, unstressed variant, and Ringe and Taylor’s proof is the vocalism itself: “OE iow ‘you (dat. pl.)’ definitely does [show early apocope] (since it does not exhibit i-umlaut)” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58, §3.1.4). Had the **-i* survived, i-umlaut (SC055 OEIUmlaut) would have fronted the diphthong; West Saxon *ēow* ‘you’ beside early West Saxon and Northumbrian *īow* ‘you’ shows the normal unumlauted development (Campbell 1959, sect. 702, p. 283).

4.12.2 SC098. Early apocope in unstressed words (PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope)

```
define PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope [
    [ [{*i}|{*u}] -> 0 || .#. {*ᵘ} ?* [
        [EnglishStarLongVowel | EnglishStarLongDiphthong] EnglishStarConsonant*
        | EnglishStarShortVowel EnglishStarConsonant EnglishStarConsonant+
    ] _ .#. ]
    .o. [{*ᵘ} -> 0]
    .o. [
        [{*ᶜ}:0 [EnglishStarAlphabet - {*ᶜ}]* 0:{*ᶜ}]
        | [EnglishStarAlphabet - {*ᶜ}]*
    ]
];
```

Sentence stress and phonological finality are now explicit, independently selected context. They do not alter the PGmc reconstruction, the selected segmental input or its historical stage. The computational marks in the rule distinguish weak-final context from weak-nonfinal context; they are not reconstructed phonemes and are absent from displayed forms. Ordinary evaluation explicitly chooses strong-final citation context. You selects the independently source-discussed weak-final variant, not an unstressed classification inferred from a pronoun label or missing acute.

The worked history is **izwiz* → **iwwiz* by assimilation → **iuwiz* by SC031 OEWWSimplification → **iuwi* by final *z*-loss → weak-final **iuw* by this rule → OE *ēow*. The operation requires a heavy syllable and a phonologically final short high vowel: long vowel/diphthong weight or a short vowel followed by a closing consonant cluster, not literal *ww*. Its condition therefore survives glide reanalysis. Loss of final *z* still feeds it, and removal of *i* bleeds SC055 OEIUmlaut. Its PWGmc placement precedes the later northern loss of stressed-monosyllabic final *z* (SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss) ((Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 55, 57–58)).

The staged strong contexts retain the high vowel in the histories of *ġiest* ‘guest’ and *fȳr* ‘fire’. A weak-final and context yields *and* ‘and’, whereas the proposed proclitic context retains the vowel in *ymbe* through the later apocope corridor. The right-boundary annotation is removed only after SC063 OEHighVowelApocope has had the opportunity to apply. These controls implement the defended exceptionless account; they do not claim direct observation of prehistoric sentence stress or lexical optionality ((Ringe and Taylor 2014, 55, 57–58)).

The corresponding English realization of *iu+w* belongs to SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling, not a late vocalization of retained *ww*. The model’s retained-i counterfactual produces an umlauted result after intervening w-loss; its exact terminal spelling is a computational prediction, not an attested strong OE form. The attested weak-final target and the source’s mutation argument must not be replaced by that counterfactual ((Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 57–58, 173–75; Campbell 1959, 283)).

4.13 Northern monosyllabic final **z*-loss

4.13.1 Historical discussion

Long after the Proto-West Germanic loss of final **z* in unstressed syllables (SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion), the northern West Germanic dialects lost word-final **z* in stressed monosyllables as well, with compensatory lengthening of a short nucleus. Ringe and Taylor’s witness set is OE *mā* ‘more’ < **maiz*, the pronouns *wē* ‘we’, *ġē* ‘you’, *mē* ‘me’, *þē* ‘thee’, *hē* ‘he’, *hwā* ‘who’ < **hwaz*, and — hedged in their own print with question marks — *cū* ‘cow’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1). The southern dialects retained the sibilant and rhotacized it: Old High German *mir*, *wir*, *mēr*, *er* answer the Old English endingless forms, which is why Fulk counts this loss among the diagnostic Ingvaeonic features (Fulk 2018, 18, n. 6). Ringe and Taylor explicitly treat this as a change separate from the Proto-West Germanic unstressed loss, citing Crist’s demonstration that the two must be distinguished (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1).

The scholarship disagrees about the exact conditioning, and the disagreement is worth recording. An older account, represented by Campbell and going back to Luick, derived the endingless pronouns from unaccented sentence variants rather than from a regular sound change (Campbell 1959, 166; Luick 1914–1940, 819). Ringe and Taylor reject that analysis because *mā* 'more' and *cū* 'cow' are not plausibly unaccented words (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1). Crist formulates an Ingvaeonic rule in which **z* is lost after front vowels, with compensatory lengthening, covering preconsonantal cases as well; his data contain no word-final back-vowel monosyllables, so forms like **hwaz* and the ancestor of *cū* fall outside what his statement can decide — a documented gap rather than a refutation (Crist 2002, 1, 4, §§1, 10). Kilday narrows the preconsonantal subcase to Old Saxon and Old Frisian while accepting the word-final monosyllabic loss for Old English, contrasting regular *meord* 'reward' with the loanword-influenced *mēd* 'reward' (Kilday 2024, 1–3). CAPR adopts Ringe and Taylor's quality-neutral formulation because it alone generates the back-vowel witnesses, while noting that the front-vowel forms are compatible with both analyses.

Apparent counterexamples are analogical, not phonological: OE *dēor* 'deer', *ār* 'oar', and *gār* 'spear' show final *-r* from levelling out of inflected forms where the sibilant was word-internal and regularly rhotacized, not from retention of word-final **z* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1, n. 24). The change precedes rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism), which Ringe and Taylor place last in this sequence of northern developments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87, §3.3.1).

The corpus now witnesses this change directly. The interrogative pronoun 'who' is selected in its nominative singular masculine cell, PGmc **hwaz* (Gothic *hwas*), precisely the form Ringe and Taylor cite for this loss (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1): the rule lengthens the short nucleus and deletes the sibilant, giving **hwā*, whence OE *hwā* 'who'. The resulting back vowel never undergoes Anglo-Frisian brightening — "**hwǣ* does not exist", as Campbell puts it (Campbell 1959, sect. 125, p. 49; Brunner 1965, sect. 137 Anm. 1, p. 129) — so the derivation ends with the attested form. Other members of Ringe and Taylor's witness set remain outside the corpus because it selects oblique or plural cells for them — 'cow' and 'meed', for instance, enter the cascade in inflected forms whose **z*, where present, is word-internal.

4.13.2 SC097. Northern monosyllabic final **z*-loss (MonosyllabicFinalZLoss)

```
define MonosyllabicFinalZLoss [
    {*a} -> {*ā}, {*á} -> {*ā},
    {*e} -> {*ē}, {*é} -> {*ḗ},
    {*i} -> {*ī}, {*í} -> {*ī́},
    {*o} -> {*ō}, {*ó} -> {*ṓ},
    {*u} -> {*ū}, {*ú} -> {*ū́}
        || .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]*
            _ {*z} .#.
] .o. [
    {*z} -> 0 ||
        .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]*
            EnglishStarVocalic+ _ .#.
];
```

The rule first lengthens a short nucleus standing immediately before word-final **z* in a monosyllable, then deletes the **z* after any vowel in a monosyllable. The principal synthetic controls run the change on Ringe and Taylor's own witnesses, fed to the rule in their chronologically correct intermediate shapes. Short-nucleus inputs show both halves of the change at once: **hwaz* yields **hwā* and **hiz* yields **hī*, each with loss of the sibilant and compensatory lengthening (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1). A form whose nucleus is already bimoric skips the lengthening step and simply loses the sibilant: **maiz* yields **mai* at this stage, with its diphthong intact; the attested OE *mā* 'more' arises only later, when the stressed monophthongization (SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization) takes **ai* to **ā*. The word 'cow', whose history Ringe and Taylor themselves print with question marks and whose analysis remains disputed, is deliberately not used as a principal control; a long-vowel input of that shape (**kūz* yielding **kū*) merely repeats what **maiz*

already demonstrates, and the word's evidentiary weight is discussed in the historical dossier rather than leaned on here.

The corpus derivation of *hwā* 'who' now fixes this rule's position empirically as well as philologically. It stands after SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion, since the two losses are historically distinct changes with the unstressed loss earlier (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism) follows in the executable cascade as in the historical account: Ringe and Taylor place rhotacism after this loss, at the end of the sequence of **z*-losses (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87, §3.3.1), and the cascade composes it immediately after this rule, so a sibilant removed here can never surface as *-r* — were the order reversed, **hwaz* would rhotacize to **hwar* and 'who' could never be derived; the negative controls below confirm this. Consonant-final monosyllables are untouched: their nominative **-z*, where it ever existed, was eliminated before Proto-West Germanic under SC096 RootNounNomZLoss. Word-internal **z*, as in PGmc **déuzą* 'deer' on its way to OE *dēor* 'deer', does not meet the environment of this rule and duly rhotacizes.

4.14 Monosyllabic lengthening before final *r*

The model admits Old English *þǣr* 'there' and *hwǣr* 'where' from source-supported short-*a* antecedents. Their quantity and the date of the lengthening remain qualified: the forms do not establish a Proto-Germanic date, and they do not determine the order of SC015 PNWGmcILowering.

4.14.1 SC112. Stressed monosyllabic lengthening before inherited final *r* (PNWGmcMonosyllabicFinalRLengthening)

```
define PNWGmcMonosyllabicFinalRLengthening [
    [
        {*á} -> {*ā},
        {*é} -> {*ē},
        {*í} -> {*ī},
        {*ó} -> {*ō},
        {*ú} -> {*ū}
        || .#. EnglishStarConsonant* _ {*r} .#.
    ]
];
```

The early working placement preserves inherited final *r* before rhotacism, so secondary *r* does not trigger the rule. The guard also excludes disyllabic forms. This is a general formalization of the two admitted witnesses, not a lexical exception list or a claim of strict relative chronology against SC015 PNWGmcILowering or SC024 PNWGmcLongELowering.

4.15 West Germanic rhotacism

4.15.1 Historical discussion

Bammesberger states that Germanic **z* yielded **r* in intervocalic position in Old English, while final **z* was generally lost (Bammesberger 1992, 39). Ringe and Taylor argue that this merger of **z* with **r* was independent in Norse and West Germanic and belongs after the Proto-West-Germanic stage (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 52, 98, 102). Crist likewise places rhotacism after earlier West Germanic **z*-deletion rules and rejects treating it as an inherited Proto-Northwest-Germanic innovation (Crist 2001, 104–6; 2002, 1, 4).

The internal identifier SC003 EAFRhotacism places the change in CAPR's Early Anglo-Frisian corridor, the operational post-Proto-West-Germanic stage on the English line; historically the change is a West Germanic rhotacism, later than Proto-Germanic. It is also distinct from SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion, which removes final **z* before the surviving medial consonant becomes **r*.

Barrack states the same complex as his 404 family: **z* becomes a rhotic R as Proto-Germanic rule 404a (Barrack 1975, 101), and R becomes *r* as West Germanic rule 404e (Barrack 1975, 102), with the deletions of R stated between them. His two-step treatment, in which an intermediate rhotic persists while the deletions apply, is structurally parallel to the ordering argument from

Crist adopted here, though he assigns the first step to Proto-Germanic where Ringe and Taylor argue for independent Norse and West Germanic mergers. He also registers the material directly relevant to this rule's *meorde* witness: his rule 404b, which he grades as resting on "very sporadic" evidence, deletes the rhotic before a voiced dental with compensatory lengthening and so derives *mēd* 'reward', while the alternate development that yields *meord* is referred to his rule 139zc (Barrack 1975, 101–2). His orderings are formal, not chronological (Barrack 1975, 34).

4.15.2 SC003. West Germanic rhotacism (`EAFRhotacism`)

```
define EAFRhotacism [
    {*z} -> {*r} || EnglishStarVocalic _ ?
];
```

Breaking supplies the decisive upper boundary. If rhotacism is delayed until after SC044 OEBreaking, PGmc **mízdai* 'meed' yields †*merde* rather than expected OE *meorde* 'meed'. Moving rhotacism earlier within the tested range changes no output.

The lexical evidence thus supplies a terminus ante quem but no terminus post quem. The lower boundary rests on the historical analyses cited above: Ringe and Taylor put rhotacism at the end of the sequence of **z*-losses — "first **z* was lost in a variety of environments …, then all surviving **z* became **r*" (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87, §3.3.1) — and Crist observes that the deletions distinguish **z* from **r* and so must precede the merger (Crist 2002, 2–3). The rule is accordingly ordered after the three final-**z* losses (SC096 RootNounNomZLoss, SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion, and SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss) and before breaking, so that the derivation follows the reconstructed chronology.

4.16 *mn*-dissimilation

4.16.1 Historical discussion

In the inherited *n*-stem paradigm the zero-grade oblique cells brought *m* and *n* into direct contact, and in that adjacent cluster the labial nasal dissimilated to a labial spirant: *mn* > *βn* (surfacing as *fn*). Old Norse preserves the older paradigmatic distribution, with the labial confined to the oblique cluster (*himinn* 'heaven' beside dative *hifni*); Old English and Old Saxon generalized it. Fulk treats the cluster change among developments common to Germanic, while warning that its surface results are irregular and that reverse *bn* > *mn* is later well attested in Northwest Germanic (Fulk 2018, 121, §6.11). The relevant *heofon* 'heaven' and *mōnaþ* 'month' material is discussed by Campbell (Campbell 1959, 189, 195, §§470, 484).

The underlying cluster change is therefore late Proto-Germanic / Common Germanic, not securely a pan-Northwest-Germanic innovation; `PNWGmc` remains a stable executable identifier only. The lexical evidence does not constrain a positive local cascade position.

4.16.2 SC022. Dissimilation of adjacent *mn* (`PNWGmcMnDissimilation`)

```
define PNWGmcMnDissimilation [
    {*m} -> {*β}
        || EnglishStarVocalic _ {*n}
];
```

The rule fires only where *m* stands directly before *n*. It supplies the labial of *stefn* 'stem, trunk' from the *mn*-cluster of the *stamn*-family, and it is the historical change behind the labial of *heofon* 'heaven', which was generalized from the oblique cluster into the vowel-bearing stem before the Old English vocalic changes. (An earlier cross-syllable formulation that labialized an intervocalic *m* before a later nasal has been retired: it simulated paradigm levelling rather than a sound law.)

Moving SC022 PNWGmcMnDissimilation earlier or later leaves every output unchanged. Its executable place in this holding zone is therefore editorial/computational, while its historical classification rests on the handbook account of *mn*-dissimilation.

4.17 Word-final *n*-loss

4.17.1 Historical discussion

The change isolated here is far older than its position in the cascade suggests: it is the general (pre-)Proto-Germanic loss of word-final **n*, with nasalization of the preceding vowel, in polysyllables. Ringe's proof set for the law spans the whole grammar — nouns such as **yugón* > **juką* 'yoke', pronouns such as **tón* > **þanǭ*, and even the verb form **dedǭ* 'I did' — so it is general phonology, not a fact about any one declension (Ringe 2017, 101–3). Gothic *tuggo* shares the weak nominative-singular outcome, and the nasalized reflex **-ǭ* remained contrastive into Proto-West Germanic before yielding OE *-e* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 54–55, 58–59).

Within the present corpus the change surfaces in exactly one shape: the weak nouns are cited in the stem form **-ōn-*, and this rule carries them to the Proto-Germanic nominative singular in **-ǭ*, as in **túngōn* > **túngǭ* > *tunge* 'tongue', alongside *eorþe* 'earth', *heorte* 'heart', *nǣdre* 'adder', and thirteen further weak nouns. The masculine weak nominative singular in trimoric **-ô* never had a final **-n* to lose, and Proto-Germanic **sebun* 'seven', **nigun* 'nine', and **tehun* 'ten' kept their *-n* by lexical analogy among the numerals (Ringe 2017, 103); the rule's narrow **-ōn* environment leaves all of these correctly untouched.

4.17.2 SC023. Loss of word-final **n* after **ō* (`PNWGmcNStemNLoss`)

```
define PNWGmcNStemNLoss [
    {*ō} {*n} -> {*ǭ} || _ .#.
];
```

The verb *dōn* 'do' supplies the negative, counterfeeding witness for the chronology. PGmc **dōną* 'do' passes this rule untouched; only SC047 OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope later strips the final **ą* and creates a new word-final **-ōn*. That secondary **-n* survives into *dōn* precisely because the old loss was no longer active: if SC023 PNWGmcNStemNLoss is displaced after the apocope, it consumes the new nasal and the derivation collapses entirely (+*?*).

The retained *-n* of *dōn* 'do' therefore supplies a terminus ante quem for the loss — it must be dead before the apocope — while the seventeen weak nouns above are its positive witnesses; the lower boundary remains unattested within the cascade, as befits a change already complete in Proto-Germanic.

4.18 Nasal-spirant lengthening

4.18.1 Historical discussion

Germanic lost nasal consonants before voiceless fricatives twice, in two changes that are easily confused because their outcomes look alike. Both replace a sequence of vowel, nasal and fricative with a long nasalized vowel and the fricative. They differ in date, in geography, and in which fricatives they affect.

The earlier change is common Germanic and is treated in the opening chapter of this book, on the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x*. Its results are shared by every daughter language, and only **a*, **i* and **u* occur in its input (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7).

The later change belongs to the dialects bordering the North Sea, that is to Old English, Old Frisian and Old Saxon, the group traditionally called Ingvaeonic. Here the groups **mf*, **ns* and **nþ* likewise reject the nasal with compensatory lengthening and nasalization (Campbell 1959, 47, §121; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11; Brunner 1965, 176, §186.1; Luick 1914--1940, 276, §301.1). Ringe and Taylor call it the most obvious phonological innovation of the northern dialects and list some thirty examples, among them **gans* 'goose' and **jugunþi* 'youth' (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 139–41). Campbell describes it as a later change similar to the common Germanic one, and Fulk as comparable to it; neither treats them as the same law.

The two are told apart by what the languages outside the North Sea area show. The common Germanic change left no nasal anywhere, so Old High German has *fūht* ‘damp’ and *fūst* ‘fist’ exactly as Old English does. The later change was confined to the north, so the cognates of its witnesses keep the nasal: Old High German *fimf*, *gans*, *ander*, *jugund* answer Old English *fīf* ‘five’, *gōs* ‘goose’, *ōþer* ‘other’, *ġeoguþ* ‘youth’. On this test **funhsti-* ‘fist’, whose long vowel is shared by Old High German *fūst*, Dutch *vuist* and German *Faust*, belongs to the earlier change and not to the North Sea law at all (Kroonen 2013, 160).

Where the vowel was **a*, the long nasalized vowel that this law produced was afterwards rounded to *ō* in Anglo-Frisian, which is why Old English has *gōs* ‘goose’, *tōþ* ‘tooth’ and *ōþer* ‘other’. That rounding is a third change again, and it is the same rounding that gives *fōn* ‘seize’ and *þōhte* ‘thought’ from the common Germanic law and *mōna* ‘moon’ and *spōn* ‘chip’ from inherited long *ā* before a surviving nasal; Campbell states that it reached all three sources at one and the same time (Campbell 1959, 50, §128 n. 1; Brunner 1965, 33, §26; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). It is treated in the chapter on the rounding of the long nasalized low vowel. That the vowel was rounded and did not simply merge shows that its nasality survived the law that created it: as Fulk observes, it did not fall together with the *ā* that came from **ai* (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1). Ringe and Taylor take the nasalization to have remained subphonemic until it was lost separately in each daughter (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 141). Old Saxon shares the loss of the nasal and the nasalization, and rounds only variably, which is why the law itself is described as North Sea Germanic and the rounding as Anglo-Frisian (Campbell 1959, 47, §121; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11).

The North Sea Germanic law is a single connected sound change: in every handbook account the nasal is lost *with* compensatory lengthening, and the lengthening is the compensation for the loss. It is stated here as two rules only because the vowel must be adjusted while the conditioning nasal is still present, before the nasal can be removed. The order of SC026 EAFNasalSpirantLengthening before SC027 EAFNasalSpirantLoss is a requirement of the statement, not evidence for two successive historical stages.

Barrack’s cascade concurs on both the geography and the two-law distinction. He states the North Sea development as Ingvaeonic rule 121, locating it in the Old English and Old Frisian area with Old Saxon retaining free variation, and cites *ōþer* among his witnesses (Barrack 1975, 44); he orders it explicitly after his Proto-Germanic rule 119, the common Germanic nasal loss before the velar fricative (Barrack 1975, 42–44). Two differences of framework apply: he models the change as a window of free variation rather than a categorical law (Barrack 1975, 21–23), and his orderings are formal rather than chronological (Barrack 1975, 34).

4.18.2 SC026. North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law, first step (EAFNasalSpirantLengthening)

```
define EAFNasalSpirantLengthening [
    {*a} -> {*ã} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,
    {*i} -> {*ī} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,
    {*u} -> {*ū} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,
    # Stressed variants (*á -> *ã: stress absorbed into length, no stressed
    # long low tier exists):
    {*á} -> {*ã} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,
    {*í} -> {*ī} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,
    {*ú} -> {*ū} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant
];
```

The environment is nasal plus **f*, **þ* or **s*. The fricative **x* is excluded: nasal loss before **x* is the earlier change stated as SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX. Campbell names the groups **mf*, **ns* and **nþ*, Fulk says the change affects **mf*, **ns* and **nþ*, Sievers and Brunner name the fricatives **f*, **þ* and **s*, and no example in Ringe and Taylor’s list contains **x* (Campbell 1959, 47, §121; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11; Brunner 1965, 176, §186.1; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 139–41). As in the earlier change, only **a*, **i* and **u* occur. The outcome of **a* is the long nasalized **ą̄*, which SC104 EAFNasalizedLowRounding later rounds; the outcomes of **i* and **u* are written **ī* and **ū*, their nasality having no further consequence (Campbell 1959, 47, §121).

Two witnesses apply in the present corpus. PGmc **gánsz* ‘goose’ becomes **gą̄ns* ‘goose’, and PGmc **júgunθ* ‘youth’ becomes **júgūnθ* ‘youth’. In *ġeoguþ* ‘youth’ the syllable carrying the lengthened vowel is unstressed, and the length is given up again by the later shortening of unstressed syllables; Sievers and Brunner note the same course in *beraþ* ‘they carry’ from **beranþi* ‘they carry’ through **berōþ* ‘they carry’ (Brunner 1965, 176, §186.1 Anm. 3; Luick 1914–1940, 276, §301.1).

If lengthening is stated after the loss of the nasal, it can no longer read its conditioning environment. The vowel must therefore be adjusted before that nasal is removed. This is an executable dependency within the statement of one historical change, not a date for either component. The earlier experiment’s youth output also depended on the retired early glide-insertion architecture; it is not a current historical boundary.

4.19 Nasal-spirant loss

4.19.1 SC027. North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law, second step (EAFNasalSpirantLoss)

```
define EAFNasalSpirantLoss [
    EnglishStarNasal -> 0 || _ EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant
];
```

The nasal is removed in the environment that conditioned the lengthening, giving **gą̄s* ‘goose’ and **júgūθ* ‘youth’. The rule completes the statement of the single change begun in SC026 EAFNasalSpirantLengthening; the two are not independent sound laws. The converse test, stating the loss first, merely reproduces the same two wrong forms. Nothing in the material fixes a later boundary for the loss.

4.20 The hiatus-breaking *w* of the verba pura

4.20.1 Historical discussion

The small class of Germanic strong verbs whose roots ended in a vowel, the *verba pura*, reached Northwest Germanic with a morphologically expected hiatus. Ringe and Taylor reconstruct Proto-Germanic **sēaną* ‘to sow’ (Gothic *saian*), which the Northwest Germanic lowering of **ē₁* carried to **sāaną*; the West Germanic languages then “exhibit innovative consonants that eliminated” the hiatus (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 12). The repair differs by branch, and the difference dates and localizes the change. Old English and Old Frisian inserted *w*, as in Old English *sāwan* ‘to sow’ and Old Frisian *sāwinge* ‘sowing’ beside *grōwinge* ‘growth’, while Old Saxon and Old High German used *j* (*sāian* ‘to sow’, *sāen* ‘to sow’, *sājen* ‘to sow’) (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 12, 151). The insertion of *w* is therefore an Anglo-Frisian development and the consonant of *sāwan* is not inherited; it must not be projected back into the protoform.

The origin of that *w* is neither inherited nor morphological. Þórhallsdóttir, in the standard treatment of the problem, rejects in turn the derivation of the West Germanic *w* from a Proto-Indo-European *u*-perfect (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 115–17), from a **ue/o*-present (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 117–19), and from the transfer of a preterite *w* into the present (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 121–22). The *w* “rather has an inner-Germanic phonological explanation” (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 136). It began as an ordinary phonetic glide filling the hiatus, and it began in one narrow environment, before **u*. The cells in question, as Bremer had already seen, are the first singular and first plural of the present indicative together with the plural of the reduplicated preterite in **-um*, **-uþ*, **-un* (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 120). Þórhallsdóttir sets out the pre-Old English present indicative with the hiatus still intact, first singular **sā’u*, second **sā’is*, third **sā’iþ*, first plural **sā’um*, second plural **sā’iþ*, third plural **sā’anþ*, and observes that “the glide *w* was a natural hiatus filler before the *u* of the endings of the 1st person singular and plural” (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 127). The preterite stem **seuwun* arose by the same insertion before the **u* of the plural endings (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 126).

From those few cells the *w* was carried through the whole paradigm by analogy. Three forces converge. Levelling proceeded out of the **u*-cells themselves; the preterite stem **seuw*, **seuwun*

"would have assisted in extending the new *w* to all forms of the present paradigm" and to the preterite participle; and verbs with an etymological **w*, above all *flōwan* 'to flow' from the root **pleu-*, exerted their own attraction (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 127). The result, complete already in pre-Old English, is the uniform pattern **sāwan*, **seuw*, **seuwun*, **sāwan-* (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 136). Old Frisian inherits the same generalized type, so that its *w* and the Old English *w* are one Anglo-Frisian event (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 130, 134). The scattered *w*-forms of Old High German are a separate and later inner-German development and are not to be identified with it (Þórhallsdóttir 1993, 119, 123).

This layering matters for how the rule below should be read. Old English citation forms are infinitives, and the infinitive **sā'an* is precisely one of the cells that never received *w* by the phonological rule, so the *w* of *sāwan* 'to sow' is analogical. The rule therefore models the outcome of the generalization, and its environment, any vowel after *ā*, is a citation-form proxy for a paradigm-wide result. It is not a reconstruction of the conditioning of the original insertion.

The chronology is fixed on both sides by Ringe and Taylor. The *w* must postdate the West Germanic loss of intervocalic **w*, or the new glide would itself have been swept away (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151, n. 9); and it "must have occurred early enough to prevent fronting of **ā*" in pre-Old English (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151). The whole reason *sāwan* 'to sow', *cnāwan* 'to know', *blāwan* 'to blow', and *māwan* 'to mow' keep their back vowel is that the *w* was already in place when the North Sea Germanic fronting applied. Since it is the generalized *w* that stands in the infinitive, this later boundary constrains the generalization itself. The rule accordingly stands before the fronting in the cascade, even though on the present corpus the two orders happen to produce the same outputs, since the fronting rule as implemented does not touch a prevocalic *ā* in any case; the ordering encodes the historical chronology, and no corpus-internal contrast demonstrates it. That chronology rests on Ringe and Taylor alone, for Þórhallsdóttir's chapter nowhere discusses the fronting of **ā* and supplies no independent evidence for the order.

4.20.2 SC102. Generalized hiatus-breaking *w* after long *ā* (EAFHiatusWInsertion)

```
define EAFHiatusWInsertion [
    [..] -> {*w} || {*ā} _ EnglishStarVocalic
];
```

The rule is fed by SC024 PNWGmcLongELowering, which creates the *ā*-initial hiatus it repairs; **séaną* 'to sow' passes through **sāaną* to **sāwaną* on its way to *sāwan* 'to sow'. Displaced before the lowering, the rule can never apply, since the root vowel is still **ē* and no hiatus after *ā* exists, and the derivation loses its consonant altogether.

Its output in turn feeds the blocking environment of SC101 EAFLongAFronting: the inserted *w* is precisely what shields the *ā* of *sāwan* 'to sow' from fronting, as treated in that chapter. The corpus carries *sāwan* as the diagnostic witness of the class; *cnāwan* 'to know', *blāwan* 'to blow', *māwan* 'to mow', *wāwan* 'to blow (of wind)', and *þrāwan* 'to turn' instantiate the same derivation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151).

4.21 North Sea Germanic nasalization of long *ā* before a nasal

4.21.1 Historical discussion

In the dialects along the North Sea coast the long low vowel **ā* — centrally the vowel produced from **ē₁* by the Northwest Germanic lowering — was nasalized when a nasal consonant followed and survived. The nasalized vowel was afterwards rounded in Anglo-Frisian, which is why Old English has *mōna* 'moon', *mōnaþ* 'month' and *spōn* 'spoon' against Old High German *māno* 'moon', *mānōd* 'month', *spān* 'spoon' and Old Norse *máni* 'moon', *mánaðr* 'month', *spánn* 'spoon'. Campbell describes the split of Germanic *ǣ*[1] before nasals in these terms and identifies the vowel that the rounding operated on as a nasalized and unrounded **ą̄* [Campbell (1959), p. 50, §127; p. 50, §128 n. 1]. Fulk places the rounded outcome of **ǣ* before nasals among the Anglo-Frisian changes and derives it from an earlier nasalized vowel (Fulk 2018, 72–73, §4.12).

The nasalization and the rounding have different geographies, and separating them resolves an apparent disagreement in the handbooks. Ringe and Taylor state that stressed low vowels were nasalized in the northern West Germanic dialects, Old Saxon among them (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2); Old Saxon accordingly shows *ōdar* ‘other’ and *sōd* ‘true’ beside unrounded *quān* ‘wife’ and *sāno* ‘immediately’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 150–51). What Old Saxon shares is the nasalization; what it shares only in part is the rounding, and for the vowel inherited from Proto-Germanic it does not share the rounding at all (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). The nasalization stated here is therefore North Sea Germanic, and the rounding treated in the chapter on the long nasalized low vowel is Anglo-Frisian.

The nasalization is the conditioned counterpart of the fronting of oral **ā* treated in the fronting chapter: a following nasal gives nasalization and eventual rounding, and its absence gives fronting. Together the two exhaust the fate of the old low vowel in this area. The comparative material does not order the two branches against each other, and no such ordering is claimed here.

4.21.2 SC025. Nasalization of long *ā* before nasals (EAFLongANasalRounding)

```
define EAFLongANasalRounding [
    {*ā} -> {*ã} || _ EnglishStarNasal
];
```

The rule consumes the **ā* created by SC024 PNWGmcLongELowering: displacing the lowering after this rule leaves the nasalization without an input, and **mḗnōθz* ‘month’ surfaces as †*mānaþ* in place of OE *mōnaþ* ‘month’, **spḗnuz* ‘spoon’ as †*spān* in place of *spōn* ‘spoon’. Its output is consumed in turn by SC104 EAFNasalizedLowRounding, which supplies the rounded vowel that the two words actually show.

Equally important is what the rule must precede. The monophthongization of **ai* in SC004 EAFAi-Monophthongization creates a new long *ā*, and that vowel was never nasalized and never rounded before nasals: *stān* ‘stone’ and *hām* ‘home’ keep *ā*. Stating the monophthongization before this rule makes the new vowel eligible for nasalization and hence for rounding, and the cascade then wrongly yields †*stōn* and †*hōm*. This is the same chronological inference Campbell draws for the fronting: the treatments of the old low vowel were complete, or at least under way, before *ai*-monophthongization supplied a new one (Campbell 1959, 52–53, §132; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–70).

4.22 Anglo-Frisian rounding of the long nasalized low vowel

4.22.1 Historical discussion

Three separate developments described in earlier chapters end in the same sound: a long, nasalized, low vowel. The oldest is the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x*; the second is the North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law; the third is the nasalization of the inherited long *ā* before a nasal that survived. In Old English and Old Frisian all three surface as *ō*, and Campbell states the unification without qualification: the nasalized vowel became identical with the *ō* inherited from Proto-Germanic already in prehistoric Old English, and the same change affected the nasalized vowel of the Proto-Germanic law and the nasalized vowel of the Ingvaeonic law at one and the same time (Campbell 1959, 50, §128 n. 1). One later sound change therefore accounts for all three, and the appearance of three independent roads to *ō* is an illusion created by looking only at the Old English surface.

That the intermediate vowel was nasalized and unrounded is shown by a form in which it was shortened very early. Campbell’s example is *samcucu* ‘half alive’, where the shortened reflex is *a* and never *o*; the vowel that the earlier laws produced was therefore a nasalized **ą̄*, and the rounding is a distinct and later event (Campbell 1959, 50, §128 n. 1). Sievers and Brunner describe the same nasalized long vowel and its rounded Old English outcome [Brunner (1965), p. 33, §26; p. 58, §64].

The geography is Anglo-Frisian. Old Saxon nasalized its stressed low vowels along with the rest of the northern West Germanic area (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2), and it shares the loss of the nasal in both of the earlier laws; the categorical, systematic rounding, however, it does not share. For the Proto-Germanic nasalized low vowel Old Saxon retains *ā* consistently, and for the vowel created by the nasal-spirant law it has *ā* or *ō* according to word and dialect, while Old English and Old Frisian have *ō* throughout (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). That partial and lexically variable Old Saxon rounding is comparative evidence bearing on the innovation rather than participation in it. Ringe treats the rounding as a parallel development of the diverging northern dialects and locates it in the northernmost of them, that is in Anglo-Frisian (Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2). Luick groups the whole set of changes among those peculiar to the Anglo-Frisian dialect group and notes that the nasalized vowel later gave up its nasality (Luick 1914--1940, 276, §301.1). The rounding is accordingly Anglo-Frisian, and the nasalization that feeds it is the wider North Sea Germanic property.

Ringe and Taylor confirm that a single rounding covers all the sources: the rounding affected the nasalized low vowels of the nasal-spirant law, the nasalized low vowels of the accompanying list, and the reflexes of Proto-Germanic **/anh/* alike (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2). The condition on the input is nasality and nothing else, which is why the long *ā* that Old English later won from **ai* escapes: that vowel was oral, and it came into being after the rounding had run its course. Fulk makes this the central argument for the long survival of the nasality, since the nasalized vowel developed to *ō* and did not fall together with Old English *ā* from **ai* (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1).

4.22.2 SC104. Rounding of the long nasalized low vowel (EAFNasalizedLowRounding)

```
define EAFNasalizedLowRounding [
    {*ã} -> {*ō}
];
```

The rule is unconditioned, since the vowel it operates on exists only where one of the three earlier changes created it. Its inputs arrive from SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX, from SC026 EAFNasalSpirantLengthening and from SC025 EAFLongANasalRounding, and each of those three stands in a feeding relation to it: stated before any one of them, the rule leaves that source's nasalized vowel untouched and the cascade returns no form at all for its witnesses.

Four lexemes in the present corpus reach Old English through this rule, and between them they witness all three sources. **gánsz* 'goose' arrives as **gą̄s* 'goose' from the North Sea Germanic law and gives *gōs* 'goose'; **mḗnōθz* 'month' arrives as **mą̄nōþ* 'month' and gives *mōnaþ* 'month'; **spḗnuz* 'spoon' arrives as **spą̄nu* 'spoon' and gives *spōn* 'spoon'. The Proto-Germanic law contributes **θánxtē* 'thought', the preterite of the verb 'to think', which arrives as **θą̄xtē* 'thought' and gives *þōhte* 'thought'. That is the very form cited for this rounding, beside Old Frisian *thochte*, and it is the evidence that the vowel did not fall together with the *ā* of *stān* 'stone' (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Campbell 1959, 44, §119). The other firing of the Proto-Germanic law, the high vowel of *fȳst* 'fist', does not reach this rule at all.

The counterpart is what the rule leaves alone. **stáinaz* 'stone' and **xáimaz* 'home' acquire their long *ā* from SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization, which follows this rule, and their vowel was never nasalized; they surface as *stān* 'stone' and *hām* 'home'. Placing the monophthongization before the nasalization and the rounding makes that vowel eligible and the cascade then yields †*stōn* and †*hōm*, which is the chronological inference Campbell draws for the treatments of the old low vowel generally (Campbell 1959, 52–53, §132; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–70).

4.23 North Sea Germanic fronting of long *ā*

4.23.1 Historical discussion

Long after the Northwest Germanic lowering of **ē₁* to **ā*, the dialects of the North Sea coast fronted the surviving oral **ā* to a low front vowel: West Saxon *ǣ* in *dǣd* 'deed', *slǣpan* 'to sleep',

lǣtan ‘to let’, *rǣdan* ‘to read’, and *mǣl* ‘meal’, against Anglian, Kentish, and Old Frisian *ē* (*dēd* ‘deed’, *slēpa* ‘to sleep’, *jēr* ‘year’) (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 146–50; Campbell 1959, 50–51, §128). Old Saxon and Old High German keep the back vowel (Old Saxon *dād* ‘deed’, Old High German *tāt* ‘deed’, *slāfan* ‘to sleep’, *lāzan* ‘to let’), but sporadic Old Saxon spellings in ⟨e⟩ show that the fronting lapped unevenly into Old Saxon territory (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 150). The change is therefore a North Sea Germanic development rather than an exclusively Anglo-Frisian one, though only Old English and Old Frisian carry it through systematically.

The fronting affected stressed, non-nasalized **ā*; nasalized **ą̄* was instead rounded, as treated in the rounding chapter. Ringe and Taylor further establish a conditioning by a following **w*. Before **w* plus a back or non-high vowel the **ā* was retained: the clearest witnesses are the *verba pura* — *sāwan* ‘to sow’, *cnāwan* ‘to know’, *blāwan* ‘to blow’, *māwan* ‘to mow’, *þrāwan* ‘to turn’ — together with *clāwu* ‘claw’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151); the simplest hypothesis, which Ringe and Taylor adopt from Hogg, is that fronting never occurred in that environment (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151; Hogg 1992a, 81). Before **w* plus a high front vocalic, by contrast, the fronting did apply: **lēwijaną* ‘to betray’ (Gothic *lēwjan* ‘to betray’, Old High German *gilāen* ‘to betray’) yields West Saxon *lǣwan* ‘to betray’, and the same environment appears in *eltǣwe* ‘entire’ and *brǣw* ‘eyelid’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 150). Both sides of the condition are encoded in the rule below and witnessed in the corpus. Bennett states the retaining environment independently from the West Saxon evidence alone, and slightly more broadly: West Saxon “shows *ǣ* as a regular isolative development of IE *ē* but has *ā* before *w* or *g* plus a back vowel”, with the paradigmatic alternation *wǣg* ‘wave’ beside plural *wāgas* ‘waves’ (Bennett 1950, 235, n. 6). The rule below encodes the *w* environment, for which the corpus supplies witnesses on both sides; the parallel *g* environment is left for separate treatment.

Whether this fronting restored a front vowel that had earlier been backed, or whether — as Fulk argues — the North Sea dialects simply retained an old front **ǣ* that was never backed at all, is the same dispute recorded in the lowering chapter (Fulk 2018, 60–61, §4.6; Campbell 1959, 50–51, §§128–129). On the retention analysis this chapter’s change dissolves into the non-event of staying put; the present model follows Ringe and Taylor’s two-step reconstruction, on the strength of the runic evidence for an early [a:] and the place-adverbs *þǣr* ‘there’ and *hwǣr* ‘where’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 13–14).

4.23.2 SC101. Fronting of long *ā* outside nasal and *w* environments (EAFLongAFronting)

```
define EAFLongAFronting [
    {*ā} -> {*ǣ} || _ [EnglishStarConsonant - EnglishStarNasal - {*w}],
    {*ā} -> {*ǣ} || _ {*w} EnglishIUmlautTrigger
];
```

The first clause fronts **ā* before any oral consonant other than **w*; the second admits the fronting before **w* exactly when a high front vocalic follows. The two corpus witnesses of the *w* condition form a minimal contrast. **sḗaną* ‘to sow’, whose hiatus-filling *w* is supplied by SC102 EAFHiatusWInsertion, reaches this rule as **sāwaną* and is left unfronted, surfacing as *sāwan* ‘to sow’; were the *w*-block removed, the cascade would deliver †*sǣwan* instead. **lḗwijaną* ‘to betray’, whose inherited *w* is followed by **i*, is fronted by the second clause to **lǣwijaną* at this rule’s own stage — before, and independently of, the much later i-umlaut — and surfaces as *lǣwan* ‘to betray’. The rule consumes the **ā* created by SC024 PNWGmcLongELowering; displaced before the lowering, it has nothing to front, and **skḗpą* ‘sheep’ surfaces as †*sċāp* rather than OE *sċēap* ‘sheep’, **jḗrą* ‘year’ as †*ġār* rather than *ġēar* ‘year’, **slḗpaną* ‘to sleep’ as †*slāpan* rather than *slǣpan* ‘to sleep’.

Two later boundaries carry real historical content. First, the fronting must precede the completion of SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization: the *ā* that arose from **ai* was never fronted — *stān* ‘stone’, *hām* ‘home’, *lāþ* ‘hostile’, *rāp* ‘rope’, *tācn* ‘token’, *gāst* ‘spirit’ all keep the back vowel. Campbell draws exactly this chronological inference (Campbell 1959, 52–53, §132), and Ringe and Taylor endorse it as cogent (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–70); in the present cascade the inference is enforced by rule order, and displacing the fronting after the monophthongization

wrongly yields †*lǣþ*, †*rǣp*, †*tǣcn*, †*sǣwol*, and †*ġēast*. Historically the two changes may well have overlapped in time; the discrete ordering is the grammar's way of stating that inherited *ā* had been fronted before the new *ā* arose.

Second, the fronting must precede SC056 OEWsPalatalDiphthongization, which operated on the already-fronted vowel: *ǣ* > *ēa* after the palatals, as in *sċēap* 'sheep' and *ġēar* 'year' (Campbell 1959, 69–70, §185; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–16, §6.5.1). Displaced after the diphthongization, the cascade yields †*sċǣp* and †*ġǣr* instead.

5 Chapter 4. From Anglo-Frisian to Old English

5.1 Historical interval

This chapter follows the English daughter from the required Anglo-Frisian ancestor through prehistoric English to attested Old English. It includes changes earlier than the manuscript period, not merely changes within it. West Saxon is the principal target; each comparison still requires its actual dialect, paradigm cell and evidential status.

5.2 Scope and dialect variation

Not every change in this chapter has pan-Old-English scope. Some changes — most notably ordinary West Saxon palatal diphthongization and parts of the back-mutation history — are specifically West Saxon or more broadly southern Old English phenomena. The diphthong corridor also represents earlier West Germanic feeders; a West Saxon final outcome does not date every feeder to West Saxon (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 171–73, 215–17). (The West Saxon palatal-glide spellings, SC016, belong to the written surface of Old English and are treated in Chapter 5.)

The CAPR derivations target West Saxon Old English citation forms as the default comparator. Changes that belong to other dialects, or that are absent from West Saxon, may appear in lexical entries as comparanda rather than as derivational steps.

The distinction between West Saxon and Anglian comparanda requires the actual text and dialect, not merely a regional label. Hogg discusses the limits of the traditional divisions and the evidence for the principal textual varieties (Hogg 1992a, 3–8, §§1.5–1.12).

5.3 Chapter structure

The changes in this chapter fall into several natural historical subgroups, though the boundaries between them are not always sharp:

Prehistoric English contraction and fronting: Completed stressed **ai* > **ā* is now adopted on the English daughter in SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization. The new long vowel is distinguished from inherited oral long vowels; the source milestones allow overlap with their earlier restructuring (Campbell 1939, 90–91; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–71). This placement leaves possible conditioned ancestral onset and the runic interpretation qualifications explicit (Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318).

Early Old English changes linked to the Anglo-Frisian inheritance: Changes that feed directly on, or are closely related to, Anglo-Frisian brightening (SC043), whose section follows the earlier vowel developments at its adopted executable position in this chapter. The **awj* resolution, **au* fronting and diphthong operations currently execute before ordinary-a brightening. They cannot be described as consuming its output. Their histories combine earlier glide reanalysis with English diphthong realization (Campbell 1959, 44–47; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 65–66, 171–73). The conventional breaking/restoration account instead presupposes fronted **æ*. English plain-a/au process identity and inherited stem identity remain separate questions.

A coordinated formalization of ordinary **a* fronting and **au* fronting with its completion has now been tested over the selected lexical material. Its twenty au paths wait until the ordinary fronting corridor and then converge with the current derivations before breaking. This establishes computational compatibility, not historical event identity. The production serialization remains unchanged, and the unstressed and surviving-long-final fronting components are not dated from this test. The completed ordinary stressed component is now independently characterized on the English daughter. Its English-episode interpretation remains explicitly dependent on its contraction and nucleus premises (Campbell 1939, 90–91; 1959, 52; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–75).

The earlier unstressed contribution is not the complete unstressed law: SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly separately implements fronting before heterosyllabic nasals, whereas the coda-nasal history protects other endings (Campbell 1959, 140–41). The retained final-vowel helper

connects unrounding's carried quantity to later shortening and merger; it does not establish an independent historical long-a fronting (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 58–59, 299–300).

Old English consonantal changes: Velar palatalization (SC052), palatalization of *sk (SC051), j-cluster coalescence (SC057), and related changes produce the characteristically Old English consonant phonemes. Hogg discusses these as OE consonant changes with class-specific conditions and chronology (Hogg 1979, 90–111).

Old English i-umlaut and its context: The i-umlaut changes vowels under a following high front vocoid; paradigm alternations are evidence for that phonological conditioning, not grammatical conditions on the law (Campbell 1959, 69–72, §§190–197; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 222). Ordinary West Saxon palatal diphthongization precedes mutation in the handbook account, while the later treatment of some mutation products after *sċ* follows it (Fulk 2018, 74; Campbell 1959, 68–69; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–17, 235). The adopted cascade now places the ordinary component before mutation and retains the late approximation afterward. Gift enters with the earlier-raised vowel, following Ringe's explicitly PGmc reconstruction (Ringe 2017, 135, pp. 151–153). Its lexical section discusses the published e-alternatives and the confidence in this choice.

Syncope, apocope and weak-vowel quality: Mutation precedes the ordinary high-vowel losses: a subsequently lost **i* has already fronted the root, as in *fȳlþe* 'filth'. The former conventional working sequence distinguished ordinary nonhigh syncope (SC114), high-vowel apocope (SC063) and heavy/open high-vowel syncope (SC065). The adopted quantitative account instead gives SC063 one final/medial operation, preserving heavy–light–light *hēafudu* 'heads' and distinguishing the following-heavy *nētna* 'of livestock'. Early medial shortening belongs to SC072 through its separate component SC117; SC065 remains only a trace anchor (Fulk 2010, 129–34, 140–42; Goering 2016, 186–88; 2023, 67–68). These are prehistoric Old English changes, not simply late literary reductions toward Middle English. The former dental and heavy pre-**l* fragments implement the same high-vowel event and are no longer separate active deletions. Later light-syllable pre-**l* loss (SC066) retains its own consonant and openness conditions (Hogg 2011, 220–27, §§6.14–6.25; Brunner 1965, 132–33, §159; Luick 1914--1940, 310–11, §336).

The trisyllabic analysis remains disputed: Fulk's conservative Mercian evidence, Ringe and Taylor's syncope-before-apocope account, and Hogg's tentative phonological alternative are discussed with SC063. Early weak front-vowel unrounding and later lowering are distinct quality processes (SC074), linked to transmitted mutation under SC055, not additional syncopes. The early unrounding support component is printed at SC115; its separately positioned stress decoder is technical. Ordinary nonhigh loss now also removes compound **a*; the former early proxy (SC037) is an identity trace anchor. Positional realization of inherited **b* is computed afterward (SC049) without postnasal hardening of existing fricatives or a newly dated lenition law (Hogg 2011, 29–30, §§2.53–2.54, p. 219, §6.10; Campbell 1959, 179–81, §§444–448).

Across this chapter the densest independent parallel is Barrack's West Saxon cascade, whose focus — West Saxon to the beginning of the eleventh century (Barrack 1975, 19) — coincides with the present target. His statements most relevant here include velar palatalization as rule 170a (Barrack 1975, 57); back umlaut as rules 210 and 220 (Barrack 1975, 63–66); the *weor-* > *wur-* development as rule 320, his showcase for progressively widening environments (Barrack 1975, 75–76, 23–25); high-vowel apocope and syncope of originally long vowels as rules 345 and 358 (Barrack 1975, 85–91); and, among the late consonant adjustments, *sk*-metathesis in *fiscas*/*fixas* 'fishes' as rule 440b (Barrack 1975, 113), the *bringþ*-type dissimilation as 477a (Barrack 1975, 123), stop fortition of the *fint*-type as 481.1 (Barrack 1975, 124–25), and the nasal assimilation of *efn* > *emn* 'even' as 484d (Barrack 1975, 127). On r-metathesis (rule 459.1) he records that the relative order of breaking and metathesis varies by dialect in the *beornan*/*birnan* 'to burn' family (Barrack 1975, 115–17), a conditioning-relevant observation held for separate adjudication in the Barrack dossier. His orderings are formal, not chronological (Barrack 1975, 34), and are cited here as corroborating statements of conditioning, never as dating evidence.

5.4 The English partial chains

The working historical scaffold has several connected chains, not one uniquely demonstrated total order. Their evidential strength differs. An explicit handbook derivation, a contrast

between original and secondary vowels, and the survival of a modeled output are not interchangeable arguments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–73, 215–37; Hogg 1979, 100–110).

Historical relation	Evidence and interpretation	Limitation
Coronal assimilation before inherited ww reanalysis	Four and the second-person pronoun have assimilated inputs to vocalization	Does not date every j-created geminate
Inherited-long restructuring before completed ai contraction	New ai-derived long a escapes inherited-long fronting	Temporal overlap is possible
Completed ai contraction before ordinary short fronting	Conventional Campbell chain	Depends on the diphthong-nucleus premise
Ordinary fronting before breaking/restoration	Conventional English reconstruction	Never-fronted and restored outputs can coincide
Breaking before ordinary palatal diphthongization before mutation	Broken inputs and worked handbook vowel histories	Does not date every consonantal palatal layer
Mutation before the later sc treatment	Ai-derived mutation products such as sheath	Exact later conditioner remains unresolved
Initial productive palatal cutoff before mutation-created fronts	Unrounded mutation vowels are the stronger controls	Medial fricative merger is a separate problem

The first three relations are supported and qualified by the earlier vowel accounts (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 170–73; Campbell 1939, 90–91). The palatal and mutation relations require their own evidence (Luick 1914--1940, 162–63; Fulk 2018, 74; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–17, 235; Hogg 1979, 100–110). The table states the defended historical targets; it does not claim that every present executable proxy already realizes them faithfully.

5.5 Early glide history and the English outcome

The diphthong corridor includes inherited ww, assimilated ww and geminates created later before j. These inputs must be distinguished before assigning one date to their long-vowel outputs. Ringe and Taylor describe inherited glide reanalysis separately from the English realization of its products (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 171–73). The model now separates the earlier reanalysis from English realization.

Witness	Adopted earlier checkpoint	Later English outcome	What it tests
Four	Assimilated ww is reanalyzed as eu plus w	fēower ‘four’	Assimilation feeder and retained glide
Hew	Inherited a plus ww gives au plus w	hēawan ‘hew’	Reanalysis distinct from English realization
You	Vocalized iu plus w with a surviving final i before apocope	ēow ‘you’	Prosody/apocope compatibility, not merely quantity
Hue	Later j-gemination creates a distinct glide input	hīew ‘hue’	Negative control for the earlier inherited-ww subset
Hay	Later awj history remains separate	hīeġ ‘hay’	Gemination and secondary glide resolution

These are existing lexical witnesses, not new corpus admissions. The current spelling differences also require their actual dialectal interpretation (Campbell 1959, 44–47; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 57–58, 171–73). The reconstructed West Saxon strew target is a computational control, not an additional attested form.

The completed decomposition replaces the old consonantal-ww apocope proxy with the historical condition: a short final high vowel after a heavy syllable in a sentence-unstressed, phonologically final word. You selects that weak-final context independently of its unchanged PGmc reconstruction. Thus **iuwi* loses the final vowel to give **iuw* before mutation. A proclitic context retains the vowel, as in *ymbe* 'around'; weak-final *and* 'and' and stressed *ġiest* 'guest' / *fȳr* 'fire' check the positive and negative conditions (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 55, 57–58; Campbell 1959, 283).

The computational retained-i counterfactual for you yields a predicted †*īei*, not a source-backed strong Old English spelling: the existing w-loss before i intervenes before mutation. It tests the represented alternative context, not an additional attestation. Unmarked evaluation explicitly selects strong-final citation context; absence of an acute is never used to infer sentence stress. All selected final outputs remain unchanged.

The later realization paths are now explicit. Chew, dew, four, hew and you complete their earlier products through SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling. SC033 OEEwLongDiphthong supplies the separate j-created offglide reanalysis for *hīew* 'hue'. The selected input is inherited PGmc **xíwją*; its path is **xíwwją* to **xíuwją*, then long **xīowją* through SC110 OEJGlideIO, before mutation gives the West Saxon long *īe* reflex. Ringe and Taylor explicitly give the inherited i and long-io chain while leaving its phonemic analysis unclear (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 53, 250). Orel's and Kroonen's e reconstructions are real alternatives, and Fulk disputes traditional geminate dismantling; these qualifications are discussed in the lexical account (Orel 2003, 171–72; Kroonen 2013, 224; Fulk 2018, 59, 71–72). Knee instead selects the regular dative *cneowe* 'knee (dat.sg.)': its short pre-ending diphthong comes from SC044 OEBreaking, not singleton lengthening. The long endingless *cnēo* 'knee' and analogically restored final *w* in *cnēow* 'knee' remain a separate paradigm comparison; later long obliques must not be confused with the selected short cell (Campbell 1959, 232–33; Hogg 2011, 21–22, 86; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 187–88, 387). SC111 PWGmcEndinglessAw now supplies straw's regular endingless **strau*, feeding ordinary English realization to reconstructed **strēa*. The comparison remains attested *strēaw* 'straw': its restored final *w* belongs to paradigm levelling, so this regular derivation explicitly mismatches the target. The sources mark the free regular simplex and short obliques as unattested; the compound *strēaberige* 'strawberry' is not substituted for the selected noun (Campbell 1959, 232–33; Brunner 1965, 49, 110; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172–73, 387). SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong retains only the three show cells as a disclosed proxy. Dictionary singleton stems and the inherited-geminate handbook analysis remain distinct, unresolved premises (Orel 2003, 337; Kroonen 2013, 442; Campbell 1959, 45; Brunner 1965, 49). The unchanged SC106 OEJWWSimplification remains a technical compatibility operation, but hue now reaches it with singleton w and no longer feeds it. The before-j placement of early reanalysis is a representative serialization, not a new strict historical chronology claim (Campbell 1959, 45–47; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 65–66, 171–75).

5.6 Ordinary fronting, breaking and restoration

The preferred conventional account identifies ordinary non-nasal short-a fronting and fronting of au's first element as one English episode. The later offglide development is distinct. Early spellings record the fronted element, but do not measure the simultaneity of two laws (Campbell 1939, 91; 1959, 52–53; Luick 1914--1940, 130–31). English episode identity is not inherited Anglo-Frisian event identity. Nor does it identify the stressed-short process with every unstressed or long-final clause in the present model.

Breaking then has vowel, quantity, consonantal and dialectal conditions. Restoration in a following back-vowel environment can remove a previously fronted vowel. A final restored vowel alone cannot distinguish that history from original blocking of fronting (Hogg 1979, 90–97; Versloot 2026, 104, 123). The conventional account is retained as the working baseline because of the combined argument, not because the more elaborate intermediate path is inherently preferable.

Versloot's late Anglian alternatives must be compared in their exact domains. His mutation-created e argument and the unbroken neighboring environments are relevant to a restricted e-breaking component, not to a wholesale postmutation relocation of every West Saxon breaking law (Versloot 2026, 126–28, 131–35). A different dialectal target cannot be silently substituted for a West Saxon lexical target. Similarly, Frisian closed-syllable breaking is not English rC breaking merely because both are called breaking (Bremmer 2009, 33–35, 37).

Fulk likewise distinguishes the later Frisian process from English breaking. His Northumbrian restoration-before-breaking account differs from the usual English ordering illustrated by *slēan* 'slay'; it cannot replace the West Saxon sequence merely because the final vowels coincide (Fulk 1998, 150–53). Chapter 3 compares his broader reconstruction and its explicit limits on shared inheritance.

5.7 Palatal consonants and the key–day problem

The useful chronological contrast is between original conditioning fronts and front vowels created by mutation. Rounded mutation products alone may support a weaker conclusion, a cutoff before later unrounding. Unrounded mutation-created fronts more directly test whether initial velar palatalization was still productive (Hogg 1979, 100–103; Laker 2007, 167–68). This cutoff does not by itself date assibilation or every earlier articulatory tendency.

Hogg's key and day paradigms identify the disputed merger premise. The initial key consonant survives a mutation-created unrounded front vowel; the day paradigm does not show the mutation that would follow if its new medial palatal element were already equivalent to inherited j. These statements concern particular historical cells, not arbitrary exceptions to a sound law (Hogg 1979, 102–10).

Diagnostic	Required distinction	What is not established
Key oblique vowel	Original fronts versus mutation-created fronts	Date of all palatal articulation
Day oblique vowel	Inherited j versus a palatal fricative at mutation	Unanimous agreement on merger timing
Geminate/postnasal g	Stop-class history versus singleton fricative	One universal g-to-j change
h	Breaking trigger versus subsequent palatal/weakening history	Identity with voiced-fricative chronology
sk	Own consonantal law versus later sc vowel treatment	A single combined palatalization event

Hogg considers several resolutions without endorsing one as demonstrated (Hogg 1979, 103–11). Ringe and Taylor, however, explicitly adopt merger after mutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 204). CAPR now implements that regular working account, preserving Hogg's phonetic objection rather than claiming consensus. Singleton g is a fricative, including initially; gg/ng are stops (Fulk 2018, 130–32).

At Hogg's pre-palatal, pre-OE checkpoint, key has **kājœ* and day **dœɣœ*. The inherited j in the former causes mutation, producing **kājœ* without reactivating initial-k palatalization. In the latter, the newly palatal fricative remains ʝ and the vowel stays æ: **dœʝœ*. Native realization then gives *cǣġe* 'key' and *dæġe* 'day' (Hogg 1979, 105; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 204). Premature merger instead supplies a j trigger and wrongly raises the day vowel. These oblique cells are non-corpus diagnostics, not new selected PGmc reconstructions; the existing day nominative cannot substitute for them.

The complete key suffix exposed a second defect: unrestricted inherited-j normalization would erase its retained glide. The repaired SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization excludes non-high long front monophthongs. Its residual weak-suffix normalization is a telescoped representation, not a universal historical VjV vocalization law (Hogg 2011, 283–86; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 228).

The fricative merger has its own visible SC109 OEPalatalFricativeMerger. Its late execution after suffix raising is a tested computational holding zone, not a precisely proved historical date. Likewise stop ʧ/ʤ are eventual-reflex proxies, not early affricate claims. Cluster coalescence and a dotted written reflex cannot identify all these classes as one historical sound (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–4; Laker 2007, 167–68; Fulk 2018, 131–32).

5.8 Three different mutation and diphthongization arguments

Guest, sheath and gift do not establish the same chronological relation. The guest derivation passes through ordinary palatal diphthongization before mutation in both the handbook account and the adopted model. The former model raised a simple vowel before diphthongizing it. Both paths reach *ġiest* 'guest', so their final agreement does not select the earlier path (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 216).

The following worked comparison abstracts from consonant notation and retains the vocalic trigger where it matters. For guest, the source starts with PGmc **gastiz* 'guest', continued as PWGmc **gasti* 'guest'. The vowel history is **a* > **æ* > **ea* > **ie*; final loss of the trigger follows the mutation it caused (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 216, 287).

Checkpoint	Handbook and adopted guest path	Superseded modeled guest path
Ordinary fronting	Short a becomes æ	Short a becomes æ
After palatal conditioning is established	Original front vowel is available to ordinary PD	Original front vowel is available, but PD remains later
First disputed vowel operation	æ becomes ea by ordinary PD	æ becomes e at mutation
Second disputed vowel operation	ea becomes ie at mutation	e becomes ie in the bundled PD proxy
Written result	ġiest 'guest'	ġiest 'guest'

The agreement in the last row is precisely why the intermediate rows must be tested. This table does not treat the implementation's palatal-consonant symbol as proof of a uniquely dated phonetic merger (Hogg 1979, 103–10).

Witness	Source-supported distinction	Present model consequence
Guest	Ordinary palatal diphthongization feeds mutation	Adopted æ > ea > ie replaces the output-equivalent old path
Sheath	Ai-derived ā mutates; a later sc layer can affect its product	Its unchanged late clause is separately retained as an approximation
Gift	Earlier inherited e-to-i raising is distinct from English mutation	Selected PGmc i is outside ordinary diphthongization
Sheep/year	Ordinary palatal diphthongization without a mutation trigger	Controls for the ordinary component
Cow/lung	Mutation changes the productive consonantal environment	Controls for cutoff, not diphthongal mutation

For sheath, *sċēaþ* 'sheath' beside *sċēþ* 'sheath' belongs to the separately described later group. Reporting both outcomes does not authorize lexical optionality in the law; the exact phonological layer and conditioner still require a defended specification (Campbell 1959, 68–69; Ringe

and Taylor 2014, 235). The incremental repair preserves the literal late clause as a visible approximation, not a lexical exception or a newly established conditioner.

The sheath comparison instead follows the ai-derived long vowel: **ai* > **ā* > **ǣ*, with the final step supplied by mutation. The separately discussed later sc treatment can then give **ēa*. The vowel available to the earlier ordinary process and the vowel created later by mutation are therefore different historical inputs, which the adopted model now separates (Campbell 1959, 68–69; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 235).

For gift, Ringe reconstructs PGmc **giftiz* 'gift', with the Old English plural *ġifta* 'wedding', and describes the earlier raising separately (Ringe 2017, 135, pp. 151–153). Ringe and Taylor explicitly distinguish that early change from the much later English vowel history (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 220). The selected input now follows that earlier-raised reconstruction. The choice is lexical and source-led, not a new raising rule justified by output fit. Orel and Kluge–Seebold print e-vowel alternatives (Orel 2003, 130; Kluge 2011, 359); the lexical section compares their evidence with the e-grade presentations and Ringe's qualified PGmc dating rather than claiming unanimous agreement.

5.9 Quantity, reduction and the written surface

Later apocope and syncope depend on prosody and syllable structure; earlier input conventions and surviving triggers must be inspected before their effects are used as dates for other changes. Morphological cells provide evidence for such environments, not grammatical conditions on phonological rules (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–59, 299–300). Inherited quantity, compensatory lengthening, diphthong quantity and later shortening must likewise remain separate dimensions.

The transition to Chapter 5 is a transition to the written surface, not proof that an orthographic change is a newly dated sound change. A single spelling can represent different historical consonant inputs, and a changed spelling need not change the phonetic derivation. The source discussions and worked lexical entries distinguish implemented laws from working reconstructions and localized unresolved components.

5.10 Executable serialization and unresolved interfaces

Sections follow executable order to make derivations inspectable, not because that serialization proves a unique total history. Final agreement can conceal different intermediate paths. Some proxies execute here with earlier historical classifications; renaming identifiers would not resolve that substantive distinction:

- SC041 (PWGmc Final Bare-*a Loss) and SC042 (Surviving Bimoric *ō Unrounding) carry Proto-West Germanic labels but execute in this stretch of the cascade.
- SC064 (NWGmc *-n Stem *n Loss) carries a Northwest Germanic label but executes after OE High-Vowel Apocope (SC063).
- SC049 (PGmc B Allophony) carries a Proto-Germanic label but executes here.

5.11 Sources

Campbell's *Old English Grammar* is the primary source for the dating and scope of individual changes in this chapter (Campbell 1959, 52–72). Hogg provides critical reassessments of palatal conditioning and its relative chronology (Hogg 1979, 90–112). Ringe and Taylor supply the most detailed relative-chronology analysis for the earlier portion of the chapter, through backmutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–73, 215–37). Fulk's *Comparative Grammar* provides additional coverage for phonological conditioning (Fulk 2018, 58–61, 72–74). For individual changes, source-specific citations appear in the relevant sound-change sections.

5.12 Awj resolution and the English brightening of au

Two changes stand between the Proto-Germanic diphthong **au* and its Old English reflex *ēa*. The earlier one repairs a West Germanic gemination and restores a diphthong that the gemination had obscured. The later one fronts the first element of every **au*, whether inherited or newly created, and belongs with Anglo-Frisian brightening.

The two are separate developments with separate domains. The first concerns a handful of words in which **w* stood before **j*. The second concerns the whole Old English history of **au*, for which *lēaf* 'leaf', *strēam* 'stream' and *brēad* 'bread' are ordinary witnesses, and to which the first change merely adds two more inputs.

5.13 Post-velar w-loss and loss of w before final i

The first rule is a narrow loss of **w* after velars in the **ngw* sequence. Ringe and Taylor derive PGmc **singwan* 'sing' to Old English *singan* 'sing' (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 214, §6.4.2). This comparative evidence establishes the change, although no lexical evidence fixes its order relative to a neighboring rule.

The second rule is historically more legible. Campbell notes the recurring loss of **w* before **i* in unstressed position (Campbell 1959, 167, §406). Ringe and Taylor trace the development of *sǣ* 'sea' from earlier **saiwi-* / **sawi-* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 257, §6.7.1), and Luick gives the same trajectory in his own historical grammar (Luick 1914--1940, 173, §187). The first rule is restricted to the **ngw* sequence; the second has a specific lexical witness and defined earlier and later limits.

5.14 I-umlaut and West Saxon palatal diphthongization

Luick gives the change its traditional scale:

> Der wichtigste Fall von palataler Beeinflussung … war die Veränderung der urenglischen Vokale durch i oder j der Folgesilbe.
>
> (Luick 1914--1940, 166–67, §182)

Campbell gives the most compact classical formulation in English when he writes that "the process known as i-umlaut or i-mutation operates on practically all the sounds which it could theoretically affect in OE" (Campbell 1959, 69, §190). He immediately defines the core conditioning environment as a following `i` or `j`, and he goes on to trace the consequences across much of the vowel system, including forms such as *giest* 'guest', *giefan* 'give', *hierde* 'shepherd', and *ieldra* 'older' (Campbell 1959, 69–72, §§190–197).

Hogg continues in the same vein: "we come now to a change which is almost as uncontroversial as it is important" (Hogg 1992b, 113). His examples, such as *bryd* 'bride', *trymman* 'strengthen', *bedd* 'bed', *ciest* 'chest', and *wiersa* 'worse', likewise emphasize that the change is a broad redistribution of vowel quality across the Old English vowel system (Hogg 1992b, 113–14).

The narrower palatal-diphthongal material is described differently. Ringe and Taylor treat West-Saxon diphthongization after initial palatals as a distinct process (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215, §6.5.1), and Fulk is even more explicit about its chronological delicacy when he calls it "diphthongization by initial palatal consonants (which precedes front umlaut but not breaking)" (Fulk 2018, 74, §4.13). Ringe and Taylor's examples such as *gieldan* 'pay', *scield* 'shield', and *scieppan* 'create' show that this narrower process is triggered by already palatal consonants and leads to specifically West-Saxon diphthongal outputs (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–16, §6.5.1).

Luick, Campbell, and Hogg treat i-umlaut as a system-wide change. Ringe and Taylor and Fulk distinguish from it a narrower West-Saxon process affecting words after initial palatals. The two changes act in different environments and produce different lexical consequences.

Two further distinctions are essential to their relative chronology. First, the raising of inherited Germanic **e* to **i* before a following high front vocoid is much earlier than Old English i-umlaut. Ringe reconstructs PGmc **giftiz* 'gift', with OE plural *ġifta* 'wedding', and discusses that earlier

raising separately (Ringe 2017, 135, pp. 151–153). Ringe and Taylor likewise caution that raising of inherited **e* occurred hundreds of years before the Old English changes; a later repetition is rare and doubtful (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 220). The selected gift input now has the earlier-raised vowel. Its lack of ordinary diphthongization therefore does not date the general West Saxon process. Published e-reconstructions remain genuine alternatives (Orel 2003, 130; Kluge 2011, 359); the lexical discussion compares their evidence and explains the attributed working choice.

Second, the ordinary diphthongization of inherited/fronted non-high vowels must be distinguished from the later treatment of some mutation products after *sċ*. Campbell separates that small group from his general front-vowel diphthongization: the group includes *sċēaþ* 'sheath' beside *sċǣþ* 'sheath' (Campbell 1959, 68–69, §§184–185). Ringe and Taylor explicitly place the treatment of the ai-derived mutation product after mutation, giving the same two sheath outcomes (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 235). Their ordinary West Saxon derivations, including *ġiest* 'guest' and *ċytel* 'kettle', instead pass through palatal diphthongization before mutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–17, 222).

The historically preferred working account therefore has ordinary palatal diphthongization before Old English mutation, with the separately evidenced later *sċ* treatment after it. The adopted cascade separates these operations: ordinary diphthongization precedes mutation, and the unchanged late approximation follows it. The sources' alternate spellings do not by themselves supply an exceptionless conditioning law for the later group; its full conditioner remains unresolved.

5.15 English stressed ai contraction

5.15.1 Historical discussion

Inherited stressed **ái* yields **ā* in English. Ringe and Taylor discuss this development separately from the earlier unstressed contraction. The distinction between inherited long vowels and new **ā* requires inherited-long fronting to have been well under way before contraction completed; it does not prove that the two developments could not overlap (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–71). Campbell gives the stricter conventional sequence and places contraction before ordinary short-vowel fronting (Campbell 1959, 52–53). Later i-mutation of the new long vowel is a separate conditioned development, not that ordinary fronting (Campbell 1959, 69).

Versloot proposes a wave account of the regional outcomes, but CAPR does not adopt diffusion as a solution to the comparative tree problem. His readings of early English and Frisian inscriptions are relevant evidence independently of that mechanism, conditional on their provenance, etymology and phonetic interpretation (Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318). The required Anglo-Frisian ancestral node is retained. CAPR places completed English contraction on the daughter branch, while leaving a possible earlier conditioned onset on the common stem distinct. This is the defended working placement under the cited runic and comparative premises, not proof against every ancestral onset (Campbell 1939, 90–91; Versloot 2017, 295–97, 318). The inherited-long relation permits temporal overlap; the retained executable order does not assert a strict order between entire events.

The live selected-corpus census has twenty-three applications, all carrying stressed **ái*. Loam's selected **láimą* 'loam' is explicitly a pre-Old-English model input, not an independent Proto-Germanic witness. The raw corpus's additional roe reconstruction has no attested target and is excluded from that census. The unstressed development **ai* > **ē* is the separate earlier change SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization.

5.15.2 SC004. English stressed ai contraction (`EAFAiMonophthongization`)

```
define EAFAiMonophthongization Ctx([
    {*ái} -> {*ā}
]);
```

The soul form fixes the relation to interstress raising. If the monophthongization is delayed until after that change, PGmc **sáiwalō* ‘soul’ yields †*sāwel* rather than expected OE *sāwol* ‘soul’. An earlier placement changes no output. This shows that SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization must come before SC036 OEInterStressRaising in the modeled sequence.

The unstressed development **ai* > **ē* in final and nonfinal syllables is a separate and earlier change; see SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization.

5.16 Resolution of awj

5.16.1 Historical discussion of the resolution of **awj*

Old English *hīeġ* ‘hay’ and *strīeġan* ‘strew’ go back to forms in which **w* preceded **j*. West Germanic doubled every consonant except **r* before **j* after a short syllable, and **w* was an ordinary member of that law (Campbell 1959, 167, §407). Proto-Germanic **hawja-* therefore appears as West Germanic **hauuj* (Campbell 1959, 46, §120.2). Campbell writes the sequence as *auj* > *auuj* > *auj*, with the diphthong restored before the Old English developments begin.

Ringe and Taylor reach the same result and explain why it is possible (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 53, §3.1.3). They find the gemination of **wj* clearest where the preceding vowel was **i*, as in Proto-Germanic **niwjaz* ‘new’ and **siwjaną* ‘sew’, which give Old Saxon and Old High German *niuwi* and *siuwen*. Gemination was reversible, since it merged nothing and altered no underlying form, so the sequence Northwest Germanic **awj* to West Germanic **[aw'w']* to pre-Old English **[auj]* can have run its course and then undone itself. Their derivations give Proto-Germanic **hawja* through **hauj-* to *hīeġ* ‘hay’, and Proto-Germanic **strawjaną* through **straujan* to Anglian *strēgan* ‘strew’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 173).

The strongest comparative argument for the doubled stage comes from paradigms in which some cells had **j* in the ending and others had **i*. Only the first group could double, and the two outcomes then sat side by side. Old High German has *hewi* ‘hay’ beside *houwi*, and Old English itself preserves both in one word, *glīg* ‘mirth’ from the undoubled nominative beside *glīowes* ‘of mirth’ in the genitive (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 53, §3.1.3). The continental forms *houwi* and *gistrouwen* ‘bestrew’, and Old Saxon *hoi* ‘hay’, point to the same West Germanic stage, which English alone went on to resolve (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 173).

The resolution did not treat every doubled **w* alike, and the difference is what allows the doubling to be seen apart from it. Campbell sets the two vowel types side by side: *auj* becomes *auuj* and then *auj*, while *iuj* becomes *iuuj* and then *iuj*. Thereafter they part company, since the *u* of *auuj* is generally lost while the *j* of *iuuj* is lost (Campbell 1959, 46, §120.2). Old English *hīeġ* ‘hay’ and *hīew* ‘form, hue’ begin from shapes that differ in a single vowel and end with different survivors. *Hīeġ* keeps its **j*, written *ġ*, while *hīew* keeps its **w*. Campbell’s other examples of the second type are *nīowe* ‘new’, *nīewe* ‘new’ and *glīow* ‘mirth’, *glīw* ‘mirth’.

One qualification belongs in the record. Fulk holds that **w* was never consonantal here, so that Proto-Germanic already had **straujaną* with its diphthong in place and there is no gemination to undo (Fulk 2018, 73, §4.10 n. 1). The account followed here is the handbook one, which the comparative material supports: the doubled stage that the continental and paradigm-internal forms point to is precisely the one Fulk denies ever existed. Both accounts agree that **auj* is what enters Old English, and the disagreement concerns whether a discrete change took place.

5.16.2 SC029. Resolution of **awj* to **auj* (`OEAwwjResolution`)

```
define OEAwwjResolution Ctx([
    {*á} {*w} {*w} {*j} -> {*áu} {*j},
    {*a} {*w} {*w} {*j} -> {*au} {*j}
]);
```

The change is confined to the **a* type. PGmc **xáwją* ‘hay’ is doubled to **xáwwją* by the West Germanic law and then resolved to **xáują*, and PGmc **stráwjaną* ‘strew’ is doubled to **stráwwjaną* and resolved to **stráujaną*, yielding *hīeġ* ‘hay’ and *strīeġan* ‘strew’ once the later diphthong

changes and *i*-umlaut have applied. PGmc **xíwją* ‘form, hue’ is doubled by the same law, and there the doubling holds: it passes through this change untouched and surfaces as *hīew* ‘form, hue’.

The resolution has to precede SC030 OEAuBrightening, since the fronting needs a diphthong to work on. Ringe and Taylor state the same dependence when they observe that these new instances of **au* went on to share the ordinary development (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 173).

5.17 English brightening of au

5.17.1 Historical discussion of the brightening of **au*

The fronting of **au* is the application to a diphthong of the same process that fronts plain **a*, the process usually called Anglo-Frisian brightening. Campbell arrives at the point while establishing the order of the early vowel changes, remarking that the normal development of Proto-Germanic **au* to Old English *ēa* shows that the change of *a* to *æ* would affect the first element of a diphthong (Campbell 1959, 52, §132). His ordered list accordingly places West Germanic *a* > Old English *æ* and West Germanic **au* > Old English **æu* in one and the same step. Fulk puts it in a single sentence, saying that this fronting of *a* applied also to the diphthong *au* in Old English (Fulk 2018, 73, §4.12).

The intermediate stage is directly attested. Ringe and Taylor describe **au* as first tensed and fronted to **æu*, a spelling still found occasionally in eighth-century documents, with the offglide unrounded and lowered only later (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172). Early spellings such as *Eadbald* with an initial *aeo* preserve the rounded offglide, and the rounding survives in late Northumbrian (Fulk 2018, 73, §4.12). The outcome of the whole sequence is the *ēa* of *dēaþ* ‘death’, *ēage* ‘eye’ and *lēaf* ‘leaf’ (Campbell 1959, 53, §135).

The geographical reach of the diphthongal fronting is narrower than that of the plain one. Old Frisian shows no such fronting and has *ā*, so that Old English *ēac* ‘also’, *ēage* ‘eye’ and *bēam* ‘tree’ stand against Old Frisian *āk* ‘also’, *āge* ‘eye’ and *bām* ‘tree’ (Fulk 2018, 73, §4.12; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172). A later change supplies independent confirmation. Old English *gēac* ‘cuckoo’ has a palatalized initial, which requires a front vowel to have followed it, while Old Frisian *gāk* ‘cuckoo’ has none (Fulk 2018, 73, §4.12). Brightening of plain **a* is shared with Frisian; brightening of the first element of **au* is English.

5.17.2 SC030. Brightening of **au* to **æu* (`OEAuBrightening`)

```
define OEAuBrightening Ctx([
    {*au} -> {*aeu},
    {*áu} -> {*áeu}
]);
```

Most of the words that pass through the change carry **au* inherited straight from Proto-Germanic. PGmc **láubą* ‘leaf’ gives *lēaf* ‘leaf’, PGmc **stráumaz* ‘stream’ gives *strēam* ‘stream’, PGmc **bráudą* ‘bread’ gives *brēad* ‘bread’, and PGmc **dráugmaz* ‘dream’ gives *drēam* ‘dream’. Where a following **j* or **i* survives long enough to cause *i*-umlaut, the *ēa* appears in West Saxon as *īe*, as in *ġelīefan* ‘believe’ from PGmc **galáubijaną* ‘believe’ and *nīed* ‘need’ from PGmc **náudiz* ‘need’ (Campbell 1959, 46, §120.2). The two words supplied by SC029 OEAwwjResolution, *hīeġ* ‘hay’ and *strīeġan* ‘strew’, join this second group.

The proportions matter for what the rule is. This is the general Old English treatment of **au*, to which the resolution of **awj* contributes two further inputs; the history of *hīeġ* ‘hay’ and *strīeġan* ‘strew’ does not define it.

The fronted **æu* has no independent life. It is taken up at once by the SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling, which lowers the offglide and delivers *ēa*. Ringe and Taylor give that order explicitly when they place the tensing and fronting first and the unrounding and lowering later (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172).

5.18 Short pre-w diphthongs and the j-created glide chain

5.18.1 Historical discussion

Ordinary diphthongization before singleton *w* must be distinguished from long diphthong formation in endingless forms and from the independently created *wwj* sequences. Their similar Old English spellings do not establish one sound law assigning long quantity before every retained vowel ending.

For *cneowe* ‘knee (dat.sg.)’, the regular pre-ending stem has short *eo*. Hogg explicitly identifies the dative as a short-diphthong example, and Campbell and Luick distinguish its genitive and dative from the long endingless form (Hogg 2011, 21–22, 86, §§2.33, 5.22; Campbell 1959, 232–33, §584; Luick 1914--1940, 139, §134). Ringe and Taylor likewise distinguish short *cneow-* before syllabic endings from long endingless *cnēo* ‘knee’. The final *w* of *cnēow* ‘knee’ is generalized from the obliques, not retained by an unrestricted prevocalic lengthening law (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 187–88, 387, §§6.2.4, 7.2.4).

The selected comparison is therefore the dative *cneowe*, from the constructed PGmc dative **knéwai*, while citation **knéwą* remains the lexeme-level reconstruction. Fulk prefers the **-ai* analysis for the West Germanic dative line but discusses alternatives; the complete selected input is a paradigm construction, not a quotation of a whole-word reconstruction (Fulk 2018, 147, §7.8).

Its short diphthong is supplied by SC044 OEBreaking, with the source’s exclusion before a following high front vocalic. Long quantity could later spread from endingless forms into obliques, but that leveling is not the selected short dative’s sound-law history. Campbell describes the extension; Ringe and Taylor qualify the knee quantity inference because decisive verse evidence is elusive (Campbell 1959, 233; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 387).

Earlier inherited-glide reanalysis is independently represented by SC031 OEWWSimplification. Chew, dew, four, hew and you complete its products through SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling. The operation below neither repeats that inherited event nor implements the regular singleton history (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 171–75).

5.18.2 SC033. J-created palatalized-glide reanalysis (`OEEwLongDiphthong`)

```
define OEEwLongDiphthong Ctx([
    {*i} {*w} {*w} -> {*iu} {*w} || _ {*j},
    {*í} {*w} {*w} -> {*íu} {*w} || _ {*j}
]);
```

Hīew ‘hue’ enters with inherited PGmc **xíwją*, following Ringe and Taylor’s explicit **hiwją*. Their palatalized geminate develops through **iuw* before the separately realized long diphthong. The conditioner is palatalized *w*, carried here as *ww+j* and subsequently *w+j*; this does not assert a second independent phoneme where the authors leave the phonemic analysis unclear (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 53, 250).

Orel’s **xewjan* and Kroonen’s **heuja-* remain competing e reconstructions, not earlier stages invented to reconcile the authors. Their derivational explanations differ. The realized-i choice uses the inherited raising account, not a later hue-specific law (Orel 2003, 171–72; Kroonen 2013, 224; Ringe 2017, 151–53; Fulk 2018, 59). Campbell supports the contrasting *iwj* outcome, but Fulk questions traditional geminate dismantling and its consonantal premises. The detailed lexical account preserves those objections (Campbell 1959, 46; Fulk 2018, 71–72, 126).

The stable component now supplies offglide reanalysis, not long quantity. Singleton *iwj*, nonpalatal *iww*, unraised *ewwj* and the separate low-vowel *awj* history are excluded. Knee remains a short singleton-w comparison. No exact historical date or independent confidence is fabricated for this support encoding.

5.19 Technical support: j-created glide compatibility

5.19.1 SC106. Retained j-created glide compatibility (OEJWWSimplification)

```
define OEJWWSimplification Ctx([
    {*w} {*w} -> {*w} || _ {*j}
]);
```

The unchanged technical operation remains composed for compatibility. Hue's reanalysis already leaves a singleton glide, so it no longer feeds this simplification. Absence of a current application does not establish universal redundancy or a newly dated historical event. It neither restores nominative *w* in knee nor duplicates earlier inherited short-Vww reanalysis.

5.20 Technical support: palatalized-glide long-io realization

5.20.1 SC110. Palatalized-glide long-io realization (`OEJGlideIO`)

```
define OEJGlideIO Ctx([
    [{*iu}|{*íu}] -> {*īo} || _ {*w} {*j}
]);
```

The palatalized-glide product realizes long *īo*, not the ordinary long *ēo* supplied by SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling. Ringe and Taylor explicitly supply pre-OE long *īow* and early West Saxon long *īew*; the retained semivowel still conditions mutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 250). Existing SC055 OEIUmlaut supplies the latter change. Ordinary inherited *iu* without this palatal conditioner remains outside the component, as does short *io*. This distinct realization does not adjudicate all the inherited atomic and split-symbol clauses in SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling.

5.21 Quantity-distinct English diphthong realization

5.21.1 Historical discussion

The English histories of inherited diphthongs and their secondary equivalents must be distinguished from both smoothing and paradigm leveling. Ringe and Taylor identify a common tensing or lengthening of the syllabic nuclei, followed by further developments of the offglides; they place that tensing before breaking. This does not make all the eventual English spellings the products of a single simultaneous change (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–75).

The fronted continuation of **au* gives long *ēa*, including in *brēad* 'bread', *dēaw* 'dew' and *hēawan* 'hew'. First-element fronting is distinct from subsequent offglide unrounding and lowering. The latter was not universal: some Northumbrian varieties retained a rounded offglide. Thus this outcome is not exclusively West Saxon, but neither is it an exceptionless description of every English dialect (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172–73; Campbell 1959, 53–54, 116–18).

The long *ēo* outcomes in *ċēowan* 'chew' and *fēower* 'four' belong to the **eu* history. Earlier inherited or assimilation-created geminate-glide reanalysis supplies the diphthong while retaining the following consonantal glide. Dew and hew similarly acquire **au* through SC031 OEWWSimplification, then reach the fronted-au path. Their early reanalysis is not the later English realization (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 65–66, 172–74).

The **iu* history is different again. Early *īo* is not simply another spelling for the initial **eu* development. Subsequent io/eo convergence has dialect-specific histories: Northumbrian retains io, whereas West Saxon and parts of Mercian show convergence. The long *ēo* of *frēond* 'friend' and *ēow* 'you' is the selected endpoint here, not evidence that the merger preceded every intervening English change. Friend's contraction-created input and you's earlier glide reanalysis are also distinct origins (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 174–75; Campbell 1959, 124–26).

5.21.2 SC032. Quantity-distinct diphthong realization (OEDiphthongLeveling)

```
define OEDiphthongLeveling Ctx([
    {*aeu} -> {*ēa},
    {*áeu} -> {*ēa},
    {*eu} -> {*ēo},
    {*éu} -> {*ēo},
    {*iu} -> {*ēo},
    {*íu} -> {*ēo},
    # Split symbols from palatal glide (stress preserved where present):
    {*e} {*u} -> {*eo},
    {*é} {*u} -> {*éo},
    {*i} {*u} -> {*eo}
]);
```

The retained definition is a compound realization proxy. Its atomic **aeu*, **eu* and **iu* symbols belong to the heavy, long-output tier; an acute mark does not itself indicate length. Atomic **aeu* records a fronted-au intermediate, not a claim that a three-vowel phonetic sequence is demonstrated. The direct **iu* to *ēo* mapping packages the selected later endpoint. The split-symbol e+u, é+u and i+u clauses instead produce short *eo*, retaining stress only in the é+u clause. Campbell distinguishes short breaking and back-umlaut diphthongs from their long equivalents, but his account does not specify these computational token boundaries (Campbell 1959, 116–18).

All 32 current applications use atomic long-tier inputs. The unaccented atomic alternatives and all three split-symbol clauses remain formal compatibility paths without a selected-word application. Their retention does not establish an independent palatal-glide origin, and no additional stressed-i clause is inferred.

The short dative *cneowe* ‘knee’ remains outside this long-output operation; its pre-w breaking is supplied by SC044 OEBreaking. The separately palatalized-glide history of *hīew* ‘hue’ reaches long *īo* through SC110 OEJGlideIO before the ordinary iu matcher. It then receives long *īe* through mutation, not ordinary *ēo* here. These contrasts preserve quantity and conditioning within the adopted selected cells (Campbell 1959, 232–33; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 187–88, 250, 387).

Fronting must supply its product before its offglide continuation: SC030 OEAuBrightening feeds this component, not every clause in the definition. Ringe and Taylor explicitly distinguish the two developments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172). Earlier displacement tests that left **aeu* unrealized produced *+?*, a computational rejection with no attested linguistic status. They therefore cannot independently establish the historical interval.

The input of *hēafod* ‘head’ must be realized into a recognized vowel before SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering can lower its remaining medial vowel in the model. That internal recognition requirement is not proof that historical offglide change conditioned the lowering. Campbell records both *hēafud* and *hēafod*, with varying preservation of protected unstressed u (Campbell 1959, 155–56). No historical order for the entire nine-clause bundle follows from that one computational dependency.

5.22 Endingless *aw* and the retained show proxy

5.22.1 Historical discussion

The attested long nucleus does not establish one general law changing singleton *aw* to *ēaw* before every following vowel. For straw, the inherited nominative/accusative **stráwą* loses its ending and vocalizes final *w*, giving **strau*; the ordinary English development then gives reconstructed **strēa*. Attested *strēaw* ‘straw’ combines that long diphthong with *w* restored from inflected forms. Conversely, the long diphthong spreads into those forms. The regular free simplex and short obliques are explicitly unattested, although the endingless pattern survives in the compound *strēaberige* ‘strawberry’ (Campbell 1959, 46–47, 232–33; Brunner 1965, 49, 110, 204–5; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172–73, 387).

The model retains attested *strēaw* ‘straw’ as its comparison target and produces reconstructed **strēa* through the regular cascade. This is an explicit mismatch, not an attested reconstructed endpoint or a sound law for analogical restoration. SC111 PWGmcEndinglessAw supplies the narrow endingless fragment; it does not imply that general final-vowel loss was conditioned by an adjacent *w*.

The inherited geminates of *dēaw* ‘dew’ and *hēawan* ‘hew’ instead undergo early SC031 OEWWSimplification, producing **au* plus retained **w*, followed by English fronting and SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling. Campbell distinguishes the glide histories; Ringe and Taylor distinguish earlier reanalysis from later English realization (Campbell 1959, 45–47, 53–54; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 65–66, 171–75). These retained-glide histories differ from endingless straw.

For *sċēawian* ‘show’, Orel and Kroonen print singleton dictionary inputs, while Campbell and Brunner include the verb among inherited geminate examples. The class-II suffix places a vowel between root *w* and *j*; this excludes direct root *aw+j* gemination but does not resolve the different root histories (Orel 2003, 337; Kroonen 2013, 442; Campbell 1959, 45; Brunner 1965, 49). SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong therefore remains a disclosed support proxy for the three selected show cells, not an established general singleton sound law or a newly dated West Saxon event.

5.22.2 SC034. Retained show long-diphthong proxy (`OEAwLongDiphthong`)

```
define OEAwLongDiphthong Ctx([
    {*a} {*w} -> {*ēa} {*w} || _ [EnglishStarVocalic | {*ô}],
    # Stressed variant (prosodic tier):
    {*á} {*w} -> {*éa} {*w} || _ [EnglishStarVocalic | {*ô}]
]);
```

The current operation changes the show infinitive, imperative singular and present third singular. Straw already has its regular long nucleus without *w* and is unchanged here. Dew and hew no longer demonstrate a local simplification-then-lengthening chain here: their earlier reanalysis has already removed that input shape. The older displacement results for those geminates describe the superseded representation, not independent dates for the adopted early event. The two proxy clauses remain unchanged; their successful show finals do not decide the unresolved singleton-versus-geminate source premise. The old straw displacement observation measured dependence on a following vowel in the superseded proxy, not independent historical order (Campbell 1959, 45–47; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 171–75).

5.23 Former compound-syncope trace anchor

The former early deletion is no longer active. Ordinary nonhigh loss belongs to SC114 OENonHighSyn, and weight-conditioned high-vowel loss to SC065 OEMedialSyncope. The comparative compound discussion accompanies those later operations. This identity preserves earlier cross-references without representing an independently dated early sound law.

5.23.1 SC037. Former compound-syncope trace anchor (OECompoundLinkingSyncope)

```
define OECompoundLinkingSyncope ?*;
```

5.24 Weak medial vocalism

5.24.1 Historical discussion

5.24.1.1 The inherited compound ‘age of men’ Old English *weorold* ‘world’ continues the compound ‘age of men’. Orel’s **wira-alđiz* and Ringe and Taylor’s **weraldiz* support an inherited i-stem starting point. CAPR selects the compact nominative **wír-àldiz*, not an early ō-stem replacement. Kroonen supports the two components, but neither their exact junction nor the com-

pound's accentuation follows automatically from their separate dictionary entries (Orel 2003, 462; Kroonen 2013, 20, 588; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 34, 202, 326).

Original *i* beside *e* remains a comparative uncertainty. The selected *i* undergoes SC015 PNWGmcILowering before *r*; an originally *e*-vowelled reconstruction would not need that step. Early short-*i* apocope removes the final vowel of *-iz*, and subsequent final-*z* loss leaves **wér-àld*. The compact stem presupposes resolution or reduction of the earlier compound junction. Its formation is not derived by treating a literal *a*+*a* sequence as an ordinary consonant-separated linking vowel (Orel 2003, 462; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 34, 326).

This nominative does not require early ō-stem analogy. That does not mean its paradigm never underwent remodelling. Ringe and Taylor's i-stem versus ō-stem comparison and Kluge–Seebold's **wira-aldō* remain relevant; late Norse *verǫld* 'world' is probably borrowed and is not an independent inherited vote. Campbell's frequent endingless accusative *weorold* supports survival of conservative inflection without requiring an entirely unchanged paradigm (Kluge 2011, 981–82; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 202, 326; Campbell 1959, 244, §610(1) n.2).

5.24.1.2 Earlier secondary accent and its weakening An earlier compound could carry secondary prominence on the second root. Kaluza's older account, presented in Stanley's *Metricalities*, allows subsidiary stress in *weorold* and many other disyllables. This is a metrical theory, not direct written evidence of pronunciation (Stanley 2022, 34). Goering instead argues that early Old English *weruld* belonged to a single initial trimoraic foot, not a light initial foot followed by a separately stressed medial foot. Initial alliteration and vowel development establish initial stress; apocope alone cannot choose between the footings. The weak vowel's behaviour and resolution of *worulde* in *Beowulf* 3068a and 2343a provide the stronger discriminants (Goering 2023, 79–82, §4.5.1.2).

The adopted relative claim is loss of independent second-element prominence before the weak-vowel development. Goering's reconstructed early Old English system, perhaps around 600 and compatible with the seventh-/eighth-century poetic horizon, provides an approximate upper horizon for that analysis, not a precisely dated deaccentuation law (Goering 2023, 84–85, §4.6). The grave therefore represents an earlier accent; it does not assert that the vowel still bore independent stress when it rounded. Hogg's warning against an unexplained "tertiary stress" remains important: a descriptive label cannot supply the missing phonological argument (Hogg 2011, 215–18, §§6.4–6.7).

5.24.1.3 Weak rounding and the selected high-vowel path Campbell describes weak retraction before *l/r* plus consonant, rounding to *o*, and further *u* in some forms. Hogg distinguishes weak retraction from breaking under stronger prominence. Bülbring proposes following-*u* assimilation for *world*. Luick, however, particularly associates weak rounding with labials and following *l*, and expressly finds the following-*u* account insufficient. His uncertainty over the boundary between *o* and *u* outcomes does not exclude a high-vowel lineage (Campbell 1959, 142, §338; Bülbring 1902, 147–49, §§366–367; Luick 1914--1940, 125–26, §113; Hogg 2011, 215–18, §§6.4–6.7).

CAPR adopts weak *a* > *u* before *l* plus consonant in a light-initial domain: an initial primary-stressed short vowel followed by one consonant and the weak medial vowel. This bounded prosodic generalization combines Luick's environment with Goering's LH analysis; neither author supplies this exact formal rule. It excludes heavy-initial shapes, primary medial accent and vowels outside the specified cluster, without identifying words or grammatical classes. Retained-prominence compounds such as *ānfeald* 'onefold' caution against unrestricted post-accent-stripping raising; weak *twifold* 'twofold' supplies a relevant rounded comparison. The rule is a qualified reconstruction of the chosen lineage, not a claim that every historically weak vowel became high (Campbell 1959, 142, §338; Bülbring 1902, 148–49, §367; Hogg 2011, 217–18, §§6.6–6.7; Goering 2023, 79–82).

One rewrite compresses possible gradual rounding and raising; it does not posit an independently dated intermediate *o* law. The resulting medial *u* feeds initial back mutation in SC059 OEBackMutation. SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering later supplies medial *o*, giving the selected West Saxon *weorold*. The inherited nominative has already lost final short *i*; no later final

high vowel needs to be removed. The initial and medial dialect differences are separate: West Saxon *weorold/worold*, also with medial *u*, Mercian *weoruld*, Northumbrian *woruld* and Kentish *wiarald* do not require one universal *a* > *u* > *o* chain. Subsequent syncopated *world* concerns loss of the medial vowel, not another raising witness (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 202, 326; Campbell 1959, 142, §338, p. 160, §391; Luick 1914--1940, 126, §113).

5.24.1.4 Placement and its limits The selected weak-domain raising precedes early unstressed fronting and breaking. A post-fronting account, compressing weak *æ* retraction, rounding and raising, also derives *weorold* and is closer to Hogg's stated sequence. Output alone cannot choose the dates. The adopted serialization avoids requiring an otherwise unobserved fronted intermediate in this weak domain. Versloot's alternative conditional-fronting/later-breaking chronology challenges compulsory fronting before *lC*; its main argument concerns other domains, especially stressed *a*, and is not evidence that he proposed weak medial *a* > *u* in *world* (Hogg 2011, 217–18, §§6.6–6.7; Versloot 2026, 111–14, 122–23).

The earlier grave survives until SC037 OECompoundLinkingSyncope has read the relevant accent information; technical grave removal then precedes weak raising. This represents annotation lifetime and a compatible relative history, not proof that every linking syncope preceded every compound's deaccentuation. The chronology of *world* is independent of the early second-root lowering in *reġnboga* 'rainbow'. That word still requires the grave through linking syncope, but its *o* already arose under SC017 PNWGmcULowering; it does not date grave loss before late unstressed lowering. *World* retains the distinct requirement that the weak vowel lack independent prominence before raising. The back-mutation implementation also admits lower back-vowel triggers through shared contexts; the selected high-*u* history succeeds under the narrower intended *u*-triggered interpretation as well. Neither that separate defect nor the later vowel-merger laws are changed here.

5.24.1.5 The distinct history of soul Ringe and Taylor derive **saiwalō* through **saiwalu*, **sawœlu*, **sawlu* and *sāwl* 'soul', then *sāwul/sāwol* 'soul'. Contraction of the stressed diphthong, loss of the medial nonhigh vowel, loss of final *u*, and epenthesis are separate developments. Their final *u* is described as restored after earlier regular loss (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 265, 330). Campbell's *sāwl* 'soul' and Luick's epenthetic *sāwul* 'soul' support this distinction; the oblique *sāwle* 'soul' also matters. The expanded *sāwol* 'soul' does not license suppressing the unexpanded forms (Campbell 1959, 143, §341; Luick 1914--1940, 287, 294, §§309, 317; Brunner 1965, 132, §159).

Fulk's competing metrical account of the early syllabic history must be evaluated independently of later spellings (Fulk 2010, 133–39). CAPR selects the inherited accusative **sáiwalǭ*, yielding *sāwle* by SC114 OENonHighSyn, without medial raising, epenthesis or analogy inside that span. Luke12:20 provides an unambiguous accusative; the nearby *eala sawel* is vocative, not nominative (Skeat 1874, 130). The wider nominative history remains distinct and unresolved.

The former continuous medial-raising proxy is retired. It was never the source-led syncope/apocope/epenthesis history, and its temporary success did not demonstrate one common raising event for *world* and *soul*.

5.24.2 SC036. Weak medial vocalism (`OEInterStressRaising`)

```
define OEInterStressRaising OELHWeakRaising;
```

The primary network now names only the adopted weak-LH operation. It does not include the distinct nonhigh syncope process. Confidence C expresses the qualified domain and chronology, independently of the Old English scope and secure attestations.

5.24.3 SC036. Light-initial weak raising (`OELHWeakRaising`)

```
define OELHWeakRaising Ctx([
    {*a} -> {*u} || .#. EnglishStarConsonant* [{*á}|{*é}|{*í}|{*ó}|{*ú}]
        EnglishStarConsonant _ {*l} EnglishStarConsonant
]);
```

The boundary and short acute nucleus restrict the initial domain; one intervening consonant distinguishes the light initial syllable. Only plain short *a* is rewritten, after removal of the earlier grave.

5.25 Combinative u-umlaut in wi-forms

5.25.1 Historical discussion

The history of *wuduwe* ‘widow’ orders these two changes within the same low-stress vocalic development. Campbell discusses both the *w*-conditioned *u* forms and the later *weorold* ‘world’ / *weoruld* ‘world’ alternation, while Ringe and Taylor give the same connection comparatively in **widuwon-*, **weraldu* ‘world’, and **jugunþi* ‘youth’ (Campbell 1959, 92, §218; Campbell 1959, 140, §332; Campbell 1959, 141–42, §§338–339; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 267; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 322, §6.9.4).

SC039 OEWICombinativeUUmlaut feeds the vowel sequence subsequently reshaped by SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering. Initial *w* conditions the first change.

5.25.2 SC039. Combinative **u*-umlaut in *wi*-forms (`OEWICombinativeUUmlaut`)

```
define OEWICombinativeUUmlaut Ctx([
    {*í} -> {*ú} || .#. {*w} _ EnglishStarConsonant [{*u} | {*o}]
]);
```

The *wuduwe* ‘widow’ derivation answers one narrow question about *wi*-forms. If SC039 OEWICombinativeUUmlaut is delayed until after SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering, PGmc **wíduwōn* ‘widow’ yields †*wudowe* rather than expected OE *wuduwe*. This one-sided witness requires combinative u-umlaut to precede medial lowering and supplies no lower boundary.

5.25.3 Historical limits of the represented account

The phonetic relevance of preceding *w* and a following back vowel is independently supported by *wudu* ‘wood’, *wuduwe* ‘widow’ and West Saxon *wucu* ‘week’. Unlike ordinary West Saxon back umlaut, this retraction can occur across a dental or velar. These comparisons do not, however, establish that every inherited short *i* in that environment acquired *u* (Campbell 1959, 92–93, §§218–221; Hogg 2011, 158–63, §§5.108–5.112; Brunner 1965, 93–94, §114; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 322–24; Fulk 2018, 68–69, §4.8).

The independently reconstructed **witun* ‘they know’ supplies a substantive limit: the present rule predicts a root *u*, whereas the cited West Saxon forms *witon* and *wioton* retain *i* or show ordinary back umlaut. This is a historical comparison, not a rejected artificial word. The general conditioning is therefore deferred; the selected widow derivation is retained without claiming a complete account of all these reflexes. No lexical exception, grammatical condition or optional sound law is introduced. Brunner’s specific optative-based explanation of *witon* ‘let us’ cannot simply be transferred to ‘they know’.

Barrack distinguishes combinative retraction from ordinary back umlaut and expressly leaves their relative order in West Saxon uncertain. His early-glossary argument does not by itself establish an earlier historical date for the combinative change; Hogg explicitly questions that inference. Bülbring’s account places a two-step development around 700, but the present representation does not establish those separate steps or a new ordering against ordinary back umlaut (Barrack 1975, 63–65, rules 210, 212, 218, 220; Bülbring 1902, 106–7, §264; Hogg 2011, 162–63, §5.112).

5.26 Final bare-*a* loss

5.26.1 Historical discussion

The loss of final short low vowels belongs to the erosion of Germanic final syllables, but not every part of that erosion is one event. Campbell distinguishes the early loss of vowels which had already been absolutely final in Indo-European from the later loss of protected **a*; the latter includes the endings represented by nominative **stainaz* and accusative **stainam*. His subsequent reference to final loss introduces a separate discussion of prehistoric English medial syncope, not a new Old English date for the final loss [Campbell (1959), pp. 137–138, §331, especially §331.4 and n. 4; p. 143, §341].

Ringe and Taylor reconstruct West Germanic loss of unstressed short oral **a* and nasal **ą*, word-finally or before final **z*. Fulk likewise distinguishes this loss from subsequent reductions and states that it was independent of the weight of the preceding syllable (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–47, §3.1.2; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6). The conditioning is phonological and prosodic, not membership in a declension. Retention before final **s*, contrasted with loss in **-az*, is particularly important: a rule deleting a vowel before any final consonant would be too broad.

Loss of **z* before apocope is the economical West Germanic analysis, not a logical consequence of an endingless descendant. Old Norse demonstrates the possibility of the opposite order. The West Germanic survival of vowels before **s* and **r* favors the **z*-first account, while the possible Matronae-name counterexamples have uncertain linguistic affiliation and different syllabic positions (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 46). The Frienstedt comb inscription *kaba* ‘comb’, interpreted as *kamba* and dated approximately 250–300 CE, provides a more concrete local witness: on that interpretation, **z* has gone while **a* remains. Fulk expressly cautions against extending that date to completed **z*-loss throughout West Germanic (Fulk 2018, 25, n. 1). Neither observation supplies an exact universal date for apocope; the runic and Latinized evidence remains qualified (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 45, n. 4).

The broader apocope also stranded glides, producing syllabic outcomes, and preceded West Germanic consonant gemination before **j*. Ringe and Taylor distinguish those early outcomes from later paradigmatic leveling (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 46–47). This is a historical constraint on the broader account, not a reason to date apocope from the late position of the following executable fragment. In particular, a successful geminated ja-stem output does not by itself establish an uninterrupted regular history of its selected nominative.

5.26.2 SC041. Loss of final bare **a* (`PWGmcFinalBareALoss`)

```
define PWGmcFinalBareALoss Ctx([
    {*a} -> 0 || _ .#.
]);
```

This is a narrower proxy than the historical change. It deletes an unaccented, short, oral final **a*; it does not delete nasal **ą*, long **ā*, stressed **á*, or a vowel still protected by a consonant. Nasal endings have a separate executable treatment, including SC047 OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope; that division of labor does not establish an Old English date for their historical loss.

The adjudicated population contains seventy live applications, all with selected inputs ending in **-az*. That agreement is a consequence of the inputs and preceding sound changes, not a grammatical condition on the rule. The inherited oblique used for *fyrhte* ‘fright’ is among them, so they are not simply seventy nominatives of one declension. The selected **stáinaz* gives *stān* ‘stone’; an accusative discussed in the comparative literature is not silently substituted for this selected nominative. Nasal-final *horn* ‘horn’, the infinitive *bacan* ‘bake’, and consonant-protected *bannes* ‘ban’ do not undergo this particular operation.

SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion exposes the final vowel in **bárdaz* and **kámbaz*, giving the immediately pre-loss forms **bárda* and **kámba*. The live rule removes their final vowel and eventually gives *beard* ‘beard’ and *camb* ‘comb’. Moving it before the exposing loss instead gives †*bearda* and †*camba*. This is feeding across a broad computational interval, not evidence that the two historical changes were adjacent.

The relationship to SC046 OEARestoration is different. In the live order, apocope removes a potential back-vowel trigger before restoration can use it: loss therefore bleeds restoration. For *crœft* ‘craft’ and *dæġ* ‘day’, delaying loss leaves a trigger present and gives †*craft* and †*dag*. This does not mean that restoration requires an environment created by apocope; it is the environment destroyed by apocope that matters. The source account of restoration independently requires a surviving back vowel after the relevant consonantal material (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 189–90, §6.3.1).

The selected fright derivation imposes another, explicitly computational requirement: loss exposes final **n* for SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss. That visibility dependency is not independent proof of adjacent historical dates. The present position after medial developments is accordingly retained as an implementation accommodation, not as the historical chronology of West Germanic apocope. The unchanged operation correctly removes the exposed short oral vowel in its current firing population; it does not, by itself, certify the earlier history of nasal endings, stranded glides, or every selected paradigm cell.

5.27 Stem-final n-loss after long i

5.27.1 Historical discussion

The inherited feminine *in*-stem represented by Gothic *faurhtei*, OE *fyrhtu*, and oblique OE *fyrhte* supplies the relevant evidence (Orel 2003, 120; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 380–81; Campbell 1959, 236, §589.7). Final **n* after unstressed **ī* was lost after Proto-West-Germanic differentiation; conservative southern Old High German prevents treating it as an undifferentiated Northwest Germanic law (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87–88; Fulk 2018, 173, §7.34). This early loss must be distinguished from the later weak-syllable developments described by Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk (Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 264–303, §§6.7.3–6.8.4; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6).

5.27.2 SC064. Loss of stem-final **n* after long **ī* (`NWGmcInStemNLoss`)

```
define NWGmcInStemNLoss Ctx([{*n} -> 0 || {*ī} _ .#.]);
```

Only word-final **n* after unstressed long **ī* is at issue. The conditioning is phonological, not membership in the feminine *īn*-stems. Besides their obliques, Campbell cites *strenge* ‘strength’, the loanword *pyle* ‘pillow’ and early past-subjunctive plural endings (Campbell 1959, 189, §473; Brunner 1965, 225–26, §280).

CAPR models the oblique OE form through the Proto-Germanic genitive singular **fúrxtīnaz* ‘fright’, following the project convention of using an appropriate non-nominative paradigm cell when the nominative does not supply the required derivation. Final ending loss exposes **fúrxtīn*; early loss of **n*, mutation and later shortening yield *fyrhte* ‘fright’. This selected encoding imposes two implementation boundaries. Before SC041 PWGmcFinalBareALoss, PGmc **fúrxtīnaz* ‘fright’ yields †*fyrhten* rather than expected OE *fyrhte* ‘fright’. After SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **fúrxtīnaz* again yields †*fyrhten* rather than expected *fyrhte* ‘fright’. The former boundary exposes the segment; the latter keeps its long-vowel environment visible. Neither dates the loss to a late post-apocope period.

Campbell attributes retained *n* in *nēten* ‘livestock’ to the inflected forms (Campbell 1959, 189, §473). Goering’s later **nētīn* therefore does not require immunity to the early law: a later paradigmatic state and uninterrupted inherited retention are different claims. An exposed early final **-īn* would regularly lose its consonant; the later **nētīn* cannot be presented as an exemption or as uninterrupted phonological survival. Its complete ancestral derivative and intervening paradigmatic history are separate questions. Final **ī* remains long until later shortening, while medial **ī* has already shortened in the inflected forms (Goering 2016, 186–88; 2023, 67–68). No word-specific protection or added accent is required. The exact date of paradigmatic retention or restoration is not fixed by these comparisons.

The selected plural avoids that singular problem. Fulk prints **nautīnō*, the ancestor of the Mercian plural, while the Hatton *Pastoral Care* attests West Saxon *nietenu* ‘animals, livestock’ (Fulk

2018, 92, §5.6; Sweet 1871, 109, lines 8–11; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–99). Its medial nasal is followed by the plural vowel throughout this early loss and therefore survives regularly. The full plural reaches *nīetenu* ‘animals’ without either an exception to this law or a transponent with restored final *n*.

5.28 Surviving bimoric **ō* unrounding

5.28.1 Historical discussion

The development has independent comparative support, not merely a successful derivation of one Old English word. Ringe and Taylor explicitly reconstruct surviving bimoric **ō* as West Germanic **ā* word-finally and before final **r*; trimoric vowels instead give **ō*, while the two quantities merge as **ō* in other unstressed environments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 58–60). Quantity, finality and the remaining consonants are therefore essential to their account. A phonological law, not membership in a declension, distinguishes the outcomes.

Their comparative examples include the histories of *wæter* ‘water’ and *fēower* ‘four’ before final **r*, and final-vowel histories continued by *ġiefe* ‘gift’, *tunge* ‘tongue’ and *heorte* ‘heart’. The different quantity underlying *nama* ‘name’ supplies a contrast, not an exception. They place unrounding before shortening before final **r* and argue for a West Germanic development partly from the retention of rounded vowels in Early Runic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 59–60). These are the authors’ comparative and runic arguments, not additional applications of the operation printed below or new independent readings of inscriptions.

The quantity analysis is not uniform across handbooks. Hogg discusses nasal-associated low-vowel outcomes and the survival and shortening of long vowels, but includes the genitive singular among the endings considered in his trimoric-vowel discussion and explicitly qualifies the security of that classification [Hogg (2011), p. 64, §3.32; pp. 227–228, §§6.26–28, especially §6.27 n. 2]. Ringe and Taylor instead explicitly assign the relevant genitive a bimoric input and reconstruct long **ā* followed by long **ǣ* on its way to final *-e* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 59, 299–300). The length is consequently not an invention required only to obtain a particular output, although the detailed prehistoric quantity remains a matter for source criticism.

Campbell’s discussion of fronting and restoration, Hogg’s separate historical chapter, and Ringe and Taylor’s English restoration account explain the surrounding English developments, rather than independently establishing the West Germanic unrounding law (Campbell 1959, 52, 60–61, §§131, 157–158; Hogg 1992b, 102, 105; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 189–90). The grammar cited for long-vowel quantity above is Hogg’s monograph in its 2011 pagination, not that 1992 chapter.

5.28.2 SC042. Unrounding of the surviving bimoric **ō* (PWGmcSurvivingBimoricOUnrounding)

```
define PWGmcSurvivingBimoricOUnrounding Ctx([
    [{*ō}|{*o̜}] -> {*ā} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.
]);
```

The operation merges surviving final oral and nasal bimoric vowels in **ā* before English final-vowel fronting. Its preceding-nucleus and intervening-consonant guard selects a polysyllabic shape; it does not independently reconstruct historical stress. The restriction to the final vowel preserves nasalized roots and the separate trimoric quantity. Before-final-**r* histories remain distributed: the selected water and four inputs already contain **a* there.

The complete current population has twenty-two applications: the oral ending in *ræste* ‘rest’, from selected genitive **rástōz*, and twenty-one nasal-final histories. These include *mære* ‘nightmare’, *tunge* ‘tongue’, *heorte* ‘heart’ and *sāwle* ‘soul’. The selected gift input remains **gíftiz*: the literature’s **gebōz* is a separate control, not another corpus application. No lexical list or grammatical condition selects the endings.

After SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion exposes **rástō*, unrounding gives **rástā*. SC043 EAFBrightening fronts the root, and the final-vowel support SC108 EAFBrighteningLongFinal gives **ræstǣ*; subsequent shortening and merger yield *ræste* ‘rest’. The final support carries quantity in the model and is not another independently dated sound law. The West Germanic long-vowel reconstruction has a source basis, but this exact serialized chain remains a computational representation of the selected history.

For *mære* ‘nightmare’, the final nasal vowel becomes **ā* here, then **ǣ* under SC108 EAFBrighteningLongFinal. The front ending no longer conditions root retraction under SC046 OEARestoration. Subsequent shortening and merger yield the selected short-vowel nominative. Attested *mare* ‘nightmare’ instead has independently identified levelling from obliques such as *maran* ‘nightmare’ (Hall 2007, 301–2, §2). The analogous nominative calculation for *flasce* ‘flask’ produces **flæsċe*, not the attested comparator: Campbell and Luick explicitly identify levelling from inflected forms there (Campbell 1959, 61, §158; Luick 1914–1940, 152–53, §161).

Moving the operation before z-loss still gives †*rasta* instead of *ræste* ‘rest’. This trial also crosses nasal-ending exposure; its changed nominatives are not additional witnesses specifically for z-loss. Moving it after final support changes twenty-one finals, whereas moving it after ordinary stressed fronting but before final support preserves every final. The component dependencies are final-environment exposure and final-vowel support, not a local feeding requirement before ordinary stressed fronting. The independently argued West Germanic development precedes the English history in the adopted account; its late executable placement does not date it.

5.29 Technical support: retained unstressed fronting

5.29.1 SC107. Retained unstressed contribution (EAFBrighteningUnstressed)

```
define EAFBrighteningUnstressed Ctx([
    {*a} -> {*æ} || _ [EnglishStarConsonant - EnglishStarNasal]
]);
```

This earlier contribution is preserved without identifying it with the entire unstressed history. The later syllabic rule also fronts surviving unstressed vowels before heterosyllabic nasals; an exception before every nasal would therefore be too broad (Campbell 1959, 140–41).

5.30 Ordinary English fronting

5.30.1 Historical discussion

Anglo-Frisian Brightening or First Fronting turns low **a* into fronted **æ*-type outcomes outside nasal environments. Later Old English developments presuppose this fronted stage even where they partly conceal it. Campbell gives the classical statement of the change, Hogg supplies the standard modern labels, and Ringe and Taylor establish its local chronology with breaking and restoration (Campbell 1959, 52, §131; Hogg 1992b, 102, 105; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157–58, 189–90; Fulk 2018, 73–74, §§4.12–4.13).

Brightening creates the input to SC044 OEBreaking, while SC046 OEARestoration later partly reverses its outcome before back vowels.

The traditional name does not itself establish one inherited event. Under Campbell’s premise that the daughter contractions precede ordinary fronting, comparable English and Frisian outcomes require separate daughter frontings in the strict tree. Chapter 3 develops that conditional argument without removing the ancestral node (Campbell 1939, 90–91). The model adopts the completed ordinary English stressed component on the English daughter under this conventional working account. This is not a claim that every author proves contraction before ordinary fronting: Ringe and Taylor explicitly question whether diphthong nuclei must behave like the plain short vowel (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–75). Earlier restricted ancestral fronting remains possible.

Fulk's surviving fronted **œi* and proposed paradigmatic levelling provide a competing account, discussed in Chapter 3, rather than direct confirmation of contraction before ordinary fronting (Fulk 1998, 143–45). No shared fronting is demonstrated merely by making that alternative compatible with the daughter outcomes.

The separately retained unstressed and final-vowel components are not dated by that argument. The first supplies an earlier nonnasal contribution; SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly separately implements the broader unstressed domain, including the contrast between coda and heterosyllabic nasals (Campbell 1959, 140–41, §§333–334). The second carries the model's preserved final-vowel quantity into later shortening and merger. Its long intermediate is a representation choice, not independent evidence for a historical long-vowel fronting (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 58–59, 299–300).

5.30.2 SC043. Fronting of low **a* outside nasal environments (EAFBrightening)

```
define EAFBrightening Ctx([
    EAFBrighteningStressed
]);
```

5.30.2.1 Stressed component

```
define EAFBrighteningStressed [
    {*á} -> {*æ} || _ [EnglishStarConsonant - EnglishStarNasal | .#
];
```

Slay requires breaking to receive the fronted root vowel: delaying the stressed member until after SC044 OEBreaking gives *sleaan* | *slēaan*, rather than OE *slēan* 'slay'. Rest involves two different changes, root fronting and the separately retained final-vowel representation. Its final-vowel dependency must not be used to date this stressed rule.

5.31 Technical support: retained final-vowel representation

5.31.1 SC108. Retained final-vowel representation (EAFBrighteningLongFinal)

```
define EAFBrighteningLongFinal Ctx([
    {*ā} -> {*ǣ} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.
]);
```

In *ræste* 'rest', this helper receives the length-preserved outcome of SC042 PWGmcSurvivingBimoricOUnrounding. The preceding-nucleus guard excludes stressed monosyllabic *hwā* 'who'. Later shortening and merger complete the ending; the carried long vowel does not establish a separate dated long-a law (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 58–59, 299–300; Campbell 1959, 49, §125).

5.32 Breaking

5.32.1 Historical discussion

Breaking creates *eo*-type outputs before *h*, *rC*, and *lC*; velar-fricative palatalization then operates in that reshaped environment. Campbell, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk place breaking after brightening. The following fricative palatalization is more narrowly conditioned (Campbell 1959, 54, 166, §§139, 405–406; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 168–69, 213–14, §§6.2.1–6.2.3, 6.4.1–6.4.2; Fulk 2018, 73–74, §4.13).

Breaking has the fuller handbook treatment. The *feoh* 'cattle' and *feohtan* 'fight' type derivations preserve its velar-fricative trigger; they do not subsequently undergo velar-fricative palatalization.

Fulk cautions that breaking before *h* does not necessarily date the articulation of *k/g*: the consonantal histories must be distinguished. His English and later Frisian breaking processes are also not one inherited event (Fulk 1998, 145–46, 152).

5.32.2 SC044. Breaking before *h*, *rC*, *lC*, and conditioned *w* (`OEBreaking`)

```
define OEBreaking FootCtx(OEBreakingA
    .o. OEBreakingE
    .o. OEBreakingI);
```

Short *e* and *i* also develop short *eo* and *io* before singleton *w*, except when a high front vowel or *j* follows it. This is the regular pre-ending history of *cneowe* ‘knee (dat.sg.)’, not long-diphthong promotion (Luick 1914--1940, 139, §134; Hogg 2011, 86, §5.22; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 187–88, §6.2.4). The shared w conditioner makes that exclusion explicit:

```
define EnglishBreakingWContext [
    {*w} [[EnglishStarVocalic | EnglishStarConsonant]
        - [{*i} | {*ì} | {*í} | {*ī} | {*ǐ} | {*j}]] |
    {*w} .#.
];
```

Root stress notation does not determine vowel length. The short knee dative is the selected comparison; long endingless *cnēo* ‘knee’ and the restored *w* of *cnēow* ‘knee’ are separate paradigm histories, discussed with SC033 OEEwLongDiphthong.

Breaking must encounter the vowel created by brightening and must precede the rule that would otherwise palatalize its velar trigger in *feoh* ‘cattle’ and *feohtan* ‘fight’. Before SC043 EAFBrightening, PGmc **sláxaną* ‘slay’ yields *sleaan* | *slēaan* rather than expected OE *slēan* ‘slay’. After SC045 OEVelarFricativePalatalization, PGmc **féxu* ‘cattle’ yields †*fehu* rather than expected OE *feoh*, and PGmc **féxtaną* ‘fight’ yields †*fehtan* rather than expected *feohtan*. The fronting relation feeds breaking. The fee/fight relation instead protects breaking’s velar trigger from premature palatalization: those forms are displacement negatives, not live SC045 OEVelarFricativePalatalization applications.

5.32.3 SC044. Stress-sensitive short-i breaking (`OEBreakingI`)

```
define OEBreakingI [
    {*i} -> {*io} || .#. OEAnyConsonant* _ EnglishBreakingRContext,
    {*i} -> {*io} || .#. OEAnyConsonant* _ EnglishBreakingHContext,
    {*i} -> {*io} || .#. OEAnyConsonant* _ EnglishBreakingWContext
] .o. [
    {*í} -> {*ío} || _ EnglishBreakingRContext,
    {*í} -> {*ío} || _ EnglishBreakingHContext,
    {*í} -> {*ío} || _ EnglishBreakingWContext,
    {*ì} -> {*io} || _ EnglishBreakingRContext,
    {*ì} -> {*io} || _ EnglishBreakingHContext,
    {*ì} -> {*io} || _ EnglishBreakingWContext
];
```

Breaking is not an ordinary unstressed-vowel development. *fulwiht* ‘baptism’ and *nawiht* ‘nothing’ supply independent negative evidence; the latter has separately explained stressed byforms. A plain vowel can nevertheless represent the stressed initial nucleus after an earlier accent-consuming change. This component therefore admits that nucleus, explicit primary *í*, and preserved subordinate *ì*, but excludes plain medial *i*. Positive pretonic foot marking retains its existing scope (Hogg 2011, 217–18, §§6.7–6.8; Campbell 1959, 54–56, §§139–144; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 187–88).

In the conditional *seleweard* history the retained medial *i* causes mutation without breaking and later lowers to *e*. This is a general stress distinction, not suppression of a diphthong by lexical

identity. The second root's subordinate marker survives until its phonological consumers; its technical decoding is not a date for obligatory historical destressing (Russom 2001, 39–64).

5.33 Velar-fricative palatalization

5.33.1 SC045. Palatalization of velar fricatives beside front vowels (OEVelarFricativePalatalization)

```
define OEVelarFricativePalatalization Ctx([
    {*x} -> {*ç} || _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*x} -> {*ç} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _,
    {*x} -> {*ç} || _ {*j}
]
    .o. EnglishStarAlphabet*);
```

The live population concerns voiceless x, as in *hēafod* 'head' and *heofon* 'heaven', not voiced-fricative merger. In *feoh* 'cattle' and *feohtan* 'fight', breaking removes the original front-vowel context: they do not change at this rule in the live derivation. Moving the rule before SC044 OEBreaking instead consumes its velar trigger, yielding †*fehu* and †*fehtan*. This is counterbleeding protection, not direct feeding.

The distant *six* 'six' displacement test supplies only a broader constraint: after SC060 OEWsPalatalUmlaut, PGmc **séxs* 'six' yields †*sihs* rather than expected OE *six*. Neither test dates voiced g. Its articulation and disputed merger are separately treated under SC052 OEVelarPalatalization and SC109 OEPalatalFricativeMerger (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–4; Fulk 2018, 130–32).

5.34 A-restoration

5.34.1 Historical discussion of A-restoration

Campbell's restoration of *a* before following back vowels and Ringe and Taylor's later retraction describe the same post-brightening development (Campbell 1959, 60–61, §§157–159; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 189–90, §6.3.1; Fulk 2018, 74, §4.13). Some outcomes of Anglo-Frisian fronting survive only in environments where restoration does not return them to back *a*.

SC046 OEARestoration has firmer handbook support than the two following nasal rules.

5.34.2 SC046. Restoration of **a* before following back vowels (OEARestoration)

```
define OEARestoration FootCtx((
    {*æ} -> {*a} || _
        OEARestorationIntervening OEARestorationTriggerVowel
        - OEARestorationIntervening OEARestorationWeakTailVowel
));
```

Restoration must receive fronted **æ* and return **a* before the nasal-tail changes. Before SC043 EAFBrightening, PGmc **bákaną* 'bake' yields †*bæcan* rather than expected OE *bacan* 'bake', and PGmc **fáraną* 'fare' yields †*færan* rather than expected *faran* 'fare'. After SC048 OESecondaryNasalization, **bákaną* again yields †*bæcan* instead of *bacan*, while PGmc **wádaną* 'wade' yields †*wædan* instead of *wadan* 'wade'. These independent witness pairs place restoration after brightening and before secondary nasalization.

5.35 Heavy-syllable nasal apocope

5.35.1 Historical discussion of heavy-syllable nasal loss and secondary nasalization

Heavy-syllable nasal apocope removes the final nasalized vowel; secondary nasalization then marks the preceding *a* before final *n*. The handbooks do not isolate both developments under

equally prominent labels. Campbell describes later nasal loss and the back-mutation environment; Ringe and Taylor provide the later relation to back mutation (Campbell 1959, 86, 166, §§205–206, 403; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 319, §6.9.4).

The reciprocal failure set fixes the order: apocope removes the ending before secondary nasalization acts on the remaining structure. Restoration receives the fuller historical treatment in the handbooks.

5.35.2 SC047. Heavy-syllable nasal apocope of final **ą* (OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope)

```
define OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope Ctx([
    {*ą} -> 0 || OEAnyConsonant _ .#.
]);
```

The old lower-bound test depended on the superseded straw proxy: moving apocope before SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong made PGmc **stráwą* ‘straw’ yield †*strœw* rather than attested OE *strēaw* ‘straw’. The adopted regular endingless branch now reaches reconstructed **strēa* through SC111 PWGmcEndinglessAw, before this apocope. The attested target retains analogically restored *w* and explicitly mismatches the regular output. The old failure therefore does not independently place nasal apocope after a universal singleton long-diphthong law (Campbell 1959, 46–47, 232–33; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 172–73, 387).

The separate recorded upper-bound test is unchanged: after SC048 OESecondaryNasalization, PGmc **bákaną* ‘bake’ yields †*bacen* rather than expected OE *bacan*, and PGmc **bíndaną* ‘bind’ yields †*binden* rather than expected *bindan*, alongside a broad *-en* failure set. That secondary-nasalization dependency is not newly adjudicated here.

5.36 Secondary nasalization

5.36.1 SC048. Secondary nasalization before final **n* (OESecondaryNasalization)

```
define OESecondaryNasalization Ctx([
    {*a} -> {*ą} || _ {*n} .#.
]);
```

The broad *-an*/*-en* split fixes the lower boundary of final **a* nasalization before *n*. Before SC047 OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope, PGmc **bákaną* ‘bake’ yields †*bacen* rather than expected OE *bacan* ‘bake’, and PGmc **bíndaną* ‘bind’ yields †*binden* rather than expected *bindan* ‘bind’. The upper boundary comes from back mutation. After SC059 OEBackMutation, PGmc **stélaną* ‘steal’ yields †*steolan* rather than expected OE *stelan* ‘steal’, and PGmc **wébaną* ‘weave’ yields †*weofan* rather than expected *wefan* ‘weave’. Reciprocal nasal-tail failures place secondary nasalization after apocope, and the later mutation witnesses place it before back mutation; SC046 OEARestoration retains the clearest independent historical support.

5.37 Sievers-law syncope

5.37.1 Historical discussion

Sievers’ Law concerns a prosodic and morphological adjustment in heavy stems. It is a distributional rule distinct from b-allophony (SC049 PGmcBAllophony). Adamczyk treats the Old English reflexes of the law as historical evidence from weak verbs and related formations (Adamczyk 2001, 61–72). Fulk gives the compact comparative summary through familiar forms such as *biddan* ‘ask’, *sellan* ‘give’, and *nerian* ‘save’ (Fulk 2018, 127, §6.15).

Sievers-law syncope is narrow in scope, but its relation to the following palatalization is lexically secure. Its earlier limit is less sharply defined than that of the preceding allophony rule.

5.37.2 SC050. Sievers-law syncope (`SieversLawSyncope`)

```
define SieversLawSyncope Ctx([
    {*i} -> 0 || [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant] _ {*j}
]);
```

The Sievers-law reduction **-CijV-* > *-CjV-**, including loss of **i* before **j*, must precede palatalization. If SC050 SieversLawSyncope follows SC052 OEVelarPalatalization, PGmc **strákkijaną* ‘stretch’ yields †*strecċan* rather than expected OE *streċċan* ‘stretch’; earlier placement creates no comparably precise error. The single cluster witness therefore places syncope before velar palatalization.

5.38 Palatalization of **sk* to **sc*

5.38.1 Historical discussion

The palatalization of **sk* to Old English **sc* is one of the recognizable early cluster changes in the larger palatalization zone. Campbell distinguishes the cluster from plain velars when he remarks that **sk* is especially prone to palatalization and assibilation (Campbell 1959, 177–78, §440). Barrack treats the cluster in the same zone as his 440 series: 440a summarizes the developments (Barrack 1975, 112–13) and 440c states the palatalization of **sk* itself (Barrack 1975, 113), kept beside, but distinct from, plain velar palatalization (his rule 170a) (Barrack 1975, 57), in agreement with the structural placement adopted here. He also registers the typologically separate Late West Saxon metathesis of the cluster in *fiscas*/*fixas* ‘fishes’ as rule 440b (Barrack 1975, 113), a written-period development that presupposes the earlier palatalization boundary rather than contradicting it. Hogg gives the same change a clearer structural place by treating **sk* beside the palatalization of plain velars and before the later West Saxon diphthongal developments (Hogg 1992b, 106–8, 113). Ringe and Taylor make the same sequence explicit when they distinguish the earlier palatalization of velars and **sk* from the later diphthongization after already palatal consonants (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 213–16, §§6.4.1, 6.5.1).

Luick places the cluster change within a broader early movement toward palatal articulation, while still allowing later vowel consequences to form a different chapter of the history (Luick 1914--1940, 157, §168). Fulk’s summary is the most concise warning against overextension: Old English **sc* is palatal except in the well-known back-vowel environments that preserve harder outcomes (Fulk 2018, 28). The result is a historically clear rule, but not an identity between the cluster change and the later umlautal developments.

5.38.2 SC051. Palatalization of **sk* to **sc* (`OESkPalatalization`)

```
define OESkPalatalization Ctx([
    {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || .#. _
] .o. [
    {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ (EnglishStarConsonant | .#.)
] .o. [
    {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || (EnglishStarConsonant | .#.) _ EnglishStarFrontVowel
] .o. [
    {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || _ {*j}
] .o. [
    {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || {*j} _
]);
```

The displacement of cluster palatalization before SC046 OEARestoration now changes *wascan* ‘wash’ to †*wæsċan*; wash remains the current lower-boundary witness. The old flask displacement belonged to an implementation that retained its final nasal vowel through restoration. After the earlier ending merger, the nominative already has a front root and gives **flæsċe* in either order. Attested *flasce* ‘flask’ has an independently sourced levelled root, after inflected *flascan* ‘flask’ (Campbell 1959, 61, §158; Luick 1914--1940, 152–53, §161). It must not be used as if

its former executable agreement independently proved a regular back-root nominative history. The consonantal history of the paradigm remains distinct from that root-vowel levelling.

Five witnesses establish the upper boundary collectively. The palatal cluster must already underlie *sċeaft* ‘shaft’, *sċēar* ‘shear’, *sċēaþ* ‘sheath’, *sċēap* ‘sheep’, and *sċield* ‘shield’ before SC056 OEWsPalatalDiphthongization. The **sċea-* ’sea’/*sċie-** set therefore places cluster palatalization before the West Saxon vowel change. The cluster change occupies the same palatalization zone as SC052 OEVelarPalatalization while remaining distinct from plain-velar palatalization and the later vowel changes.

5.39 Class-distinct velar palatalization and fricative merger

5.39.1 Historical discussion

Singleton g, including initial g, was a fricative when palatalization occurred; gg and postnasal g were stops. Palatal articulation, productive cutoff, merger and later affrication are therefore separate questions (Fulk 2018, 130–32; Laker 2007, 166–68, 175–84). The dotted spelling in *dæġ* ‘day’ cannot establish an early affricate or identify every palatal consonant with inherited j.

The adopted working account keeps a palatal fricative ɟ distinct from j during mutation, then merges it with j. Ringe and Taylor explicitly propose this chronology (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–4). It is not unanimous: Hogg objects to the phonetic plausibility of delayed merger and leaves the key/day contradiction unresolved (Hogg 1979, 102–11). We prefer the regular class-distinct account because it explains the contrasting mutation triggers without lexical or grammatical conditions. The objection remains substantive, not silently superseded by a matching final spelling.

Fulk’s earlier comparison treats reversible palatal articulation and later assibilation separately, but does not establish the particular delayed singleton-fricative merger used here (Fulk 1998, 145–49). That merger remains the attributed Ringe–Taylor working account, with Hogg’s objection retained.

Eligibility also requires attribution. Ringe and Taylor’s medial-g table is narrower than Fulk’s before-front-vowel description (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–4; Fulk 2018, 130–32). The present fricative implementation retains its broader domain; this merger decision is not a covert adoption of the narrower table.

Barrack’s cascade distributes the velar material over several rules: palatalization proper as rule 170a (Barrack 1975, 57), the palatal/velar alternations of the written period as rule 428, with *streccan* ‘stretch’ among the cited forms (Barrack 1975, 109), and the back-and-forth adjustments between palatals and velars as rules 432–435, including the *hwilic* ‘which’ type and *ortgeard*/*feccan* (Barrack 1975, 110–12). His decomposition is finer than the class-distinct account adopted here and is keyed to Campbell’s paragraphs rather than to the fricative/stop class distinction; it corroborates the breadth of the palatalization zone without bearing on the disputed merger chronology, since his orderings are formal, not chronological (Barrack 1975, 34).

5.39.2 SC052. Singleton-fricative articulation (`OEGFricativePalatal`)

```
define OEGFricativePalatal [
    [{*g}|{*ɣ}] -> {*ɟ} ||
        [.#.|[EnglishStarAlphabet - [{*g}|{*n}|{*ŋ}]]]
        _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    [{*g}|{*ɣ}] -> {*ɟ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ .#.,
    [{*g}|{*ɣ}] -> {*ɟ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel
        _ [EnglishStarConsonant - [{*j}|{*g}]]
] .o. [
    [{*g}|{*ɣ}] -> {*ɟ} ||
        [.#.|[EnglishStarAlphabet - [{*g}|{*n}|{*ŋ}]]] _ {*j}
];
```

The guards keep gg/ng in their stop paths. The value ȷ is a real phonetic class, not a tag recording a consonant's ancestry. It is transparent to a following mutation trigger, but is not itself j at that date. The source comparison normalizes older fricative notation to modern ɣ/ȷ, never to the digit 3 (Hogg 1979, 105; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 204).

5.39.3 SC052. K articulation and eventual reflex (OEVelarPalatalizationKFront)

```
define OEVelarPalatalizationKFront [
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || .#. _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || _ [{*i} | {*ī}],
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || _ {*í},
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || [{*i} | {*ī}] _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || {*í} _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || [{*i} | {*ī}] _ .#.,
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || {*í} _ .#.
] .o. [
    {*k} {*k} -> {*ʧ} {*ʧ} || _ {*j}
] .o. [
    {*k} -> {*ʧ} || _ {*j}
];
```

Here ʧ is a telescoped eventual-reflex proxy, not a claim that early palatal stops were already affricates. Ringe and Taylor explicitly separate the initial palatal stop from subsequent affrication and its syncope dependencies (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–4). The *weccan* 'wake', *licgan* 'lie' and *lecgan* 'lay' examples concern inherited j-clusters, not independent proof of every plain-velar conditioner (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 213–14).

The deterministic kk-before-j path protects *streċċan* 'stretch'. The original-front versus secondary-front distinction is more directly tested by unrounded key than by rounded *cȳ* 'cow'; rounding alone can give only a cutoff before later unrounding (Hogg 1979, 100–105; Laker 2007, 167–68).

5.39.4 SC052. Retained stop paths (`OEVelarPalatalizationStops`)

```
define OEVelarPalatalizationStops [
    OEVelarPalatalizationKFront
] .o. [
    {*g} -> {*ʤ} || _ [{*i}|{*í}|{*ì}|{*ī}],
    {*g} -> {*ʤ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ .#.,
    {*g} -> {*ʤ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*g} -> {*ʤ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ [EnglishStarConsonant - {*j}],,
    {*g} {*g} -> {*ʤ} {*ʤ} || _ {*j}
] .o. [
    {*g} -> {*ʤ} || _ {*j}
];
```

The following-vowel clause now requires immediately following original *i* or *ī*, including the transducer's stress spellings, rather than any front vowel (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203). This does not narrow the separate singleton-fricative rule. The earlier final-vowel merger makes the ending of *tunge* 'tongue' front before palatalization, but secondary *ǣ* does not meet this stop condition. The corrected calculation retains the stop rather than producing a spurious affricate. Possible effects of preceding *i* through a nasal remain a separate question; no additional such clause is introduced here.

Singleton fricatives have already left this domain. The remaining gg/ng paths use ʤ as an eventual-reflex proxy; the initial singleton fricative is no longer represented as an early affricate. *Wicg* 'horse' is a geminate-class illustration, *senġan* 'singe' a postnasal control, and *lungen* 'lung' the unchanged back-vowel negative (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–4, 213–14; Fulk 2018, 131–32).

The double comma separates the geminate-before-*j* rule's context from the singleton rules' front-vowel contexts. It corrects rewrite-rule scoping, not the proposed historical environment, date or consonant-class distinction. The separate geminate rule must replace the whole cluster, not permit a competing singleton covering.

5.39.5 SC052. Combined articulation (`OEVelarPalatalization`)

```
define OEVelarPalatalization Ctx([
    OEGFricativePalatal .o. OEVelarPalatalizationStops
]);
```

The combined operation does not give every class one sharply dated palatalization/affrication/merger event. It supplies the class distinctions needed by ordinary palatal diphthongization and mutation. The common-stem onset remains a separate question (Luick 1914--1940, 835–41; Fulk 2018, 130–32).

5.39.5.1 Key and day at the mutation checkpoint Hogg's oblique comparison starts here from pre-palatal, pre-OE **kājœ* and **dœɣœ*; neither is silently fed through a PGmc prefix (Hogg 1979, 105). The source target is *cǣġe* 'key', with velar initial k, versus *dœġe* 'day'.

Checkpoint	Key	Day under the adopted account
Before palatalization	**kājœ*	**dœɣœ*
Before mutation	Inherited j remains	Palatal j̯ is distinct from j
After mutation	**kǣjœ*, without new initial palatalization	**dœj̯œ*, without æ-raising
After merger and native realization	*cǣġe*	*dœġe*

Premature merger instead predicts pre-OE †*dejœ* under these premises. The experiment tests that source-based contrast; the existing day nominative is not the oblique discriminator (Hogg 1979, 105–10; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 204).

The complete key suffix additionally requires SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization to retain j after its non-high long front vowel. A correct mutation checkpoint followed by model-only †*cǣie* would not constitute a correct native derivation (Hogg 1979, 105).

5.40 Pretonic front-vowel raising

5.40.1 Inheritance and accentuation

Old English *ġelīefan* 'believe' continues a formation with inherited **ga-*. Gothic *ga-* preserves the older vowel, while Old Saxon and Old High German *gi-* and Old English *ge-* have reduced reflexes. Ringe and Taylor reconstruct **ga-* for Proto-Germanic and Proto-West-Germanic; similar reduced forms do not establish a single shared reduction event. Continental *gasokun* on the Pforzen buckle, externally dated 585–610, supplies neither an English palatal trigger nor a date for English raising (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 206; Runische Schriftlichkeit in den germanischen Sprachen (RuneS), n.d., find 201, inscription and external dating; Berg 2014, 60–61).

The inherited accent is disputed. Bammesberger distinguishes verbal constructions from genuine compounds with nominal second members, reconstructing initial stress for the latter, not for every nominal formation. His strongest phonological argument uses the dental contrast between Gothic *gabaurþs* 'birth' and West Germanic cognates: starting from a voiced dental, Thurneysen's Law would require an unstressed root and hence a stressed prefix. His account also requires particular reconstructions of the formation and inherited accent. Quinlin instead analyses inherited **ga-* as a clitic without primary word stress and contests those premises. An alternative account of inherited dental alternation further prevents the Gothic consonant from

uniquely determining prefix stress. These are competing historical arguments, not observations of Old English metrical stress (Bammesberger 1981, 377–82, 384, especially p. 381 and nn. 9–10; Quinlin 1991, 150–57; Ringe 2017, 305–6).

The often-cited *ġeatwe* 'equipment' is not a secure exception with accented inherited **ga-*. The traditional prefixed analysis connects Old Norse *gǫtvar* 'equipment'; Bammesberger retains it. Quinlin separates *ġeatwe* from *getāwe* 'deeds' and proposes an unprefixed stem related to Gothic *gatwō* 'street'. That alternative requires a semantic bridge which is not independently proved. Campbell himself qualifies the relationship of the associated forms, and Orel retains the equipment word under a different reconstructed base of unknown origin. The disagreement remains unresolved: neither prefixed category membership nor exceptional inherited accent can be assumed. Accordingly this word cannot securely date the prefix's reduction relative to palatal diphthongization (Campbell 1959, 31, §74 n. 5, and p. 149, §358 n. 6; Bammesberger 1981, 384 n. 17; Quinlin 1991, 155–56; Orel 2003, 403).

Ordinary Old English *ge-* and *be-* are weak, with the following root independently stressable. Alliteration and metrical analysis support this distinction; they do not prove an identical accentual system at every prehistoric stage. Grammatical structure can help reconstruct stress without itself conditioning a sound law (Hogg 1992b, 99–100; Minkova 2008, 22–23; Minkova and Zhou 2022, 535–36).

5.40.2 Manuscript distribution

Pheifer's Épinal–Erfurt edition provides the central aggregate evidence. His initial-prefix counts are:

Witness	*gi-*	*ge-*	Total *gi-/ge-*	*bi-* with *i*
Épinal	40	13	53	11
Erfurt	31	34	65	11

The proportions of *gi-* are 75.47% and 47.69%, respectively. These are descriptive proportions in related transmitted texts, not independent samples measuring the rate of a sound change. The denominators differ, and the edition does not enumerate the complete token lists or explicitly state how every corrected prefix enters the totals. Its separate medial/final-vowel exclusions cannot simply be transferred to this sample (Pheifer 1974, lxxv, §63).

The larger distribution complements, rather than replaces, the paired readings. Nine Épinal–Erfurt alignments identified by Toller include differences in both directions; their corresponding Corpus readings have *ge-*. Corpus nevertheless also has *gibrec* 'phlegm', glossing Latin *umecta*. A written correction from *i* to *e* does not itself date phonological lowering. These readings overlap the larger edition's material and must not be counted again as independent confirmations (Toller 1921, 284, s.v. ge-; Sweet 1885, 48–49, 107, 602).

Difficult forms require lexical and editorial discrimination. Épinal *gybyrdid*, beside Erfurt *gebyrdid*, means 'striped(?)' in Pheifer's interpretation, not 'born'; it cannot witness the accent of *ġebyrd* 'birth'. Sweet and Pheifer both print Épinal *gihiodum*, beside Erfurt *gaeadun* and Corpus *geeodun*. The manuscript confirms *h*; Pheifer interprets it as a possible hiatus marker. Pheifer also compares Épinal *saegesetu* with Erfurt *saegaesetu* 'maritime regions', where the disputed vowel is internal. Neither exceptional *ga-* spelling establishes by itself an unraised short vowel after an independently established palatal fricative: early prosody, vowel value and transmission remain material questions (Pheifer 1974, xxiii, lxxv, lxxxiii, §§4, 63, 72, and pp. 6, 13, 39, 74, 108; Sweet 1885, 27–28, 40, 50).

The revised critical edition confirms the *h* in *gi hiodum* and distinguishes manuscript readings from its reconstructed archetype. It also prints Corpus *saegeseotu*, rather than Pheifer's *saegesetu*: real editorial differences must remain distinct from modern transcription errors. Neither this root-vowel difference nor editorial word division decides the prefix's early phonetic history (Herren et al. 2026, letter A, PDF p. 20, Ep A192, and letter P, PDF p. 3, Cp P599).

The dates of manuscripts are not the dates of all their linguistic material. Épinal is placed around 700. Herren and Sauer date the continental Erfurt copy to the second or third decade of the ninth century; Pheifer argues for a common ancestor with Épinal and an intervening English copying layer. Corpus is a related expanded recension, not an unrelated later sample; ninth-century dating does not give every gloss a new phonological date. Dialect, exemplar, English revision and continental copying must remain distinct (Lucas and Lucas 2012, 67; Lucas 2016, 11; Herren and Sauer 2016, 129–32; Pheifer 1974, xli, §24; Pheifer 1987, 34–37).

Seiler's analysis of inherited spelling systems and source batches reinforces this caution: an aggregate need not represent one scribal phonology. Her evidence chiefly concerns wyn and thorn, not a new *gi-/ge-* census or a reclassification of Pheifer's tokens (Seiler 2017, 159–64, 167–68).

Seiler's direct comparison further distinguishes independent copying from independent linguistic evidence. Épinal and Erfurt descend from a shared textual ancestor, with an English intermediary in Erfurt's transmission; the continental copy can preserve inherited orthography as well as revise it. Positional spelling conventions and source batches therefore need not express the phonology of one copyist (Seiler 2019, 527–28, 535–37). Her analysis chiefly concerns the representation of /w/ and /þ/, not prefix vowels. It neither supplies a new *gi-/ge-* census nor corrects Pheifer's figures or the individually checked readings (Seiler 2019, 529–31, 537–38). Erfurt's independent act of copying must not be counted as an independent origin for every spelling.

Early Northumbrian *gistiga* 'climb into/onto' and later Northumbrian *giher* 'hear' and *git-rivadon* 'we trust' prevent a universal early-*gi-*/late-*ge-* spelling calendar. Samuels's Lindisfarne–Rushworth comparison likewise documents late *gi-* forms, but its principal contrast concerns the presence or absence of the whole prefix, not a vowel-frequency census or proof of influence from *bi-*. Hogg explicitly allows spelling confusion and, in late Northumbrian, a raised allophone. The attested spellings are more secure than a unique phonemic interpretation of each vowel (Sweet 1885, 125; 1871, 3; Stevenson 1840, 7, collects 2–3; Samuels 1949, 109–11; Hogg 2011, 238–39, §§6.53–6.54).

5.40.3 Regular reconstruction and prosodic domain

The preferred reconstruction remains ordinary unstressed fronting, palatalization, raising and later lowering: **ga-* > **gæ-* > **gi-* > **ge-*. Ringe and Taylor consider regular raising of short pretonic **æ* after a palatal fricative as one possibility, alongside influence from *bi-*. The preceding high front articulation supplies a plausible phonetic motivation, not direct measurement of the intermediate vowel. Fronting and later weak-vowel merger are independently supported (Campbell 1959, 140–41, §§333–334, and pp. 153–155, §§369–370; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 334–35).

Fronting and merger alone give late *ge-* but do not explain genuine early *gi-* without an additional account. A raised realization rather than an obligatory separate high-vowel stage remains possible; Hogg's posttonic raising before following palatals and late Northumbrian allophony, however, do not independently establish that early pathway after a preceding fricative. Influence from *bi-* is another published possibility, not a demonstrated replacement. Pheifer's uniform *bi-* and variable *gi-* are not matched for stress or lexical distribution; he considers stressed *bi-* and an ablaut variant corresponding to continental *ga-* as possible explanations. No positive redistribution or substitution has been established. Equally, spelling alone does not demonstrate an obligatory separate high-vowel phonemic stage. Regular raising is the more economical working reconstruction within the adopted regular account, not an experimentally observed mechanism (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 335; Berg 2014, 60–61; Pheifer 1974, lxxv, §63; Hogg 1992a, sects 6.51–6.54 (held 2011 reprint, pp. 238–239)).

Weakness does not require word-initial position. Minkova's *mísgewìeld* 'error' has the grouping *(mís-ge)-(wìeld)*, with weak internal *ge-* incorporated into the first prosodic word. In *geédnìwad* 'restored', *ge-(éd)-(nì.wad)* has a weak outer prefix before an independently stressed inner element and hiatus. The form *únforcùð* 'dishonest' supplies a comparable multi-domain structure, not the same palatal raising environment. These analyses are grounded in Old English evidence; they cannot simply be projected back as Proto-Germanic accent. Minkova also notes the lack of

equivalent evidence for extending the analysis to finite double-prefixed verbs (Minkova 2008, 38–41).

Manuscript grouping can similarly join weak material to a preceding unit. Prosodic words, stress feet and written words therefore need not coincide. The present derivations cover one initial short weak syllable before an independently headed domain, not every attested compound structure. Internal *modgidanc* ‘thought’ and *saegaesetu* deserve historical domain analysis; they are not irrelevant because the formula is word-initial, but neither yet supplies a securely reconstructed early same-environment test. No independent non-**ga-* positive or genuine same-environment unraised negative has been established (Sweet 1885, 149; Pheifer 1974, lxxv, 39; Riegger et al. 2024, 2065–68).

The lexical concentration of the evidence is consequential: a rule without a prefix label is not thereby independently demonstrated across the vocabulary. Its regular phonological conditioning remains a testable reconstruction of this prefix family’s history, rather than a securely established generalization from several unrelated families.

5.40.4 SC035. Raising of pretonic **æ* after a palatal fricative (OEPrefixAReduction)

```
define OEPrefixAReduction SentenceCtx([
    {*æ} -> {*i} || .#. {*ᶠ} OEAnyConsonant* {*j̵} _
]);
```

The conditioning is shortness, pretonic weakness and an immediately preceding palatal fricative, not prefix identity. The superscript `*ᶠ` is supplied by an earlier stress-foot-context operation: it marks one initial short unaccented vowel separated by one or more consonants from an explicitly acute-accented following vowel in the reconstructed input. It preserves that positively encoded headed structure when later rules remove the input accents. This is nonsegmental notation for reconstructed prosody, not a manuscript sign, a sound or an unrestricted parser of Old English stress. Hiatus, long weak vowels, multiple pretonics and internal weak syllables require their own historical analysis; the annotation does not parse them.

The complementary lack of weak-vowel diphthongization follows from SC056 OEWsPalatalDiphthongization: the ordinary process requires a stressed vowel at the beginning of a headed foot. Both *sċeaft* ‘shaft’ and *ġesċeaft* ‘creation’ diphthongize the stressed root after the sh-sound, but the latter’s weak first vowel does not diphthongize. The model also derives *ġestīgan* ‘climb into/onto’. These comparisons support the stress distinction without making contested *ġeatwe* ‘equipment’ its sole diagnostic (Hogg 1992a, sect. 5.48 n. 1 (held 2011 reprint, p. 104); Ringe and Taylor 2014, 335).

For *ġelīefan* ‘believe’, SC107 EAFBrighteningUnstressed supplies the front vowel and SC052 OEVelarPalatalization the fricative trigger. The rule raises the weak vowel; SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger leaves that high vowel intact; SC076 OEPrefixIReduction later lowers it to *e*. These are feeding requirements of the adopted reconstruction, not independently dated events inferred from a final match. Hogg places weak *i* lowering marginally after the earlier front-vowel merger; Pheifer’s transmitted spelling counts alone do not date that interval (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 245, 267, 335; Hogg 1992a, sects 6.50–6.54 (held 2011 reprint, pp. 237–239)).

The staged account is retained with qualified confidence: it explains early high-vowel evidence through regular phonology, while the bounded implementation neither claims universal compound coverage nor treats one successful derivation as independent proof of historical generality.

5.41 Post-velar w-loss

5.41.1 SC053. Loss of **w* after velars (`OEPostVelarWLoss`)

```
define OEPostVelarWLoss Ctx([
    {*w} -> 0 || {*n} {*g} _
]);
```

The comparative development `*singwan > singan` establishes narrow post-velar **w*-loss in the **ngw* sequence, yielding *singan* ‘sing’. Moving SC053 OEPostVelarWLoss earlier or later leaves every output unchanged. Its pre-umlaut position therefore rests on comparative evidence, while the present lexicon supplies no neighboring boundary.

5.42 West Saxon palatal diphthongization

5.42.1 SC056. West Saxon palatal diphthongization (OEWsPalatalDiphthongization)

```
define OEWsPalatalDiphthongization FootCtx([
    {*æ} -> {*ea} || .#. [{*ʧ} | {*ʤ} | {*ȷ} | {*ʃ} | {*j}] _
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#.],
    {*ǣ} -> {*ēa} || .#. [{*ʧ} | {*ʤ} | {*ȷ} | {*ʃ} | {*j}] _
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#.],
    {*e} -> {*ie} || .#. [{*ʧ} | {*ʤ} | {*ȷ} | {*ʃ} | {*j}] _
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#.],
    {*ē} -> {*īe} || .#. [{*ʧ} | {*ʤ} | {*ȷ} | {*ʃ} | {*j}] _
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#.],
    {*é} -> {*íe} || .#. [{*ʧ} | {*ʤ} | {*ȷ} | {*ʃ} | {*j}] _
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#.],
    {*ǽ} -> {*īe} || .#. [{*ʧ} | {*ʤ} | {*ȷ} | {*ʃ} | {*j}] _
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#.]
]);
```

West Saxon *gieldan* ‘pay’, *scield* ‘shield’, and *scieppan* ‘create’ show diphthongization after an already palatal consonant (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–16, §6.5.1). Their dialectal and phonological restriction separates this development from system-wide i-umlaut.

Hogg’s *giefan* ‘give’ and *sceap* ‘sheep’ belong to the same palatal-consonant environment (Hogg 1992b, 112). Fulk likewise assigns this diphthongization a place before front mutation and distinguishes the two processes (Fulk 2018, 74, §4.13).

The relevant beginning is that of a headed stress foot, not necessarily the word. Hogg’s *sċeaft* ‘shaft’ and *ġesċeaft* ‘creation’ both have diphthongization in the stressed root after the sh-sound. The weak first vowel of *ġesċeaft* ‘creation’ does not diphthongize after the initial j-sound. The context operation in the printed rule preserves an explicitly identified pretonic syllable and applies the ordinary rule to the following headed domain. It does not suppress diphthongization throughout a prefixed word or infer weakness from a missing late accent (Hogg 1992a, sect. 5.48 n. 1 (held 2011 reprint, p. 104)).

This foot-based reformulation retains ordinary diphthongization before mutation; it does not reopen the separate later treatment of mutation products. Its complementary pretonic vocalism is discussed under SC035 OEPrefixAReduction.

The ordinary live applications comprise *ġiefan* ‘give’, *ġiest* ‘guest’, *sċeaft* ‘shaft’, *sċieran* ‘shear’, *sċēap* ‘sheep’, *sċield* ‘shield’ and *ġēar* ‘year’. Gift is unchanged at this rule because its selected vowel already reflects earlier raising. Sheath changes from the mutation product **ǣ* to **ēa*; it supplies evidence for the later *sċ* layer, not the date of the ordinary treatment represented by the other examples.

The adopted ordinary process precedes mutation and preserves the split- diphthong and high-i negative controls. The reported absence of a later displacement failure supplies no positive historical terminus.

5.43 Old English i-umlaut

5.43.1 SC055. Fronting under i-umlaut (`OEIUmlautFronting`)

```
define OEIUmlautFronting [
    {*a} -> {*æ} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ā} -> {*ǣ} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*e} -> {*i} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*o} -> {*e} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ō} -> {*ē} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ù} -> {*ỳ} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*u} -> {*y} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ū} -> {*ȳ} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*á} -> {*æ} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*é} -> {*i} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ó} -> {*e} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ú} -> {*y} || _ EnglishIUmlautThroughU EnglishIUmlautTrigger
];
```

The breadth of i-umlaut appears in lexical classes that share only a following high front vocoid. The forms *fylgan* ‘follow’, *gylden* ‘golden’, *wyrm* ‘worm’, and *giest* ‘guest’ exemplify the same `i`- or `j`-conditioned fronting across different vowels (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 222, §6.6.1; Campbell 1959, 69–72, §§190–191).

The selected cow and lung inputs are negative controls on the present palatalization rule. Moving the composite umlaut rule before that rule yields †*ċȳ* and †*lungen* instead of *cȳ* ‘cow’ and *lungen* ‘lung’. This constrains the current rule’s productive domain; it does not assign every consonantal layer the same date. In particular the selected *cȳ* is a dative-singular input, not evidence from an assumed generic plural.

The stored gift and sheath displacement failures constrain the current serialization, not a universal historical upper boundary. The former gift input left an earlier raising to this late rule; sheath represents the later *sċ* treatment of a mutation product. Moving the entire palatal-diphthongization bundle earlier strands sheath and diphthongizes the model’s still-unraised gift vowel. Neither failure overturns the independently supported ordinary palatal-diphthongization-before-mutation account.

Short medial *u* can undergo mutation while transmitting it to the preceding stressed monophthong. Hogg explicitly describes this iterative development, and Campbell calls it double umlaut. The fronting context therefore includes intervening plain medial *u*, not a secondary-stressed *ù*. The latter keeps its stress as the internal carrier *ỳ* through both high-syncope components and weak-vowel unrounding. The ordinary raising and diphthong components keep their existing contexts; newly fronted *æ* across a mutation-produced *y* is not indiscriminately raised again (Hogg 2011, 120–21, §5.76, p. 219, §6.10; Campbell 1959, 80–81, §203).

```
define EnglishIUmlautThroughU [EnglishIUmlautIntervening [{*u}
 ↪  EnglishIUmlautIntervening]*];
```

The independent outmost/furthest reconstruction and the separate nonhigh-vowel and subordinate-stress controls are discussed with SC065 OEMedialSyncope; retained weak-vowel unrounding is the separate early component SC115 OEHighLinkSyncope. This coupled correction preserves the previously selected mutation and breaking histories.

5.43.2 SC055. Raising under i-umlaut (`OEIUmlautRaising`)

```
define OEIUmlautRaising [
    {*æ} -> {*e} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger
];
```

Raising of umlauted `æ` to `e` continues the same assimilatory event as fronting and therefore shares the chronology of general i-umlaut.

The four displacement controls concern the composite rule. They are not independent tests of this raising component: for example, the cow vowel changes in the fronting component, not in this **æ*-raising clause. Component chronology must follow the source-supported assimilatory event, with ordinary palatal diphthongization and the later *sċ* extension kept distinct.

The sources do not describe umlaut as simple fronting alone. Campbell notes that the low front vowel changes again before m and n in most dialects (Campbell 1959, 69, §190), and Hogg likewise treats short front vowels as part of the same assimilatory system (Hogg 1992b, 113).

5.43.3 SC055. Diphthongal outcomes under i-umlaut (`OEIUmlautDiphthong`)

```
define OEIUmlautDiphthong [
    {*ea} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ēa} -> {*īe} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*io} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*īo} -> {*īe} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*eo} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ēo} -> {*īe} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*éa} -> {*íe} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*éo} -> {*íe} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
    {*ío} -> {*íe} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger
];
```

Diphthongal outcomes belong to the same system-wide assimilation as simple-vowel fronting and raising. All three therefore belong to a single historical event.

The relevant examples are the recurring West-Saxon ie forms cited in the handbooks, including *giest* ‘guest’, *giefan* ‘give’, and *hierde* ‘shepherd’ in Campbell and *ciest* ‘chest’ in Hogg (Campbell 1959, 69–72, 78–80, §§190–191, 248–251; Hogg 1992b, 113–14). These diphthongal outcomes form a distinct part of the general umlautal development alongside simple fronting.

Those composite displacement controls do not isolate diphthongal mutation: neither the cow input nor the gift input has a diphthong here. In the conventional history, diphthongs produced by ordinary palatal diphthongization can be mutated, as in the source derivation of *ġiest* ‘guest’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 216). The adopted derivation now follows that ea-to-ie source path. The former simple-vowel route converged on the same final form, showing why final agreement alone could not establish the relative chronology.

5.43.4 SC055. The composite i-umlaut rule (`OEIUmlaut`)

```
define OEIUmlaut FootCtx(OEIUmlautFronting
    .o. OEIUmlautRaising
    .o. OEIUmlautDiphthong);
```

The literature presents fronting, raising, and diphthongal mutation as effects of one historical development. They consequently occupy a single place in the Old English chronology.

The cow/lung displacement results require the present productive palatalization rule not to consume those mutation-created environments. The historical interpretation still depends on the relevant consonantal layer and inherited versus secondary front-vowel conditions.

There is no single source-supported upper boundary at the entire West Saxon bundle. Ordinary palatal diphthongization precedes mutation in the handbook account; the later *sċ* treatment of some mutation products follows it. The former gift input and sheath’s later layer explained the old bundled serialization, not a date for every historical palatal process.

5.44 Noninitial w-loss before unstressed i

5.44.1 SC054. Noninitial **w*-loss before unstressed **i/ī* (`OEWLossBeforeI`)

```
define OEWLossBeforeI Ctx([
    {*w} -> 0 || EnglishStarVocalic EnglishStarConsonant* _ [{*i}|{*ī}]
]);
```

The history of *sǣ* ‘sea’ exemplifies noninitial **w*-loss before unstressed **i*. Campbell describes the loss, Ringe and Taylor derive the form from **saiwi-*/**sawi-*, and Luick gives the parallel trajectory (Campbell 1959, 166–67, §406; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 258–60, §6.7.1; Luick 1914--1940, 173, §187). The environment is neither exclusively postvocalic nor exclusively final: Ringe and Taylor also give weak-verb forms in **-Cwi-* and **pulwīn* > **pylwī* > **pylī*, yielding *pyle* ‘pillow’. The preceding nucleus distinguishes noninitial *w* from an initial cluster; the unaccented target excludes stressed high vowels. No lexical exemption or loanword-specific clause is used.

Ringe and Taylor independently place this loss after i-umlaut and before general syncope: the histories of *eowu* ‘ewe’ and *gierede* ‘prepared’ supply the chronology, rather than successful output alone (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 258–60). The early final-n loss in SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss and this distinct glide loss together explain *pyle*.

The former sea-only displacement supplied two distant implementation limits: before SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion or after SC063 OEHighVowelApocope, that older final-only rule yielded †*sǣw* rather than expected OE *sǣ* ‘sea’. Those receipts remain historical evidence for the former implementation, not current tests of the adopted noninitial environment. In particular, they do not independently demonstrate that the present rule requires final *z*-deletion to expose its target. Its placement after mutation and before general syncope rests on the cited histories, not on promoting the former rule’s displacement bounds.

5.45 Technical support: late palatal diphthongization

5.45.1 SC105. Retained late palatal-diphthongization approximation (OELatePalatalDiphthong)

```
define OELatePalatalDiphthong Ctx([
    {*ǣ} -> {*ēa} || .#. [{*ɥ} | {*ɰ} | {*ɟ} | {*ʃ} | {*j}] _
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#.]
]);
```

This support operation retains exactly the former postmutation long-vowel clause. Its sole current application is *sċēaþ* ‘sheath’. The four initial triggers are an unchanged approximation, not a source-proven complete historical conditioner. Campbell and Ringe–Taylor distinguish the later class (Campbell 1959, 68–69; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 235); the incremental implementation does not claim to have resolved it.

5.46 J-cluster coalescence

5.46.1 Historical discussion

Only a small lexical group reveals the coalescence of velars with **j*. Plain-velar and **sk* palatalization must already have run before **gj* and **kj* acquire their later outcomes. Campbell, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk discuss the palatalized and fronted outcomes in *bīeġan* ‘bend’ and *sēċan* ‘seek’ without assigning this later cluster adjustment the status of a major sound law (Campbell 1959, 89, 107–8, §§170, 248–251; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 213–51, §§6.4.1, 6.5.1, 6.6.1–6.6.4; Fulk 2018, 65, 75, §§4.7, 4.13).

5.46.2 SC057. Coalescence of velar + **j* clusters (`OEJClusterCoalescence`)

```
define OEJClusterCoalescence Ctx((
    # *bj coalescence removed: BAllophony (*b→*β) + JLossAfterHeavy handle
    # non-geminated *bj; for geminated *bbj, *j is consumed by JLossAfterHeavy.
    [{*g} {*j} -> {*ȝ}]
    .o. [{*k} {*j} -> {*ȸ}]
));
```

The forms *bīeġan* ‘bend’ and *sēċan* ‘seek’ determine the earlier boundary. If coalescence precedes SC052 OEVelarPalatalization, the developments behind *bīeġan* ‘bend’ and *sēċan* ‘seek’ are lost. Related forms such as *fylġan* ‘follow’, *heċġ* ‘hedge’, and *sengan* ‘singe’ fail in the same broader palatalization zone. PGmc **báugijaną* ‘bow’ yields †*bēaġan* rather than expected OE *bīeġan*, and PGmc **sōkijaną* ‘seek’ yields †*sōċan* rather than expected *sēċan*. This constrains this computational cluster consumer. It does not independently date all singleton-fricative articulation or merger: the latter is distinct from this rule and is now explicit under SC109 OEPalatalFricativeMerger (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 204; Laker 2007, 167–68). Nothing in the present lexicon supplies a terminus ante quem for the cluster consumer.

5.47 Back mutation

5.47.1 Historical discussion

West Saxon *giefan* ‘give’ and *wefan* ‘weave’ stand against non-West-Saxon *geofad* ‘gave’ and *weofan* ‘weave’. Ringe and Taylor use this contrast to define the dialectal profile of back mutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 319, §6.9.4). Campbell’s treatment of diphthongization before following back vowels includes *heofon* ‘heaven’ (Campbell 1959, 86, §207), while Hogg draws the instructive comparison with breaking (Hogg 1992b, 113). Fulk accordingly separates back mutation from the earlier umlautal changes (Fulk 2018, 69, §4.8). Barrack likewise states back mutation apart from the earlier mutations, as his rules 210 and 212 with a continuation at 220 (Barrack 1975, 63–66); his residual-ordering discussion uses a back umlaut form, *heolap*, as the worked example of a rule pair whose formal order must be reversed for a residue (210 against his rule 355.5) (Barrack 1975, 36), which illustrates his insistence that such orderings are logical rather than chronological relations (Barrack 1975, 34).

5.47.2 SC059. Back mutation before labials and liquids (`OEBackMutation`)

```
define OEBackMutation Ctx([
    {*e} -> {*eo} || _ [EnglishStarLabial | EnglishStarLiquid] {*u},
    {*æ} -> {*ea} || _ [EnglishStarLabial | EnglishStarLiquid]
     ↪  EnglishBackMutationTrigger,
    # Stressed variant (stress preserved on first element):
    {*é} -> {*éo} || _ [EnglishStarLabial | EnglishStarLiquid] {*u}
]);
```

Three witness forms bracket the chronology. If back mutation precedes SC048 OESecondaryNasalization, forms such as **gébaną* ‘give’ produce *ġeofan* ‘give’; the expected form is *ġiefan* ‘give’. **stélaną* ‘steal’ likewise produces *steolan* ‘steal’; the expected form is *stelan* ‘steal’. At the other edge, delaying back mutation until after SC078 OEWeakTailReduction makes **wébaną* ‘weave’ yield *weofan* ‘weave’; the expected form is *wefan* ‘weave’. Thus back mutation follows secondary nasalization but precedes the weak-tail reductions.

5.48 West Saxon palatal umlaut

5.48.1 Historical discussion

The reflexes *miht* ‘might’ and *niht* ‘night’ place West Saxon palatal umlaut after the principal umlautal developments. Campbell and Ringe and Taylor describe the forms themselves; Fulk sup-

plies the broader chronology of palatal-vowel change (Campbell 1959, 107–8, §§248–251; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–51, §§6.5.1, 6.6.1–6.6.4; Fulk 2018, 65, 75, §§4.7, 4.13).

5.48.2 SC060. West Saxon palatal umlaut before **h*-clusters (OEWsPalatalUmlaut)

```
define OEWsPalatalUmlaut Ctx([
    {*eo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,
    {*io} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,
    {*ie} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,
    {*eo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*io} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*ie} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    # Stressed variants (stress absorbed: result is short i):
    {*éo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,
    {*ío} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,
    {*íe} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,
    {*éo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*ío} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,
    {*íe} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel
]);
```

The change to **i* before **h*-clusters can be ordered only on its earlier side. If palatal umlaut precedes SC055 OEIUmlaut, the forms behind *miht* ‘might’ and *niht* ‘night’ remain at the overdeveloped stage †*mieht* and †*nieht* rather than expected OE *miht* and *niht*. Consequently, i-umlaut precedes palatal umlaut. Reordering the latter against any tested later change leaves both witness forms unchanged.

5.49 Weak-tail nasal loss

5.49.1 Historical discussion

The pathway from **dōną* ‘do’ to *dōn* ‘do’ supplies the sole lexical thread through this reduction. Campbell, Hogg, and Fulk place such weak-tail losses among apocope and related late reductions (Campbell 1959, 144–45, §§345–349; Hogg 1992b, 121; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6). The witness, however, ties the change to a much older development. Its immediate neighbors remain untested.

5.49.2 SC061. Reduction of final nasal weak-tail endings (OEWeakTailNasalLoss)

```
define OEWeakTailNasalLoss Ctx([
    {*n} {*ą} -> {*n} || _ .#.,
    {*m} {*ą} -> {*m} || _ .#.
]);
```

Final weak-tail **-ną* and **-mą* accordingly yield plain **-n* and **-m*.

Only *dōn* ‘do’ constrains the relative order. Placing this loss before the older n-stem loss makes the derivation record no output instead of expected OE *dōn* ‘do’. The older loss must therefore precede weak-tail nasal loss. Nothing in the current lexicon distinguishes among its possible later positions, and one witness cannot establish a wider historical development.

5.50 Ordinary nonhigh-vowel syncope

5.50.1 Historical discussion

Old English nonhigh-vowel syncope must be distinguished from the later high-vowel losses. Hogg describes loss of a short nonhigh vowel in an open medial syllable, after both light and heavy roots, with restoration and paradigm interactions considered separately. His account

places the process after umlaut and before unstressed *i* lowers (Hogg 1992a, 220–22, §§6.14–6.18). Luick's longer-word cases warn against reducing the domain to exactly three syllables (Luick 1914--1940, 279–80, §303). These are phonological and prosodic conditions, not permissions for particular words or grammatical classes.

The implemented core deletes plain short *a, æ, e* from an open posttonic syllable. Primary-root weight and final-syllable weight are not additional deletion conditions. A following singleton consonant and vowel identify the bounded open-medial domain; this does not silently claim complete syllabification of arbitrary consonant clusters. A positively identified primary root protects its own vowel, and the existing stress-domain machinery admits the supported single pretonic syllable. Wider multiprefix histories are not inferred from this restricted account.

5.50.1.1 Selected applications and contrasting forms The strong masculine nominative plural participle **fúnðanai* gives *fundne* 'found', attested in *Juliana*335. The inherited ending becomes long *ē*; medial *a* then disappears before its still-heavy final syllable, and later shortening gives final *e*. The cell is supported independently by the edition's syntax and glossary, while the reconstructed whole word combines participial formation and adjectival inflection (Strunk 1904, 15, 82; Fulk 2018, 209, §9.2, p. 284, §12.30). The genuine longer *fundene* 'found' and competing inherited participial suffixes remain evidence for the wider paradigm, not exceptions manufactured by changing the sound law.

The inherited accusative **sáiwalǭ* gives *sāwle* 'soul'. After stressed-diphthong monophthongization, medial *a* is lost before the quantity-bearing inherited ending; its later decoding and shortening supply final *e*. The ending notation does not imply unchanged late phonetic nasal rounding. Luke12:20 establishes the accusative, distinct from the neighbouring dative and vocative (Skeat 1874, 130). No raising proxy or epenthesis is required in this selected span. Fulk's competing metrical account and the syncope/apocope/epenthesis history proposed for nominatives remain independent questions (Fulk 2010, 133–39; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 265, 330).

Citation *hamer* 'hammer' is a nonapplication: earlier final-vowel loss leaves the nonhigh vowel in the last syllable. By contrast, the longer genitive input predicts *hamres*, not attested *hameres* 'of a hammer'; that wider history remains unresolved (Wright 1884, vol. 1, p. 272, line 36; Toller 1921, 505). The inherited neuter base **wéstą* gives *west* 'westwards' through existing nasal-vowel apocope, with no medial syncope target (Orel 2003, 459; Fulk 2018, 146, §7.8).

5.50.1.2 Relative chronology and limits The executable position immediately before SC063 OEHighVowelApocope preserves visibility of the inherited final quantity. That serialization is a model-local representation choice, not a new independently demonstrated historical ordering inferred from output success. The source-supported chronology and the notation's lifetime must be kept separate. The rules SC065 OEMedialSyncope and SC066 OELAdjacentSyncope now distinguish ordinary heavy/open high-vowel loss from later light pre-**l* loss. *Weorold* 'world' retains its established selected history. *Eorþcunde* 'earthly' and *reġnboga* 'rainbow' now lose the linking **a* here rather than through the former early proxy.

5.50.2 Compound formation and comparative linking-vowel evidence

Compound members with weakened force often lose or reshape their linking vowels, and Campbell treats that broad pattern through reduced second elements, connecting vowels, and obscured compounds (Campbell 1959, 148–49, §§356–357; Campbell 1959, 153, §367; Campbell 1959, 159, §§386–387).

Those discussions concern several distinct developments: modification and shortening within obscured second roots, connecting-vowel insertion, and weak-vowel quality changes do not by themselves demonstrate deletion of a linking vowel. For syncope, the relevant distinction is between short nonhigh vowels, whose loss does not require a heavy first syllable, and high linking *i/u*, whose regular heavy-root loss supplies the weight condition modelled under SC065 OEMedialSyncope. That condition is not an exhaustive account of all historical compound losses. The handbooks compare retention in light-root *Winifrið/Winefrið* and *duruweard* 'doorkeeper' with loss in *dælnimend* 'partaker' and *handclāð* 'towel' (Campbell 1959, 143, §341; Campbell 1959,

145–46, §§348–353; Hogg 2011, 220–23, §§6.14–6.19; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 266–67; Brunner 1965, 137–38, §§167–168). These are comparison forms, not additional selected derivations. Variant first stems and the *hild-/hilde-* material require source-critical analysis rather than an automatic rule conditioned by the identity or weight of the second member (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 303).

The handbook comparisons do not yet provide a selected complete history testing the newly restricted high-vowel clause. In particular, Orel reconstructs Proto-Germanic **đura-warđaz* 'doorkeeper', with an *a*-linker, and compares Gothic *daura-wards* 'doorkeeper'; Kroonen derives the Old English simplex *duru* 'door' from **durō-*. Neither fact establishes an inherited short linking *u* in *duruweard* 'doorkeeper', nor an independently demonstrated change supplying it before syncope. Its attested vowel cannot simply be substituted into the earlier compound reconstruction. The retained name vowels also need their own formation histories (Orel 2003, 79; Kroonen 2013, 110; Brunner 1965, 137–38, §168).

The older names cannot simply be dismissed as exceptions to a universal heavy-root requirement. Sievers and Brunner, Campbell, Luick and Hogg explicitly recognize high-vowel loss after light first roots, including *Sigfrið* and *Hyglāc*. Luick distinguishes chronological layers and says that the circumstances of the change are not yet understood. Hogg also discusses the second member's weight. These observations require a bounded reconsideration of an exhaustive weight-only account; they do not license lexical optionality, a rule restricted to personal names, or an unsupported appeal to analogy. Nor does the manuscript date of a name independently date its formation or syncope (Brunner 1965, 137–38, §168; Campbell 1959, 145–46, §§348–349; Luick 1914--1940, 283–84, §305; Hogg 2011, 224–25, §6.21).

seleweard 'hall-warden' provides a stronger retained-vowel candidate. Orel prints **sali-warđaz* and **sali-warđuz*, with Old Norse *sal-vǫrðr* 'hall-warden'. Both reconstructions have first-member *i*; their alternatives concern the second member's inflection, not an *a/i* linker choice. The first member's secondary i-stem history is independently supported. Nevertheless, these transparent formations do not discriminate inheritance of this particular compound from later independent formation: Orel expressly reports Carr's parallel-formation assessment. Beowulf attests the Old English accusative singular, but does not independently place the compound before the relevant syncope. Neither an ending nor a high linker has to be invented; the unresolved premise is formation chronology (Orel 2003, 315, 448; Kroonen 2013, 424; Clark Hall 1960, 260, Beowulf 667).

The canonical grammar now recognizes inherited high-vowel first members and the second member's dental cluster without sacrificing older accepted analyses. Both printed hypotheses, and the ordinary a-stem accusative **sáli-wàrðą*, regularly produce *seleweard*. Previously the retained plain medial *i* incorrectly underwent breaking, producing †*seleoweard*. Restoring the former early high-vowel deletion instead produces †*sealweard*; removing the later weight condition produces †*selweard*. These are three distinct wrong analyses, not three attestations. Correct output establishes a conditional derivation, not the date or inheritance of the compound.

No new lexical selection is made without that independent formation premise. Complete selected weight controls and independently reconstructed later-stage controls now test the high-vowel core described under SC065 OEMedialSyncope; they do not supply a complete inherited-compound discriminator for the former early rule. *reġnboga* 'rainbow' and *eorþcunde* 'earthly' remain genuine selected *a*-deletion witnesses, not evidence for the new high-vowel restriction. The source-proposed *ūtumist* history supplies a distinct transmitted-mutation and weak-vowel-loss control; its final root alone does not independently order mutation against loss of *u* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 267).

Barrack's weak-vowel fronting and quality rules 333a/b and his rounding rule 335 belong to this wider discussion, but are not equivalent linking-vowel deletion laws. Their formal ordering is not independent evidence for dating syncope or removal of secondary stress (Barrack 1975, 82–84).

The former SC037 OECompoundLinkingSyncope proxy captured this pattern in *reġnboga* 'rainbow'. Its second-root vowel has already lowered under subordinate stress: **régna-bùgô* > **régna-bògô*. The grave survives that early change and formerly licensed early deletion of the linking vowel, giving **régnbògô*; ordinary accent stripping formerly gave **régnbogô*. The full account

and its reconstruction qualifications belong to SC017 PNWGmcULowering, not to late unstressed lowering. Its immediate annotation dependency does not date historical nonhigh syncope. The handbooks place ordinary nonhigh syncope after breaking, and high-vowel loss normally after mutation. The early *a* fragment is retained as a selected-input holding proxy in the earlier model. It is now an identity: ordinary nonhigh deletion applies here, independently of a surviving grave, and inherited **b* receives positional realization afterward under SC049 PGmcBAllophony. The high-vowel component follows mutation (Brunner 1965, 137–38, §167 and notes; Hogg 2011, 220–24, §§6.14–6.20; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 266–67).

The earlier proxy's apparent dependency on grave removal did not date a universal loss of compound secondary stress. The relevant junctures also relate to SC035 OEPrefixAReduction and SC036 OEInterStressRaising. Russom's metrical review challenges obligatory positional destressing; modern stress marks are annotations, not independent prosodic evidence for every historical name (Russom 2001, 39–64).

5.50.3 SC114. Ordinary nonhigh syncope (`OENonHighSyn`)

```
define OENonHighSyn FootCtx([
    [{*a}|{*æ}|{*e}] -> 0 ||
        .#. OEAnyConsonant* EnglishStarVocalic
        [OEAnyConsonant+ EnglishStarVocalic]* OEAnyConsonant+
        _ OEAnyConsonant EnglishStarVocalic
        [OEAnyConsonant|EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}]* .#.
]);
```

5.51 B allophony

5.51.1 Historical discussion

The positional alternation of Germanic **b* is a Proto-Germanic distributional feature. Hogg states the Old English distribution clearly: /b/ is a stop initially, after nasals, and in gemination, while the same segment is otherwise realized as a voiced bilabial fricative (Hogg 2011, 29–30, §§2.53–2.54). Ringe and Taylor support the broader West Germanic background by treating Proto-West-Germanic **b* as a segment whose stop and fricative values depend on position (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 121), and Luick's spelling evidence shows the same labial fricative pattern in Old English (Luick 1914--1940, 107).

The distribution is narrow, but later changes presuppose the stop-fricative alternation. CAPR implements the rule at a late cascade position for computational reasons: the alternation must interact with consonant environments shaped by intermediate rule applications. The inherited distribution is Proto-Germanic; the position at which CAPR realizes it is not a new Proto-Germanic event.

Hogg distinguishes the early bilabial fricative, still an allophone of inherited /b/, from its later split and merger with /f/. Campbell's spelling discussion likewise distinguishes inherited labial realization from secondary voicing of /f/ (Hogg 2011, 29–30, §§2.53–2.54; Campbell 1959, 179–81, §§444–448). CAPR retains underlying **b* until ordinary nonhigh syncope has established its conditioning environment. This removes the need for early compound deletion; it does not insert a later **β* > **b* sound law.

The distinction matters: already represented **β* and inherited **f* remain fricatives after nasals, whereas underlying **b* has stop realization there. Initial, postnasal and geminate stops are preserved; intervocalic **b* receives fricative realization. Syncope-created velar clusters do not license analogous hardening: Ringe and Taylor contrast *syngian* 'sin' with inherited stop clusters (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 4). The chosen serialization precedes the labial split in the model, not a newly demonstrated strict historical boundary.

5.51.2 SC049. Distribution of **b* after vowels and liquids (PGmcBAllophony)

```
define PGmcBAllophony Ctx([
    {*b} -> {*β} || PGmcStarVocalic _,
    {*b} -> {*β} || [{*l} | {*r}] _
] .o. [
    {*β} -> {*b} || _ {*b}
]);
```

Realization before SC114 OENonHighSyn gives †*reġnfoga* instead of *reġnboga* ‘rainbow’; realization afterward preserves the selected output. This discriminates the representations, not an independently dated new lenition law or compound-specific exemption.

5.52 Early medial realization of unstressed shortening

5.51.1 SC117. Medial component of SC072 unstressed shortening (OEMedLongShort)

```
define OEMedLongShort FootCtx([
    {*ī} -> {*i} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _ OEAnyConsonant+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}],
    {*ū} -> {*u} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _ OEAnyConsonant+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}],
    {*ȳ} -> {*y} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _ OEAnyConsonant+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}],
    {*ā} -> {*a} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _ OEAnyConsonant+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}],
    {*ē} -> {*e} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _ OEAnyConsonant+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}],
    {*ǣ} -> {*æ} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _ OEAnyConsonant+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}],
    {*ō} -> {*o} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _ OEAnyConsonant+
     ↪  [EnglishStarVocalic|{*ô}]
]);
```

This separately visible component belongs to SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening. It realizes the medial quantity required before SC063 OEHighVowelApocope, without prematurely shortening final long vowels. Goering distinguishes later **nētīn*, yielding *nēten* ‘livestock’, from the medially shortened inflected forms that yield *nētenu* ‘livestock’ and *nētna* ‘of livestock’ (Goering 2016, 186–88; 2023, 67–68). The same quantity distinction is required in the earlier comparison of unstressed vowels (Fulk 2018, 90–96, §§5.6–5.7). The later singular’s final consonant is paradigmatically preserved or restored, not a survival through early final-n loss; the source does not fix the restoration’s date (Campbell 1959, 189, §473).

The root and transmitted prominence are protected. Final long vowels remain for the later component of shortening; this early component is not an extra high-vowel deletion or a morphological condition. The separately traced identifier records implementation ownership, not a new independently dated historical sound change.

The selected oblique *fyrhte* ‘fright’ supplies a final-quantity control. Its inherited **fúrxtīnaz* exposes final **ī* after early ending and final-**n* loss; that vowel remains long here (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87–88, 380–81). Premature shortening makes it a target of SC063 OEHighVowelApocope, wrongly giving †*fyrht*. The later component, not this medial realization, licenses the regular final vowel of *fyrhte*.

The inherited neuter plural **nautīnō* provides the complementary positive dependency: West Saxon *nīetenu* ‘animals, livestock’ requires medial shortening before quantitative deletion (Fulk 2018, 92, §5.6; Sweet 1871, 109, lines 8–11; Goering 2016, 186–88). Shortening produces HLL **nīetinu*, retaining both high vowels; omission wrongly gives †*nīeten*. The selected *lȳtelu* ‘little’ already has a short medial vowel and is unchanged by the same omission. This full inherited

plural protects the dependency without relying on a singular with restored final *n* or inventing another sound law.

5.53 Quantitative high-vowel deletion

5.53.1 Historical discussion

Final and medial short high vowels undergo one quantitative deletion. Campbell, Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk agree that the relevant loss follows mutation, but disagree over trisyllables and surrounding syncope (Campbell 1959, 144–46, §§345–353; Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 264–93, §§6.7.3, 6.8.1; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6). Barrack separately presents final deletion as rule 345 and medial syncope as rule 351, with progressive simplification of the former environment (Barrack 1975, 23–25, 85–87). Those descriptions remain comparative evidence, not proof of one particular prehistoric serialization.

The adopted account follows Fulk's conservative Mercian evidence and Goering's quantitative analysis. A heavy first syllable followed by two light syllables preserves both high vowels: *hēafudu* 'heads', *lȳtelu* 'little' and *īdelu* 'idle'. A heavy following syllable instead licenses medial loss, as in *nētna* 'of livestock'. The distinction is independently motivated by quantity and metrical grouping, not inferred from the selected corpus's match count (Fulk 2010, 129–34, 140–42; Goering 2016, 186–88; 2023, 67–68). Early medial shortening, realized in SC117 OEMedLongShort, gives short medial **i* in the inflected livestock forms while final **ī* remains long in the later compared state **nētīn*. Its final consonant is not an uninterrupted survival through early final-n loss: Campbell attributes it to the inflected forms, without fixing the restoration's precise date (Campbell 1959, 189, §473). Later shortening yields *nēten* 'livestock'; the earlier final-n law does not restart here.

The alternatives remain substantive. Conventional apocope followed by syncope gives **hēafdu*, whereas Ringe and Taylor's syncope-before-apocope account gives **hēafd*, with restored attested plurals attributed to analogy. Hogg also discusses a tentative one-syllable-reduction account (Hogg 2011, 225–27, §§6.22–6.25; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 289–93). Output equivalence on selected words does not erase these contrasting histories.

The conservative neuter plural *lȳtelu* is particularly discriminating. The Vespasian Psalter has *netenu lytelu 7 micel* 'small and great animals', glossing Latin *animalia pusilla et magna*; agreement fixes the neuter plural, while Fulk independently establishes the West Mercian quantity (Sweet 1885, 336, Psalm 103:25; Fulk 2010, 133–34; Goering 2016, 176–77). Orel's comparative **lūtilaz* and the inherited strong neuter plural ending **-ō* support **lūtilō*; Fulk also prints this complete ancestral plural explicitly [Orel (2003), p. 248; Fulk (2018), p. 92, §5.6; p. 209, §9.2]. This selected plural preserves both weak high vowels: indiscriminate heavy-root syncope gives †*lȳtlu*, and final apocope in HLL gives †*lȳtel*. Neither error is exposed by the selected singular *hēafod* 'head'. The comparative root alternation remains unexplained; retention is not a grammatical exception (Kroonen 2013, 339).

The selected West Saxon *nīetenu* 'animals, livestock' supplies a complementary test. The Hatton *Pastoral Care* has plural *nietenu*; Fulk prints the complete ancestral **nautīnō*, and the dialectal comparison distinguishes West Saxon *nīetenu* from Mercian *nētenu* 'animals' (Sweet 1871, 109, lines 8–11; Fulk 2018, 92, §5.6; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–99; Goering 2016, 186). The medial nasal is never final in this plural and needs no restoration or exception. After mutation, early medial shortening makes **nīetinu* HLL: both high vowels survive. Omitting that shortening instead gives †*nīeten*, while the short-medial *lȳtelu* is unaffected. Indiscriminate heavy-root medial deletion gives †*nīetnu*. These independently reconstructed plurals protect different aspects of the quantitative account.

This loss is distinct from West Germanic weak-word deletion in SC098 PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope. The separately selected sentence context remains effective; its boundary annotation is not a segment of the reconstruction (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58). Later light-syllable pre-l loss in SC066 OELAdjacentSyncope, weak-vowel unrounding, and technical stress decoding remain separate operations.

5.53.2 SC063. Quantitative deletion of short unstressed high vowels (OEHighVowelApocope)

```
define OEHighVowelApocope FootCtx([
    [{*i}|{*u}|{*y}|{*ų}] -> 0 ||
        .#. OEAnyConsonant* HvI HvP* _
        [.#. | OEAnyConsonant [HvL | HvS OEAnyConsonant [.#.|OEAnyConsonant]]]
] .o. [{*ᶜ} -> 0]);
```

The auxiliary expressions distinguish short and long nuclei, heavy syllables, the initial quantitative group and following permitted groups. Deletion targets a short unstressed high vowel at a group boundary; a medial target requires a following singleton onset and heavy syllable. The first root and separately transmitted prominence remain protected. The singleton-onset representation bounds this implementation; it is not a general parser for arbitrary historical syllabification.

Mutation must precede loss: *cȳ* ‘cow’ and *brȳd* ‘bride’ require the high vowel to perform its umlautal work. The selected *fȳlþe* ‘filth’ and *spinle* ‘spindle’ retain their independently supported accusative cells; their nonhigh final vowels produce the regular medial deletion. The comparative nominatives **fȳleþu* and **spinnelu* retain their light medial syllables in this account. Their attested alternatives and the genuine comparative gemination problem remain separate from the selected accusatives (Fulk 2010, 140–42; Goering 2016, 186–88; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 289–93).

No special final-u loss after **h* is retained. *Feoh* ‘cattle, wealth’ continues an independently supported, already-endingless a-stem transponent **feh*, not an inherited u-stem forced through an additional deletion (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 177, n. 4).

5.54 Former syncope anchor and comparative evidence

5.54.1 Historical discussion

The conventional heavy/open account discussed below is retained as comparative evidence. The adopted quantitative operation now belongs to SC063 OEHighVowelApocope, which preserves heavy–light–light forms such as *hēafudu* ‘heads’. This former medial component is an identity trace anchor, not a second productive deletion (Fulk 2010, 129–34; Goering 2016, 186–88).

Old English lost unstressed medial high vowels in open syllables after heavy syllables. The handbooks state the law generally, as part of the prehistoric reduction of unstressed vowels: Ringe and Taylor describe a weight-conditioned loss of medial **i* and **u*, and Campbell surveys related later developments. Hogg explicitly distinguishes prehistoric losses from changes after the earliest texts (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 264–67, §6.7.3; Campbell 1959, 157–59, §§388–393; Hogg 1992b, 121; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6). The loss is English, not common West Germanic: the continental cognates cited below keep their medial vowels.

The clearest witnesses are the feminine abstracts in **-iþō*, which uniformly show syncope: *strengþu* ‘strength’, *hǣlþ* ‘health’, *fȳlþ* ‘filth’, *þīefþ* ‘theft’, *wiermþu* ‘warmth’ (Campbell 1959, 236, §589.6; Bammesberger 1990, 117–18, §4.5). The corpus now tests the type through accusative *fȳlþe*, from **fūliþǭ*, a composite of Kroonen’s base **fūla-* with the abstract suffix (Kroonen 2013, 158). The medial vowel survives in Old Saxon fulitha ‘filth’ and in Old High German fülida ‘filth’ (Toller 1921, 276).

The same word fixes a relative chronology. Had syncope preceded i-umlaut (SC055 OEIUmlaut), the deleted **i* could not have fronted the root vowel, and the selected result would have been **fūlþe* rather than attested *fȳlþe*; umlaut must therefore precede this syncope. Campbell derives the endingless nominative singular of these abstracts analogically after the *lār* type (Campbell 1959, 236, §589.6), whereas the former cascade reached the same form through excess apocope. Corrected heavy–light retention no longer licenses that endingless regular nominative. Fulk independently supplies paradigm evidence for analogical syncope in the nominatives of the abstract class (Fulk 2010, 140–42). The selected accusative *fȳlþe* is attested as the object in *Đā fylde ādōn of þām Godes temple*; ordinary feminine accusative inflection supplies **-ǭ*, and its nonhigh

ending avoids the disputed nominative history (Toller 1921, 276, Hml.S25, 378). The earlier selection and the competing accounts remain comparison history, not a second selected cell.

In Barrack's cascade the corresponding territory is covered by his syncope rule 351 (Barrack 1975, 87), with further medial losses at rules 388 and 390, the latter citing *meolc* 'milk' (Barrack 1975, 96); his rules are broader than the dental-conditioned statement formerly used here and are not coextensive with it. Rule 347 concerns final verbal territory, not an equivalent general medial-syncope law (Barrack 1975, 86).

5.54.2 Independent historical stage controls

The regular high-vowel core loses a short unstressed high vowel in an open medial syllable after a heavy syllable. Light-root retention and the earlier light-root contractions must remain distinguished; the latter are not explained away as optionality, grammatical conditioning or unsupported analogy (Brunner 1965, 137–38, §§167–168; Campbell 1959, 145–46, §§348–349; Hogg 2011, 222–25, §§6.18–6.21).

Ringe and Taylor reconstruct pre-Old-English **ūtumist*, then **ȳtymist*, and attested *ȳtmest* 'furthest'. In their proposed history, mutation precedes the loss of the medial high vowel; the final root alone does not establish that ordering, since earlier loss of *u* would leave suffixal *i* as a direct trigger. Skipping that loss, while preserving subsequent unrounding and lowering, gives †*ȳtemest*. That variant is also attested: Ringe and Taylor explicitly analyse it by analogy with *yfemest* and similar forms. It fails the specified regular history to *ȳtmest*, not the entire Old English lexicon (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 267). The transmitted mutation is independently described by Hogg and Campbell; it is not inferred from the need to make this derivation succeed (Hogg 2011, 120–21, §5.76, p. 219, §6.10; Campbell 1959, 80–81, §203).

Hogg's **gaduling* gives *gædeling* 'companion'. Its light first syllable preserves the medial high vowel through syncope; mutation-produced *y* then unrounds and lowers. Unrestricted deletion predicts †*gædling*; omitting weak unrounding leaves †*gædyling*. This supplies an independent later-stage light-root retention control without presuming a new inherited compound (Hogg 2011, 120–21, §5.76, p. 219, §6.10).

The bailiff reconstruction provides a second, strictly stage-level control: **skuldihātijā* becomes **sċyldihǣtjā*, with medial *i* lost in *sċyldhǣta* 'bailiff' (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 267). The syncope component correctly deletes that *i*. Its complete suffix derivation is not certified: subordinate prominence on the long second root is not fully represented, and the current model shortens its vowel. This limitation must not be concealed by substituting a convenient short reconstruction or adding a lexical repair.

The inherited **wiđuwōn* and Old English *widuwe* 'widow' independently corroborate the retained medial vowel (Orel 2003, 462). The selected root-vowel variant *wuduwe* retains that same *u*. Removing the weight restriction predicts †*wudwe*. This is a complete selected negative control for the general high-vowel component, not a complete discriminator of the former early compound-only formulation. Its root-vowel history remains with SC039 OEWICombinativeUUmlaut.

5.54.3 SC065. Former general-syncope trace anchor (`OEMedialSyncope`)

```
define OEMedialSyncope ?*;
```

The preceding consolidation replaced the dental enumeration and the heavy part of SC066 OELAdjacentSyncope with a single conventional general operation. Under that account, short unstressed **i/u/y* disappears after a heavy first syllable when a following singleton consonant and vowel establish an open medial syllable. The retained quantity carrier **ô* is included locally as a following vowel; it was omitted from the shared ordinary-vowel class. This is a bounded onset domain, not a claim to complete historical syllabification of arbitrary clusters. Light-root *wuduwe* 'widow', final-closed *cetel* 'kettle' and *engel* 'angel' environments do not meet the deletion condition.

Earlier controlled experiments found that an unrestricted extension to **u* syncopated *hēafod* ‘head’, dropping the dental restriction destroyed *hierfest* ‘harvest’ and *sċilling* ‘shilling’, and the open-syllable formulation was vacuous after the old excess apocope, while moving it earlier reduced the former *sāwol* ‘soul’ selection. These measurements remain the history of the narrow proxy, not arguments against the corrected general law. Independently selected vocalic accusatives now give *fȳlþe* ‘filth’ and *spinle* ‘spindle’; the corrected apocope also gives conventional *hēafdu* ‘heads’. The adopted quantitative operation likewise requires neither dental nor lateral identity, but does not repeat the conventional heavy/open loss here. Mutation must still precede deletion; syncope feeds the subsequent preconsonantal degemination in *spinle*.

The selected *spinle* ‘spindle’ is the strong feminine accusative **spénnilǭ*, not the former endingless nominative. Clark Hall gives *spinel*, feminine, with genitive *spinle*; Orel reconstructs **spennilō(n)* (Clark Hall 1960, 272; Orel 2003, 364). Toller’s tool enumeration reads *He sceal habban fela towtōla spinle, reól, gearnwindan* (Toller 1921, 288, s.v. gearn-winde, Angl. ix 263, 11). The quantifier *fela* governs genitive *towtōla*; the subsequently enumerated implements are interpreted as objects of *habban*, with singular strong feminine *spinle*. This is a syntactic interpretation of the quotation, not a dictionary’s explicit case label. Ordinary accusative **-ǭ* supplies a complete reconstructed cell. The nominative and the competing syncope-before-apocope history remain comparison evidence rather than another selected derivation.

5.55 Early weak front-vowel unrounding

5.55.1 Historical discussion

Mutation-produced weak **y* unrounds to **i*; retained **i* later lowers to **e*. These are quality changes, not syncope. Hogg places the unrounding at a very early prehistoric stage and illustrates transmitted mutation with **gaduling* > *gædeling* (Hogg 2011, 219, §6.10 and note 1). The early component belongs to the same weak-front-vowel history whose later lowering is SC074 OEMedUnstressedILowering1. Its stable identifier is retained for scholarly cross-references; it no longer implements high-vowel deletion.

5.55.2 SC115. Early weak-front-vowel unrounding component (OEHighLinkSyncope)

```
define OEHighLinkSyncope FootCtx([
    {*y} -> {*i} || EnglishStarVocalic OEAnyConsonant+ _
]);
```

The component excludes initial-root **y* and still-marked subordinate **ẏ*. It is computed after SC065 OEMedialSyncope and before SC066 OELAdjacentSyncope. Unrounding preserves height and commutes with the bounded general high-vowel loss; the serialization does not date unrounding after syncope. The *d/l* protection in the later light component permits *gædeling* ‘companion’ on either side of that component, but this particular comparison does not establish universal commutation.

The separate SC116 OEHighStressDecode helper runs after the light pre-**l* component, not at this unrounding position. It preserves secondary-vowel protection until both deletion components have finished. Neither technical decoding nor this component’s serialized location dates disappearance of historical secondary stress.

5.56 L-adjacent syncope

5.56.1 Historical discussion

Vowel loss creates the clusters upon which later assimilation and degemination operate. Hogg and Ringe and Taylor describe this dependence, while Brunner’s *netle* ‘nettle’ beside later *netele* ‘nettle’ supplies a concrete lexical type (Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 264–96, §§6.7.3–6.8.2; Brunner 1965, 131–33, §§158–159). Fulk places this syncope after i-umlaut (Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6).

The three relations are not equally secure. Lexical evidence orders syncope and degemination; the intervening dental assimilation has no independent ordering witness.

5.56.2 SC066. Later light-syllable pre-**l* syncope (`OELAdjacentSyncope`)

```
define OELAdjacentSyncope Ctx([
    {*i} -> 0 ||
        [EnglishStarShortVowel|EnglishStarShortDiphthong]
        [OEAnyConsonant - [{*d}|{*θ}|{*f}]] _ {*l} EnglishStarVocalic
]);
```

The loss of medial **i* before **l* is late enough to preserve earlier umlaut, as *netle* ‘nettle’ demonstrates.

The former statement combined two historically distinct strata. Its heavy part now belongs to the single quantitative deletion in SC063 OEHighVowelApocope, not an independently productive second syncope. The selected accusative **spénnilǭ* ‘spindle’ and the genitive **θístilas* ‘thistle’ lose their **i* after the heavy sequences *-nn-* and *-st-* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 270–72, §6.7.3; Campbell 1959, 158, §392). The nonhigh, quantity-bearing endings distinguish these selected histories from the HLL nominative comparisons; SC065 OEMedialSyncope remains an identity anchor. After a light syllable, however, the handbooks describe a later and more particular development: unstressed **i* next to *l* is lost even where the preceding syllable is light, as in *netle* ‘nettle’ from the diminutive **nátilōn* ‘nettle’ (Kroonen 2013, 384; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 272, §6.7.4). Luick, following Weyhe, restricts this light-syllable deletion to trisyllabic forms whose middle syllable was open, dating it before the literary period after dentals and to the eighth century after gutturals (Luick 1914–-1940, sect. 336); Brunner likewise treats it as regular in the oldest sources after light syllables (Brunner 1965, 132–33, §159c); Campbell describes medial vowels as dropped after short syllables when a group of consonant plus *l* or *r* would result (Campbell 1959, 157–58, §§388–390).

The open-syllable condition carries the explanatory weight. *Cetel* ‘kettle’, an early Latin loan (**katilaz* ‘kettle’, from *catillus*), famously fails to syncopate (Orel 2003, 211; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 272). It is not a lexical exception. Its nominative **i* stands, after apocope, in a word-final closed syllable with a short nucleus, but heavy by closure — a position the adopted light/open formulation does not reach. The same structural point explains the nominative–oblique split that Campbell records for the *netel*/*spinel* class, where the nominative retains its vowel while the syllabically open oblique cases syncopate (Campbell 1959, 235–36, §589). The current component contains only the later light-syllable loss.

The selected *sċytel* ‘dart’ supplies a complete inherited closed-final control. Orel reconstructs **skutilaz,* beside Old Norse *skutill*; the Corpus Glossary prints *scytel*, with retained medial *e* (Orel 2003, 346–47; Sweet 1885, 79, Corpus 1325). The corresponding Épinal and Erfurt glosses have *scytil.* Their Latin *momentum* denotes the moving beam or lever of a balance, not an unqualified dart or a balance pointer [Pheifer (1974), p. 34, gloss 632; p. 101, commentary 632]. The palatal dot is editorial, and the Corpus form is not relabelled West Saxon. After apocope and mutation, **sċytil* has the closed final syllable *-til.* Its vowel survives this law and later lowers to *e.* Removing the following-vowel restriction from the adopted operation wrongly gives †*sċytl.* This tests the open-medial domain, without forcing an unverified West Saxon spelling of *cetel* into the selected population.

Brunner’s original passage excludes the environments between *d* and *l*, and between inherited Germanic *þ/f* and *l*; the *f* descended from earlier *bh* is explicitly distinguished (Brunner 1965, 132, §159c, §192.2). CAPR excludes the corresponding still-distinct **d/θ/f* segments, not words or grammatical classes. Source-supported **gaduling* > *gædeling* remains a retention control even when mutation-produced weak **y* has already unrounded to **i.*

The sources disagree about the residue of variation. Weyhe, Luick, and Brunner treat the law as categorical within its consonant-class and dialect conditions, explaining late West Saxon *netele* as anaptyxis, a secondary vowel reinserted in the cluster (Luick 1914–-1940, sect. 336; Brunner 1965, 133, §159 Anm. 3). Ringe and Taylor instead read pairs such as *crypel* beside dative *cryple* as

a change arrested before completion, leaving stable variation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 272). The selected positive *netle* does not discriminate between these readings of open-medial variation; both accounts are therefore recorded without a forced choice. The closed-final *sċytel* control protects the distinct open-versus-closed domain of the adopted categorical law.

Barrack reaches the same material through his framework of progressive environment simplification. His rule for medial high-vowel deletion in open syllables after long accented syllables corresponds to the heavy-syllable stratum, and in West Saxon he drops the length condition, generalizing the deletion to light syllables (Barrack 1975, 87). A separate rule deletes an unstressed vowel before a liquid or nasal followed by a vowel, and he reports that West Saxon simplified the environment further by dropping the following-vowel condition entirely (Barrack 1975, 96). The present law retains the following-vowel condition for the light stratum: dropping it, as Barrack's West Saxon formulation would, predicts syncope in the *cetel* nominative. His neighbouring rule deleting a vowel after a liquid, which derives *meolc* 'milk' from **meluk* 'milk' (Barrack 1975, 96), is likewise not adopted: West Saxon *meoloc* retains the vowel, and medial **u* next to *l* is in general kept far longer than **i* (Luick 1914--1940, sect. 336.2; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 273).

In the preserved experiments on the former combined statement, placement before i-umlaut makes PGmc **nátilōn* 'nettle' yield †*nætle* rather than expected OE *netle* 'nettle', and PGmc **spénnilō* 'spindle' yields †*spenl* rather than expected *spinl* 'spindle'. Placed after preconsonantal degemination, PGmc **spénnilō* yields †*spinnl* rather than expected *spinl*. Those earlier experiments remain evidence for the former combined statement. The spindle feeding relation now belongs to quantitative SC063 OEHighVowelApocope, not to this light-only component. The nettle mutation relation remains with SC066 OELAdjacentSyncope; no independent chronology is invented for the intervening dental assimilation.

5.57 Secondary high-vowel annotation decoding

This independently traced support operation decodes retained subordinate high-vowel marks only after their phonological consumers have finished. It is a computational identity, not an additional historical sound change.

5.57.1 SC116. Technical secondary high-marker decoding (OEHighStressDecode)

```
define OEHighStressDecode Ctx([{*ì} -> {*i}, {*ù} -> {*u}, {*ỳ} -> {*y}]);
```

The decoder follows SC066 OELAdjacentSyncope and precedes later weak-vowel lowering. Marked subordinate vowels are protected from SC065 OEMedialSyncope, early weak-vowel unrounding at SC115 OEHighLinkSyncope, and the light-syllable deletion component before these marks are removed. No historical date for obligatory loss of subordinate stress follows from this serialization.

5.58 Dental assimilation

5.58.1 SC067. Dental assimilation in newly formed clusters (OEDentalAssimilation)

```
define OEDentalAssimilation Ctx([
    {*θ} -> 0 || {*t} _
]);
```

Loss of **θ* after **t* resolves a dental cluster produced by syncope (Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 279–96, §§6.7.5, 6.8.2). No witness distinguishes its position: moving dental assimilation across every tested neighbor leaves the outputs unchanged. I nevertheless place it after syncope, which supplies its input, and before the more general cluster simplification described in the handbooks. This order is phonologically motivated, not established by a lexical contrast.

5.59 Preconsonantal degemination

5.59.1 SC068. Preconsonantal degemination before sonorants (OEPreconsonantalDegemination)

```
define OEPreconsonantalDegemination Ctx(OEPreconsonantalDegemTT .o.
 ↪  OEPreconsonantalDegemNN);
```

Preconsonantal **tt* and **nn* simplify only after syncope has created a following sonorant cluster, as in *spinle* ‘spindle’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 279–96, §§6.7.5, 6.8.2).

The historical change is a general one: Ringe and Taylor state simply that geminates were degeminated next to another consonant (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 296, §6.8.2). Barrack describes the same territory twice over, once as a degemination of long consonants after a vowel before another consonant, and once as a late and general simplification of triple clusters in both directions, which he orders after his syncope rules (Barrack 1975, 115, 122). The present law states the narrower slice of this process that the witnesses attest: **tt* before a nasal in *botm* ‘bottom’ and **nn* before *l* in *spinle* ‘spindle’. The two clauses are segmental cases of one change, not two historical developments, and no witness in the corpus licenses the broader formulation.

The two witnesses reach the law by different routes. For *spinle* the geminate cluster exists only because SC065 Medial high-vowel syncope has created it; SC066 Light-syllable syncope before *l* does not delete this heavy-root vowel. For *botm* the cluster **ttm* is already present in the stem. Kroonen reconstructs the word with an inherited geminate, **buttman-* beside **budman-*, deriving OE *botm* directly from the geminated variant (Kroonen 2013, 82). Ringe and Taylor instead derive *botm* from **buþm-* with a later West Saxon development of *þm* to *tm*, while observing that the prehistory of this word cannot be recovered in detail (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 332, 354). The derivation here follows the geminate reconstruction; the alternative route is recorded as an open question of reconstruction selection, not of the sound law itself.

Placed before SC065 Medial high-vowel syncope, the selected accusative **spénnilǭ* ‘spindle’ yields †*spinnle* rather than expected OE *spinle*. Syncope must therefore create the cluster before degemination simplifies it. The earlier nominative comparison **spénnilō* gave †*spinnl* against *spinl* under the former narrower syncope clauses; that comparison does not establish a separate heavy-root *l*-adjacent law. *Botm* does not order the pair, since its cluster does not depend on syncope. Reordering degemination against any tested later change leaves the witness unchanged, so no terminus ante quem is known.

5.60 Early o-shortening

5.60.1 Historical discussion

After the principal palatal and umlautal changes, unstressed vowels undergo shortening, fronting, merger, and sometimes complete loss. Campbell describes the early shortening of unaccented long vowels, while Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk relate it to apocope, syncope, and the later reductions (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–96, §§5.6–5.7).

Early o-shortening has only a distant earlier boundary. The rules that follow, especially SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly and SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, have more closely defined relations.

5.60.2 SC069. Early shortening of unstressed **ō* before nasals (OEEarlyOShortening)

```
define OEEarlyOShortening Ctx([
    # EARLY: *ō → *a before nasals (runs BEFORE fronting)
    # This *a will undergo fronting: *a → *æ → e (Campbell §333, §369)
    {*ō} -> {*a} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ EnglishStarNasal
```

```
]);
```

The rule shortens unstressed long **ō* before a following nasal. Because this shortening happens early, the resulting **a* can still participate in the later fronting and merger that shape many weak final syllables.

Moving the rule before SC023 PNWGmcNStemNLoss, PGmc **nédrōn* ‘adder’ yields †*nædran* rather than expected OE *nædre* ‘adder’, PGmc **érθōn* ‘earth’ yields †*eorþan* rather than expected *eorþe* ‘earth’, and PGmc **fláskōn* ‘flask’ yields †*flascan* rather than expected *flasce* ‘flask’. The same earlier shift also disrupts forms such as *heorte* ‘heart’ and *līne* ‘line’. This broad set of failures requires SC069 OEEarlyOShortening to follow SC023 PNWGmcNStemNLoss.

If the rule is moved later within the tested sequence, no output differs from the expected one. The lexical evidence therefore does not identify a corresponding later constraint. The sources place early **ō*-shortening before the later weak-tail changes without fixing a closer local order.

5.61 Early unstressed fronting

5.61.1 Historical discussion

Campbell distinguishes the shortening of unaccented long vowels, while Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk place fronting and shortening within a later history of syncope and final-vowel adjustment (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–96, §§5.6–5.7). Earlier unstressed fronting precedes later o-shortening.

SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly has both an earlier and a later lexical breakpoint. SC071 OELateOShortening confirms their reciprocal order, but no lexical evidence fixes its later boundary.

5.61.2 SC070. Early fronting of unstressed **a* (OEUnstressedFrontingEarly)

```
define OEUnstressedFrontingEarly FootCtx(OEUnstressedAFronting);
```

The rule fronts unstressed **a* to **æ* after the earlier shortening has created a frontable vowel but before the later shortening of unstressed **ō*. It produces endings such as OE *-en* in *lungen* ‘lungs’.

If the rule is moved before SC052 OEVelarPalatalization, PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields †*lungen* rather than expected OE *lungen* ‘lungs’. If the rule is delayed until after SC071 OELateOShortening, PGmc **búrōθi* ‘bears’ yields †*boreþ* rather than expected OE *boraþ* ‘bears’, and PGmc **mḗnōθz* ‘month’ yields †*mōneþ* rather than expected *mōnaþ* ‘month’. The witness forms require SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly to follow SC052 OEVelarPalatalization and precede SC071 OELateOShortening.

The relation to SC071 OELateOShortening is local. The earlier boundary at SC052 OEVelarPalatalization places fronting after the older palatal developments.

5.62 Late o-shortening

5.62.1 SC071. Later shortening of unstressed **ō* (OELateOShortening)

The following rule handles the later shortening stage.

```
define OELateOShortening Ctx([
    # LATE: *ō → *o elsewhere (runs AFTER fronting; Campbell §355: the late
    # product is "of too late origin to become æ").
    # Stausland Johnsen 2015:28-30: unstressed long vowels shorten regularly in
    # pre-OE AFTER the loss of short unstressed vowels (the *bursti-/*burstīz
    # argument). The shortened vowel is a plain short *o — the ONLY source of
    # unstressed *o at this stage (the earliest OE texts have just two
```

```
    # unstressed back vowels, u and a: Stausland Johnsen 2015:21; classical-OE
    # unstressed o arises only from the later 9th-c. lowering, SC040). Its
    # split — u in medial syllables, a in final syllables — is carried out by
    # OEMedUnstressedORaising (SC099) and OEFinalUnstressedOLowering (SC100)
    # immediately below, replacing the old one-step *ō → *a compression that
    # hard-coded the final-syllable outcome for all positions (van Helten's
    # refuted conditioning aside, medial *ō would have surfaced wrongly as a:
    # **wundade).
    {*ō} -> {*o} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]*
]);
```

The rule shortens the remaining unstressed long **ō* after fronting. The shortened vowel is then resolved by the following medial/final distribution, not directly as *a* (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–31).

Moving the rule before SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly makes PGmc **búrōθi* ‘bears’ yield †*boreþ* rather than expected OE *boraþ* ‘bears’. The contrast requires SC071 OELateOShortening to follow SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly.

5.63 Medial raising of shortened unstressed o

5.63.1 SC099. Medial raising of shortened unstressed **o* (OEMedUnstressedORaising)

```
define OEMedUnstressedORaising Ctx([
    {*o} -> {*u} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]* EnglishStarVocalic
]);
```

After SC071 OELateOShortening, the shortened vowel gives *u* in an unstressed medial syllable. The rule encodes Stausland Johnsen’s statistically supported account of West Saxon ō-verb pasts, not a general rule for inherited short **o* or for nominal morphology (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–31, 36). His diagnostic derivation is PGmc **wúndōdē* ‘wounded’ > †*wundode* > OE wundude ‘wounded’ (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–29).

5.64 Final lowering of shortened unstressed o

5.64.1 SC100. Final lowering of shortened unstressed **o* (OEFinalUnstressedOLowering)

```
define OEFinalUnstressedOLowering Ctx([
    {*o} -> {*a} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]* .#.
]);
```

In a final syllable the same shortened vowel gives *a*. Thus the existing month control continues PGmc **mḗnōθz* ‘month’ through shortened **o* to OE mōnaþ ‘month’, while **wúndōdē* ‘wounded’ takes SC099 OEMedUnstressedORaising instead. The medial/final contrast and its chronology after long-vowel shortening are Stausland Johnsen’s analysis (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–31).

5.65 Unstressed long-vowel shortening

5.65.1 Historical discussion

Campbell describes the shortening of unaccented long vowels, and Ringe and Taylor place the later component among the last prehistoric Old English changes before the merger of unstressed **œ* with **e* (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–96, §§5.6–5.7).

SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening and SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger have a reciprocal ordering relation. SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss supplies the earlier boundary of shortening, and SC085 OEHLoss the later boundary of the merger.

5.65.2 SC072. Shortening of unstressed long vowels (OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening)

```
define OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening FootCtx(OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening1
    .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening2
    .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening3
    .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening5
    .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening6
    .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening7
    .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening8);
```

An earlier medial component is separately realized in SC117 OEMedLongShort, before SC063 OEHighVowelApocope. Goering's contrast between final **nētīn* and medially shortened inflected forms requires that distinction (Goering 2016, 186–88; 2023, 67–68). The rule below shortens the remaining unstressed long vowels before weak final syllables reach their later forms. A small group of lexical witnesses fixes its chronology.

If the rule is moved before SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss, PGmc **fúrxtīnaz* 'fright' yields †*fyrhten* rather than expected OE *fyrhte* 'fright'. If the rule is delayed until after SC073 OEUnstressedAE-Merger, PGmc **nédrōn* 'adder' yields †*nædrœ* rather than expected OE *nædre* 'adder', and PGmc **fádēr* 'father' yields †*fædœr* rather than expected *fæder* 'father'. These outputs require SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening to follow SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss and precede SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger.

The late component therefore follows the earlier weak-tail preparation and immediately precedes the merger. The old fright displacement records loss of the long-i environment in the executable; it does not independently date the early final-n law to this late corridor.

5.66 Unstressed ae-merger

5.66.1 SC073. Merger of unstressed **œ* with **e* (OEUnstressedAEMerger)

The following rule handles the merger stage.

```
define OEUnstressedAEMerger SentenceCtx([
    [{*æ} -> {*e} || .#. {*ᶠ} OEAnyConsonant* _]
    .o. FootCtx(OEWeakTailReduction3)
]);
```

The rule merges unstressed **œ* with **e* after shortening has produced the weak final vowels, yielding the ordinary OE *-e* spellings.

Pretonic vowels also participate. A positively identified weak initial syllable is eligible without the preceding-vowel condition appropriate to post-tonic endings. The superscript `*ᶠ` records this prosodic information, not a segment or a grammatical prefix. Stressed roots are not thereby included in the merger. Later lowering of pretonic **i*, including the early *gi-* of *gistīga* 'climb

into/onto', belongs to SC076 OEPrefixIReduction; Hogg places it marginally after the earlier merger (Campbell 1959, 153–55, §§369–370; Hogg 1992a, sects 6.50–6.54 (held 2011 reprint, pp. 237–239); Ringe and Taylor 2014, 334–35).

The displacement tests expose dependencies of the current cascade. If the rule is moved before SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **nédrōn* 'adder' yields †*nǣdræ* rather than expected OE *nǣdre* 'adder', and PGmc **fádēr* 'father' yields †*fædær* rather than expected *fæder* 'father'. They therefore require shortening before merger in this implementation. If merger is delayed until after SC085 OEHLoss, PGmc **táixōn* 'toe' yields †*tāæ* rather than expected OE *tā* 'toe'. That narrower result establishes the current representation's merger-before-loss dependency, not an independently demonstrated historical order.

Clay makes the distinction important. Corpus 207 *thoae* 'clay', beside Épinal 3 *thohae* 'clay', is read as hiatus *thōæ* 'clay' beside h-bearing *thōhæ* 'clay' (Sweet 1885, 36, 41; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314, §6.9.3). If written *ae* preserves distinct unstressed *æ*, this form instead places loss before merger. If the spelling does not distinguish *æ* from *e* here, it cannot decide their relative order. The spelling question remains open: the current stage trial has *e*, not *æ*, in hiatus, and its successful contraction is not a philological argument for identifying the two. The parallel account under SC085 OEHLoss keeps this conditional historical interpretation separate from the toe displacement.

5.67 Medial weak front-vowel quality changes

5.67.1 Historical discussion

Hogg and Ringe and Taylor treat the late weakening and merger of unstressed vowels as a continuing history (Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 327–32, §§6.9.5–6.9.6). SC074 OEMedUnstressedILowering1 lowers medial unstressed *i*; SC075 OEMedUnstressedILowering preserves *i* before **ng* in words of the *sċilling* 'shilling' type.

Two stages must be distinguished. Mutation-produced weak **y* unrounds to **i*; retained **i* later lowers to **e*. Hogg dates the unrounding to a very early prehistoric stage and gives **gaduling* > *gædeling*, with root mutation transmitted through the weak vowel. Initial-root **y* and still marked subordinate **ỳ* are not weak-vowel applications (Hogg 2011, 219, §6.10 and note 1).

Épinal–Erfurt *scytil* 'balance beam', glossing Latin *momentum*, retains medial unstressed *i*; Corpus *scytel* 'balance beam' has *e* (Pheifer 1974, 34, 101, item 632; Sweet 1885, 79, Corpus 1325; Christiansen 2018, 583, note 3, and pp. 599–600, note 52). After ending loss and the appropriate earlier changes, inherited **skútilaz* retains its *i* in final closed **-til*: SC066 OELAdjacentSyncope does not delete that vowel. It subsequently lowers to *e* under SC074 OEMedUnstressedILowering1, giving normalized *sċytel* 'dart; balance beam'. Pheifer's discussion already recognizes both retained *i* and *e* spellings in the early glossaries and variation attributable to their common exemplar (Pheifer 1974, lxxv, §63). The contrast illustrates retained and lowered vowel qualities, not a precisely dated interval between surviving manuscripts; their exemplars need not have the same dates or orthographic histories. Nor does the Corpus form by itself establish a specifically West Saxon reflex. This medial *i/e* evidence is separate from Christiansen's etymological argument about stressed root *y* against an alleged connection with the *scit-* 'excrement' family (Christiansen 2018, 593–98).

The unrounding component is computed after general high-vowel syncope and before the later light pre-**l* loss. It is separate from both deletion and later lowering. Unrounding preserves vowel height and commutes with the bounded general high-vowel deletion; this adjacency does not prove an unrounding-after-syncope chronology. With the source-supported *d/l* retention condition, *gædeling* 'companion' also survives on either side of the light pre-**l* component. That particular result does not establish universal commutation.

The early component is printed at its actual executable location under SC115 OEHighLinkSyncope, a support component of this vowel-quality history, not a second historical syncope law. The separate technical decoder runs after the light pre-**l* component and before ordinary lowering. It does not turn protected subordinate **ỳ* into an application of weak unrounding.

General lowering precedes the restricted restoration before **ng*. The evidence is narrower than that for SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening and SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger.

5.67.2 SC074. First medial unstressed-*i* lowering (OEMedUnstressedILowering1)

```
define OEMedUnstressedILowering1 FootCtx([
    {*i} -> {*e} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _
]);
```

The rule lowers medial unstressed **i* to **e* after a preceding vocalic syllable. The resulting *e*-outcome is reversed before **ng*.

If the rule is moved before SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **fúrxtīnaz* 'fright' yields †*fyrhti* rather than expected OE *fyrhte* 'fright'. If it is delayed until after SC075 OEMedUnstressedILowering, PGmc **skíllingaz* 'shilling' yields †*sċilleng* rather than expected *sċilling* 'shilling'. The derivations require SC074 OEMedUnstressedILowering1 to follow SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening and precede SC075 OEMedUnstressedILowering.

The evidence is narrow on each side. The rule follows unstressed long-vowel shortening and precedes the more specific **ng* preservation.

5.68 Preservation of i before ng

5.68.1 SC075. Preservation of medial unstressed **i* before **ng* (OEMedUnstressedILowering)

The following rule reverses the lowering before **ng*.

```
define OEMedUnstressedILowering Ctx([
    {*e} -> {*i} || _ {*n} {*g}
]);
```

The rule restores **i* before **ng*, preventing the broader lowering from producing the wrong medial vowel in forms such as *sċilling* 'shilling'.

Moving the rule before SC074 OEMedUnstressedILowering1 makes PGmc **skíllingaz* 'shilling' yield †*sċilleng* rather than expected OE *sċilling* 'shilling'. On this evidence, I take SC075 OEMedUnstressedILowering to follow SC074 OEMedUnstressedILowering1. Moving it later within the tested range creates no equally sharp failure.

5.69 Medial unstressed-u lowering

5.69.1 SC040. Lowering of medial unstressed **u* (OEMedUnstressedULowering)

```
define OEMedUnstressedULowering [MPFoot .o. MPULower .o. MPDecode];
```

Medial unstressed **u* lowers to **o* in the later Old English period, while accented **u* preserves the following unstressed vowel (Campbell 1959, 155–56, §373). This lowering follows the earlier shortening and resolution of unstressed long vowels, rather than preceding that history. The eighth-century unstressed back-vowel system and its later development distinguish the two periods (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 21–22, 28–31).

The inherited ordering evidence from *wuduwe* 'widow' remains relevant: delaying SC039 OEWICombinativeUUmlaut until after lowering yields †*wudowe* rather than the expected form. In the adopted sequence, *wuduwe* retains its medial vowel after accented **u*, whereas *weorold* 'world' undergoes lowering.

5.69.1.1 Medial prominence and the initial foot The retained *u* of *eorþcunde* ‘earthly’ is not an exemption for a suffix or an inflection. Its heavy first syllable is followed by a nonfinal heavy syllable which can head a medial foot. In contrast, an initial light syllable is accommodated with a following syllable, including a heavy one, in the initial foot. These distinct configurations are supported by the quantity-sensitive analyses of McCully and Hogg and Goering (McCully and Hogg 1990, 323–33, especially pp. 330–333; Goering 2023, 79–84, §§4.5.1.1–4.5.2).

The relevant short diphthong **éo* counts as one short nucleus, not as two separate vowels. In the inflected control **wéoruldes*, syllabification gives light **weo*, heavy **rul* and final **des*. The first two belong to the initial light–heavy foot; the medial *u* is not a separate head and lowers. The shorter selected *weorold* has the same initial accommodation. In *eorþ.cun.de*, the initial **eorþ* is heavy and the subsequent nonfinal **cun* is independently heavy: its *u* is protected. The genitive control *eorþcundes* has the same contrast. This explanation depends on the phonological representation at lowering, not on the spelling of a comparative citation form.

The independent comparisons *æþelingas* ‘princes’ versus *cyningas* ‘kings’, and *rīdende* ‘riding’ versus *wesende* ‘being’, test initial-foot accommodation with different vowel classes. Inflected *godcundne* ‘divine’ and *godcundre* ‘divine’ supply medial retention comparisons, not permission to exempt the whole formation (McCully and Hogg 1990, 330–33; Hogg 2011, 49–50, §2.89). Final uninflected *godcund* remains outside this nonfinal medial-foot computation; the complete paradigm is not thereby derived.

5.69.1.2 Temporary computation, not another inherited-accent loss The implementation syllabifies the current string, accommodates the initial foot and marks eligible later closed short-vowel heads. It uses the existing short-vowel and short-diphthong inventories. Temporary graves on *a e i o u* distinguish computed prominence from the inherited compound accent, already removed by inherited secondary-accent deletion. They are decoded immediately after this lowering. The existing pretonic-prefix representation is accommodated without inserting a new initial boundary or relocating inherited accent deletion.

Segmental conditioning is retained: the preceding *u*-class nuclei and following *m* block lowering, with the same consonant classes. A temporarily marked *ù* also belongs to that preceding exclusion; changing its technical marking must not make it license lowering of a subsequent *u*. This is preservation of the original condition, not a new harmony law.

Hogg cautions against using “tertiary stress” merely to rename a desired retention, and distinguishes labial-nasal preservation from ordinary *-un* > *-on* (Hogg 1996, 8–11, especially p. 11 n. 7; Hogg 2011, 239–41, §§6.55–6.58). The computation consequently uses weight and domain rather than lexical identity or a blanket dental-nasal exception. Nor does metrical prominence by itself certify speech-stress history (Minkova and Zhou 2023, 86–90). This is a bounded prosodic projection for the present sound law, not a complete cyclic Old English stress grammar.

5.69.1.3 Existing chronological distinctions *Reġnboga* ‘rainbow’ is not a further live example: its second-root *o* arose while subordinate stress was still represented, under SC017 PNWGmcULowering. Its linking-vowel history therefore does not require secondary-accent loss before the present late lowering.

The reciprocal early-lowering experiment is no longer equivalent: the intervening vowel-resolution history restores medial **u*, so that movement does not now produce the same *widow* failure.

The formerly reported *ġeoguþ* ‘youth’ boundary does not establish that lowering preceded SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening. That experiment inserted a front glide vowel early in the derivation; delayed lowering then encountered an altered preceding nucleus and produced †*ġeogoþ*. With the adopted late SC016 OEWsPalatalGlide spelling, the root retains phonological **u* through lowering and preserves the medial vowel. Moving lowering across shortening in this current architecture leaves *ġeoguþ* unchanged. The spelling evidence is therefore not an independent date for the lowering; the later placement rests on the historical vowel chronology, not a reversal of that obsolete experiment.

5.70 Pretonic i-lowering

5.70.1 Historical discussion

Late weak-tail reduction affects unstressed prefixes as well as inflectional endings and medial vowels. Fulk's discussion of prefix vowels accounts for OE **be-* and **ne-* (Fulk 2018, 97, §5.7). Hogg explicitly includes *be-* and *ge-* in the lowering of unstressed **i*, marginally later than the earlier front-vowel merger. Ringe and Taylor supply early *gistīga* 'climb into/onto' beside later *gestīga* 'climb into/onto', and place *bi-* and *ni* alongside this development (Hogg 1992a, sects 6.50–6.54 (held 2011 reprint, pp. 237–239); Ringe and Taylor 2014, 334–35).

The limited relative chronology follows the handbook reconstruction, not the older proxy's displacement results or a simple count of manuscript spellings. Pheifer reports Épinal *gi-/ge-* as 40/13 and Erfurt as 31/34; both related witnesses already mix the spellings. Their different denominators and transmitted linguistic layers do not independently date a universal merger. The Durham Ritual still writes *gi-* in the tenth century. Different varieties, possible raised allophony and transmitted orthography must be distinguished from successive reconstructed vowels; the accentual status of contested *ġeatwe* 'equipment' cannot supply a secure prefix-specific date either (Pheifer 1974, lxxv, §63; Toller 1921, 284; Stevenson 1840, 7; Hogg 2011, 238–39, §§6.53–6.54; Quinlin 1991, 155–56).

5.70.2 SC076. Pretonic i-lowering (`OEPrefixIReduction`)

```
define OEPrefixIReduction SentenceCtx([
    [{*i} -> {*e} || .#. {*ᶠ} OEAnyConsonant* _]
    .o. [{*ᶠ} -> 0]
]);
```

The rule lowers short **i* in a positively identified weak pretonic syllable, not specifically in morphemes beginning with a particular consonant. Thus the same conditioning treats inherited weak **bi-* and the raised vowel in **gi-*; stressed roots remain outside its domain. The superscript `*ᶠ` is a nonsegmental prosodic annotation, removed once it is no longer needed. The rule therefore produces **e* directly, not a protected intermediate breve-e.

This bounded implementation requires a following headed syllable. The separately unstressed negative particle *ni* 'not' > *ne* 'not' supports the wider history of weak-vowel lowering, but is not made into a newly encoded selected input or a claim that the present pretonic condition covers every weak particle (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 335).

The earlier displacement experiment found no final-output boundary for the old consonant-identity proxy. That negative result is not a test of the reformulated prosodic rule and does not date it. The relative placement after the earlier merger follows the handbook account; its precise interval remains approximate.

5.71 Weak-tail reduction

5.71.1 Historical discussion

Campbell, Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk describe a late history in which apocope, shortening, contraction, and further weak-tail reductions reshape final syllables (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992b, 121; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–91, §5.6). Lexical failures place the remaining weak-tail reduction after unstressed fronting and before contraction.

5.71.2 SC078. Reduction of remaining weak-tail vowels (OEWeakTailReduction)

```
define OEWeakTailReduction OEWeakTailReduction1;
```

The rule reduces the remaining weak-tail vowels, preventing a broad class of *-en* and extra-vowel outcomes.

I place the change after SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly and before SC086 OEContraction. Moving it before SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly, PGmc **bákaną* ‘bake’ yields †*bacen* rather than expected OE *bacan* ‘bake’, and PGmc **bíndaną* ‘bind’ yields †*binden* rather than expected *bindan* ‘bind’, alongside a much wider set of comparable *-en* failures. If the rule is delayed until after SC086 OEContraction, PGmc **fléuxaną* ‘flee’ yields †*flēoan* rather than expected OE *flēon* ‘flee’, and PGmc **sláxaną* ‘slay’ yields †*sleaan* rather than expected *slēan* ‘slay’.

The earlier boundary spans a wide interval and does not establish a close neighboring relation. The later boundary is narrower: SC078 OEWeakTailReduction precedes SC086 OEContraction.

5.72 J-loss after heavy syllables

5.72.1 Historical discussion

After SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy removes **j* in heavy environments, forms such as *lungen* ‘lungs’ acquire a final geminate. SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification then removes the second nasal.

SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy has a broad earlier boundary at SC055 OEIUmlaut. SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification is fixed only by the final *nn* outcome in the following derivation.

5.72.2 SC079. Loss of **j* after heavy syllables (`OEJLossAfterHeavy`)

```
define OEJLossAfterHeavy [
    {*j} -> 0 || (EnglishStarLongVowel | EnglishStarDiphthong)
     ↪  [EnglishStarConsonantNoR | EnglishPalatalConsonant] _,
    {*j} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant] [EnglishStarConsonantNoR |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant] _
];
```

The rule removes **j* after the relevant heavy-syllable configurations, after the earlier umlaut-sensitive vocalism has developed. The affected glide is **j*.

If the rule is moved before SC055 OEIUmlaut, PGmc **galáubijaną* ‘believe’ yields †*ġelēafan* rather than expected OE *ġelīefan* ‘believe’, PGmc **báugijaną* ‘bow’ yields †*bēaġan* rather than expected *bīeġan* ‘bow’, and PGmc **fúlgijaną* ‘follow’ yields †*fulġan* rather than expected *fylġan* ‘follow’. If it is delayed until after SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification, PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields †*lungenn* rather than expected OE *lungen* ‘lungs’. I accordingly take SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy to follow SC055 OEIUmlaut and precede SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification.

The earlier boundary is broad, but the relation to final geminate simplification is local.

5.73 Final geminate simplification

5.73.1 SC080. Simplification of final geminates (OEFinalGeminateSimplification)

The following rule handles the final simplification directly.

```
define OEFinalGeminateSimplification [
    {*n} -> 0 || {*n} _ .#.
];
```

The rule removes the extra final nasal in forms where the preceding derivation has already created a final geminate.

Moving the rule before SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy makes PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yield †*lungenn* rather than expected OE *lungen* ‘lungs’. These failures require SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification to follow SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy. Moving it later within the tested range before SC087 OERMetathesis creates no new failure.

5.74 J-strengthening after front diphthongs

5.74.1 Historical discussion

SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong preserves a consonantal outcome after front diphthongs. SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization then normalizes part of the inherited intervocalic **j* domain, and SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction removes the resulting *ei*-like sequence in weak verbal endings.

The output of each rule conditions the next. SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization has local lexical evidence on both sides; SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong has a distant earlier boundary, and SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction has no tested later boundary.

5.74.2 SC081. Strengthening of **j* after front diphthongs (OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong)

```
define OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong [
    {*j} -> {*ʒ} || [{*ēa}|{*ǽa}|{*íe}|{*īe}|{*éa}] _ EnglishStarVocalic
];
```

After the relevant front diphthongs, **j* first strengthened to a consonantal outcome; otherwise it would have vocalized too early.

If the rule is moved before SC055 OEIUmlaut, PGmc **stráwjanǫ* ‘strew’ yields †*strēaġan* rather than expected OE *strīeġan* ‘strew’. If it is delayed until after SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization, the same PGmc form yields †*strīeian* rather than *strīeġan*. The order test requires SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong to follow SC055 OEIUmlaut and precede SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization.

The earlier constraint reaches back to SC055 OEIUmlaut and therefore defines a wide interval. The *strīeġan* ‘strew’ derivation fixes the local relation to SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization.

5.75 Intervocalic j-vocalization

5.75.1 SC082. Bounded inherited-j normalization (OEIntervocalicJVocalization)

```
define OEIntervocalicJVocalization [
    {*j} -> {*i} ||
        [EnglishStarVocalic - [{*æ}|{*ē}|{*ǽ}]] _ EnglishStarVocalic
];
```

The former unrestricted VjV matcher wrongly gave model-only †*cǣie* instead of *cǣġe* ‘key’. Hogg’s pre-OE **kǣjæ* retains the glide (Hogg 1979, 105). The bounded rule therefore excludes preceding non-high long front monophthongs.

This is not a generic physical vocalization law. Hogg distinguishes high-vowel coalescence from spellings that merely represent a consonantal glide and from unstressed alternations (Hogg 2011, 283–86, §§7.69–7.76). The remaining weak-suffix e+j to e+i to i path telescopes later raising/contraction, rather than asserting that its e+i intermediate is a source reconstruction (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 228). SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction consumes that modeled sequence. The full residual proxy domain is not claimed to be one independently established historical event.

The separately represented fricative ȷ passes through this zone without being treated as inherited j. Its later merger belongs to SC109 OEPalatalFricativeMerger.

Moving the rule before SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong makes PGmc **stráwjaną* ‘strew’ yield †*strīeian* rather than expected OE *strīeġan* ‘strew’. Delaying it until after SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction makes PGmc **búrōjaną* ‘bore’ yield †*boreian* rather than expected OE *borian* ‘bore’, PGmc **xándlōjaną* ‘handle’ yield †*handleian* rather than expected *handlian* ‘handle’, and PGmc **mákōjaną* ‘make’ yield †*maceian* rather than expected *macian* ‘make’. The witness forms require SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization to follow SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong and precede SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction.

SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization is therefore ordered between strengthening and contraction.

5.76 Unstressed ei-contraction

5.76.1 SC083. Contraction of unstressed *ei* (`OEUnstressedEIContraction`)

The final rule removes the extra unstressed *e* before *i*.

```
define OEUnstressedEIContraction [
    {*e} -> 0 || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
     ↪  EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ {*i}
];
```

The rule contracts the unstressed *ei*-like sequence that the preceding vocalization would otherwise leave behind in forms such as *borian* ‘bore’ and *liccian* ‘lick’.

Moving the rule before SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization makes PGmc **búrōjaną* ‘bore’ yield †*boreian* rather than expected OE *borian* ‘bore’, and PGmc **líkkōjaną* ‘lick’ yield †*licceian* rather than expected *liccian* ‘lick’. The contrast requires SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction to follow SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization. Moving it later within the tested range before SC087 OERMetathesis creates no new failure.

5.77 Intervocalic h-loss

5.77.1 Historical discussion

When SC085 OEHLoss removes intervocalic **h*, it creates hiatus. SC086 OEContraction is the next operation in the executable cascade, but loss and contraction are distinguishable historical developments: the glossaries preserve forms still in hiatus.

Ringe and Taylor describe this late sequence of *h*-loss and contraction (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 305–14, §§6.9.1–6.9.3). Fulk places the contracted verbs in a broader Germanic context (Fulk 2018, 270, §12.21), and Luick describes the corresponding West Germanic contractions (Luick 1914--1940, 165).

For clay, Épinal 3 has *thohae* ‘clay’ under Latin argillus (-a), while Corpus 207 has *thoae* ‘clay’ under argilla (Sweet 1885, 36, 41). Ringe and Taylor read these as *thōhæ* ‘clay’ and *thōæ* ‘clay’, followed by contracted *þō* ‘clay’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314, §6.9.3). On that reading a front ending was already present with the fricative; loss then left the vowels in hiatus, before contraction.

Fringe supplies the contrasting environment. Épinal 1066 and the aligned Erfurt parallel have *uulohum* ‘fringe’, whereas Corpus 2122 has *uuloum* ‘fringe’, all under Latin villis (Sweet 1885, 104, 107). The normalized dative plural *wlōhum* ‘fringe’ thus gives *wlōum* ‘fringe’: both flanking vowels are back, and both the vowel and consonant of the ending *-um* survive loss. A front vowel was therefore unnecessary for intervocalic loss (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314, §6.9.3).

These related early Mercian glossary witnesses preserve different states of the forms. Their textual relationship permits comparison without assigning absolute dates to the changes from the dates of the surviving copies. Nor does written *h* by itself settle the fricative’s phonetic value: CAPR’s assignment of [ç] before a following front vowel at palatalization is a model analysis, not a transcription of that letter.

In the current stage trial for *þō* ‘clay’, the early final-vowel merger and subsequent fronting supply *ǣ* before palatalization, where CAPR assigns [ç]. Shortening and merger then supply *e*

while the fricative is still present; loss leaves *ō* + *e*, and contraction produces the contracted form. This verifies the front-ending/fricative/hiatus sequence without equating the trial's *e* with the glossary spelling *ae*. The historical interpretation of that distinction is discussed with SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger.

5.77.2 SC085. Loss of intervocalic **h* (`OEHLoss`)

```
define OEHLoss FootCtx([
    [{*x}|{*ç}] -> 0 || EnglishStarVocalic _ EnglishStarVocalic
]);
```

The rule removes singleton intervocalic **h* in either model allophone. It must not depend on a front neighbour: *wlōhum* 'fringe' loses the fricative between back vowels while retaining *-um*. Geminates do not meet the singleton environment. The existing foot wrapper protects pretonic material: Campbell explicitly retains intervocalic *h* between an unaccented and an accented vowel in *behindan* 'behind', *behealdan* 'hold', *gehelpan* 'help' and *toheald* 'inclined' (Campbell 1959, 186–87, §§461, 464–465). Thus the prosodic guard has independent support; it is not a lexical exception introduced to protect matching outputs. Contraction can subsequently resolve the hiatus, but the hiatus is itself attested.

If the rule is moved before SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger, PGmc **táixōn* 'toe' yields †*tāæ* rather than expected OE *tā* 'toe'. This establishes a dependency of the current merger and contraction implementations, not independent historical proof that merger preceded loss. If Corpus *thoae* 'clay' preserves distinct unstressed *æ*, the clay witness instead puts loss before merger in that form. Whether this spelling distinguishes *æ* from *e* remains open; a successful contracted endpoint cannot decide it.

If loss is delayed until after SC086 OEContraction, PGmc **fléuxaną* 'flee' yields †*flēoan* rather than expected OE *flēon* 'flee', PGmc **sláxaną* 'slay' yields †*sleaan* rather than expected *slēan* 'slay', PGmc **téxun* 'draw' yields †*teoon* rather than expected *tēon* 'draw', and PGmc **táixōn* 'toe' yields †*tāe* rather than expected *tā* 'toe'. These outputs require loss before contraction in the current cascade. The four displacement witnesses agree with the glossary evidence for that sequence; neither their executable adjacency nor the copy dates establish an immediate historical succession.

5.78 Contraction after h-loss

5.78.1 SC086. Contraction of the resulting hiatus (`OEContraction`)

The following rule contracts the hiatus left by SC085 OEHLoss.

```
define OEContraction [
    {*a} {*a} -> {*ā},
    {*e} {*e} -> {*ē},
    {*i} {*i} -> {*ī},
    {*o} {*o} -> {*ō},
    {*u} {*u} -> {*ū},
    {*ea} {*a} -> {*ēa},
    {*ēa} {*a} -> {*ēa},
    {*eo} {*a} -> {*ēo},
    {*ēo} {*a} -> {*ēo},
    {*eo} {*o} -> {*ēo},
    {*ēo} {*o} -> {*ēo},
    {*éo} {*o} -> {*éo},
    {*éo} {*o} -> {*éo},
    {*ā} {*a} -> {*ā},
    {*ā} {*e} -> {*ā},
    {*ē} {*a} -> {*ē},
    {*ē} {*e} -> {*ē},
    {*é} {*a} -> {*é},
```

```
    {*é} {*e} -> {*é},
    {*ī} {*a} -> {*ī},
    {*ī} {*e} -> {*ī},
    {*ǽ} {*a} -> {*ǽ},
    {*ǽ} {*e} -> {*ǽ},
    {*ō} {*a} -> {*ō},
    {*ō} {*e} -> {*ō},
    {*ū} {*a} -> {*ū},
    {*ū} {*e} -> {*ū}
];
```

The rule contracts the vowel sequences created after *h*-loss, producing *flēon* ‘flee’, *slēan* ‘slay’, and *tēon* ‘draw’.

Clay exposes the separate states. Épinal 3 *thohae* ‘clay’ and Corpus 207 *thoae* ‘clay’ are the diplomatic spellings (Sweet 1885, 36, 41). Ringe and Taylor’s normalized *thōhæ* ‘clay’ passes through attested hiatus *thōæ* ‘clay’ before contracted *þō* ‘clay’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314, §6.9.3). The front ending is present before loss; contraction follows the hiatus state, rather than being inseparable from the disappearance of the fricative. In the current executable trial, the hiatus vowels are *ō* + *e*, and this rule contracts them to the long back vowel. This models the sequence, not a proof that written *ae* equals unstressed *e*; see SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger.

The dative plural *wlōum* ‘fringe’ is an attested hiatus comparison, discussed with its h-bearing counterpart under SC085 OEHLoss. Ringe and Taylor’s contracted **wlōm* ‘fringe’ is reconstructed, not an attested endpoint in the cited texts (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314, §6.9.3). The evidence to preserve here is the hiatus with both segments of *-um* retained, not an additional contraction target.

Moving contraction before SC085 OEHLoss makes PGmc **fléuxanǫ* ‘flee’ yield †*flēoan* rather than expected OE *flēon* ‘flee’, PGmc **sláxanǫ* ‘slay’ yield †*sleaan* rather than expected *slēan* ‘slay’, PGmc **téxun* ‘draw’ yield †*teoon* rather than expected *tēon* ‘draw’, and PGmc **táixōn* ‘toe’ yield †*tāe* rather than expected *tā* ‘toe’. The derivations require SC086 OEContraction to follow SC085 OEHLoss. Moving it later within the tested range before SC087 OERMetathesis creates no new failure. The more distant SC078 OEWeakTailReduction relation establishes only that weak-tail reduction precedes contraction.

5.79 R-metathesis

5.79.1 Historical discussion

Sievers-Brunner describes r-metathesis in forms such as *berstan* ‘burst’, *forst* ‘frost’, and *cærse* ‘cress’ (Brunner 1965, 146–47, §179). Luick likewise treats it as a later rearrangement whose interaction with breaking remains variable (Luick 1914--1940, 201).

For the selected West Saxon *berstan*, the evidence places breaking before metathesis; this is not a chronology for every dialectal metathesis. It does not establish an ordering relation between SC086 OEContraction and SC087 OERMetathesis.

Barrack devotes his longest metathesis discussion to this change as rule 459.1, whose feature matrix moves **r* across a short vowel before *s* or *n* and whose worked examples include the *cyrps* and *-firiþ*/*-ferþ* types; a companion rule 459.3 treats the regressive movement of *r* back across an accented short vowel before *ht*, as in late West Saxon *worhte* beside *wrohte* (Barrack 1975, 115–18). His account agrees that in West Saxon the *beornan*/*birnan* ‘to burn’ family shows metathesis operating on the output of earlier developments, which he schematizes as 157 followed by 170a followed by 459.1; but he records that the relative order of breaking and metathesis varies by dialect, separating the West Saxon from the Anglian treatment (Barrack 1975, 115–17). Because his orderings are formal rather than chronological (Barrack 1975, 34), that dialect-order observation is conditioning evidence to be weighed in its own right, not a dating, and does not alter the West Saxon ordering adopted here.

Barrack describes generalized environments of 459.1 as “a late stage of free variation” (Barrack

1975, 116), while grading the evidence for 459.3 as meagre (Barrack 1975, 118). These are descriptions of the distribution of forms, not an explanation by optional sound change. Campbell records byforms such as *forst* beside *frost*, *gœrs* ‘grass’ beside *græs*, *cerse* beside *cresse*, and *rinnan* beside *iernan*, *eornan* (Campbell 1959, 184, §459). Regular sound change remains exceptionless within its phonological, chronological and dialectal domain. Distinct dialect histories, transmission of earlier and later forms, borrowing or independently evidenced analogy could account for coexistence; the byforms alone do not decide among them.

The categorical operation below correctly handles the selected *berstan* and *forst*. Controlled comparisons extending only the vowel inventory to include **œ* and **y*, while retaining *st*, alter no selected output. With that same inventory, removing the *t* requirement changes *græs* ‘grass’ to attested *gœrs*. Thus the selected forms discriminate these implementations, although neither spelling establishes which conditioning was historically productive. The earlier zero-difference comparison before *s* versus *st* depended on an enumeration excluding **œ*. A further extension to nasal environments also alters selected *brandes* ‘firebrand (gen.)’, *drenċ* ‘drink’ and *strenġ* ‘string’; a regressive pre-*ht* operation changes selected *fyrhte* ‘fright’. These are reasons not to adopt those operations unchanged across the present selections, not proof that broader regular metathesis was historically impossible.

The cress family supplies independent evidence beyond *st*: Campbell and Hogg describe *cresse* through reconstructed **cersse* to *cerse*, with simplification of the geminate (Campbell 1959, 190, §476; Hogg 2011, 288, §7.80). Ringe and Taylor give *cœrse* from reconstructed **crœsse* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 263). Campbell’s Middle English *kers* evidence also places the metathesis after assibilation (Campbell 1959, 184, §459 n. 1). These forms merit discussion even without selecting a new corpus target: their inherited stem and exact attested cell and dialect must be established separately. The retained operation represents the changes presently required by the selected forms; it does not delimit the whole historical phenomenon.

5.79.2 SC087. Metathesis of **r* with a following short vowel (OERMetathesis)

```
define OERMetathesis [
    {*r} {*e} -> {*e} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},
    {*r} {*u} -> {*u} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},
    {*r} {*i} -> {*i} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},
    {*r} {*o} -> {*o} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},
    {*r} {*a} -> {*a} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},
    {*r} {*é} -> {*é} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},
    {*r} {*ó} -> {*ó} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},
    {*r} {*á} -> {*á} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t}
];
```

The rule moves **r* across a following short vowel in the relevant late clusters, producing forms such as *berstan* ‘burst’ where an earlier order would still show a broken vowel sequence.

Moving the rule before SC044 OEBreaking makes PGmc **bréstaną* ‘burst’ yield †*beorstan* rather than expected OE *berstan* ‘burst’. On this evidence, I take SC087 OERMetathesis to follow SC044 OEBreaking. Moving it later within the tested sequence alters no output.

The lexical evidence fixes the earlier relation but does not identify a corresponding later constraint. For the selected West Saxon history, the sources support a late rearrangement after breaking without placing it immediately beside contraction.

5.80 Late unstressed suffix raising

5.80.1 Historical discussion

The late history of unstressed **-ag-* differs from prehistoric i-mutation. Ringe and Taylor give the sequence through fronting and raising to *-ig-*, explicitly placing its final stage long after mutation.

Their examples include *hunigġ* ‘honey’; a velar intermediate can survive before a back vowel (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 334–35, §6.9.6). These are the printed pages, not the PDF sheet labels.

5.80.2 SC089. Late suffix consumer (`OELateUnstressedAgSuffix`)

```
define OELateUnstressedAgSuffix (
    [{*a} -> {*e} ||
        EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _
         ↪  {*g}]
    .o.
    [{*g} -> {*ȷ} ||
        EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ {*e}
         ↪  _ .#.]
    .o.
    [{*e} -> {*i} ||
        EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _
         ↪  [{*ȷ}|{*ʤ}]]
);
```

The singleton consonant is a palatal fricative, not an early affricate (Fulk 2018, 130–32). The raising consumer therefore recognizes ȷ alongside retained stop-reflex compatibility. This does not make ȷ a prehistoric mutation trigger: later raising and earlier i-mutation have different conditioning histories.

The present late applications are *hunigġ* ‘honey’ and *wīþigġ* ‘withy’. The word-final guard remains narrow; this implementation is not an exhaustive model of every inflected suffix form. SC109 OEPalatalFricativeMerger follows here as a disclosed serialization, not proof of a uniquely dated historical merger immediately after this raising (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 204, pp. 334–335).

5.81 Technical support: postmutation fricative merger

5.81.1 SC109. Postmutation merger serialization (OEPalatalFricativeMerger)

```
define OEPalatalFricativeMerger [
    {*ȷ} -> {*j}
];
```

The historical commitment is merger after mutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 204). Its execution after SC089 OELateUnstressedAgSuffix is a computational holding zone, not proof of an exact historical date. It keeps the fricative out of inherited-j normalization while preserving late palatal raising, syllable weight, reduction and native rendering. SC057 OEJClusterCoalescence remains a different cluster process. Stop affrication dates and the precise disputed eligibility domain are not settled by this merger.

6 Chapter 5. Old English orthography and the written surface

6.1 Historical interval

This short chapter stands apart from the derivational chapters that precede it. The earlier chapters primarily discuss changes to the spoken language, alongside explicitly identified technical support operations. The material treated here belongs instead to the written surface of Old English — scribal conventions that determined how the results of the completed phonological history were committed to parchment.

In the executable model these conventions apply after every phonological rule, in the final written-surface block. That serialization renders the results of the phonological reconstruction; it does not independently date the origin of each spelling practice relative to every phonological change.

6.2 Scope

The one rule treated here is the West Saxon palatal-glide spelling (SC016), by which back vowels following word-initial [j] — spelled *g* — came to be written with a preceding front glide letter, as in *geoc* 'yoke' for spoken [jok] and *geoguþ* 'youth' for a form whose root vowel remained [u]. Ringe and Taylor state the modern assessment directly: the *eo* of *geoc* is a spelling convention, and the word was pronounced [jok] (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 5). Hogg reaches the same verdict for the back-vowel cases generally (Hogg 1992b, 113). The older handbooks — Campbell, Brunner, Bülbring, Luick — analysed the same spellings as rising diphthongs; the section below presents both views (Campbell 1959, 17, § 44; Brunner 1965, 64–65, § 92).

6.3 Sources

Ringe and Taylor provide the modern phonological interpretation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 5). Campbell (Campbell 1959, 17, 64–67, §§ 44, 170–176), Brunner (Brunner 1965, 64–65, § 92), and Bülbring (Bülbring 1902, 120, §§ 298–299) document the distribution of the spellings; Hogg supplies the critical reassessment (Hogg 1992b, 113).

Barrack's West Saxon cascade registers the same written-surface facts at two points: the *iung*/*giong*/*geong* 'young' spellings under his rule 171b (Barrack 1975, 58), and an Early West Saxon spelling variation, with *Geoworpa* and *Iugurtha* among the cited forms, as a Campbell-footnote rule 430n3 (Barrack 1975, 110). He treats these within his free-variation framework rather than as a single orthographic convention; that framing is a rival description of the same evidence, not support for a spoken rising diphthong.

6.4 West Saxon palatal-glide spelling before back vowels

6.4.1 Historical discussion

West Saxon spellings such as *ġeoc* 'yoke', *ġeong* 'young', and *ġeoguþ* 'youth' write a front glide letter between a word-initial palatal and a following back vowel. Campbell describes the phenomenon as the development of rising diphthongs when "palatal glides developed before back vowels" and cites *ġeoc* directly (Campbell 1959, 17, §44); Brunner separates the *u*-cases (*ġeong*, *ġeoguþ*) from the *o*-cases (*ġioc* 'yoke', *ġeoc*) (Brunner 1965, 64–65, §92.1); Bülbring likewise treats *iuguð* 'youth' and *iuc* under *ju* but derives *ġioc*, *ġeoc* from West Germanic **jok* (Bülbring 1902, 120, §§298–299); and Luick groups all of these under his "schwebende Diphthonge" after palatal onsets (Luick 1914--1940, 158–59, §169).

The phonological interpretation of these spellings is disputed. The older handbook tradition — Campbell, Brunner, Bülbring, Luick — reads them as genuine rising diphthongs. The modern assessment is orthographic: Ringe and Taylor state flatly that *ġeoc* "is /jok/", the digraph being a spelling convention that became universal after word-initial /j/ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 5), and Hogg concludes that the back-vowel cases were "never anything more than an orthographic variation", judging Campbell's arguments to the contrary "insubstantial" (Hogg 1992b, 113; Campbell

1959, 66–67, §176). This model follows Ringe and Taylor and Hogg: the rule is a spelling convention applied to the finished phonology, and it therefore stands at the end of the derivation, in the written-surface stage of the cascade.

Its position also settles a relative chronology. The *o* of *ġeoc* 'yoke' is itself the product of Northwest Germanic u-lowering (SC017 PNWGmcULowering): Fulk lists *ġeoc* as a regular lowering example beside OIcel *ok* and OHG *joh* (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3), and Campbell gives *ġeoc* among the regular *u* > *o* words (Campbell 1959, 43, §115). The lowering therefore feeds the spelling: first **juk-* became **jok-* in Northwest Germanic, and only much later did West Saxon scribes write the result as *ġeoc*. Where lowering did not apply, as in *ġeoguþ* 'youth', whose root *u* was protected by the high vowel of the following syllable, the same convention wrote the retained *u* with the same digraph (Brunner 1965, 64–65, §92.1).

Barrack registers the same spellings at two points of his cascade: the *iung*/*giong*/*geong* 'young' alternation under his rule 171b (Barrack 1975, 58), and an Early West Saxon variation, with *Geoworpa* and *Iugurtha* among the cited forms, as the Campbell-footnote rule 430n3 (Barrack 1975, 110). Writing before Hogg's reassessment, he handles the alternation inside his free-variation framework rather than as a convention of the written surface (Barrack 1975, 21–23); his treatment is thus a formal restatement of the older rising-diphthong reading, and the orthographic interpretation adopted here follows Ringe and Taylor and Hogg against it.

6.4.2 SC016. West Saxon palatal-glide spelling before back vowels (OEWsPalatalGlide)

```
define OEWsPalatalGlide [
    {*ó} -> {*éo} || .#. ġ _ ,
    {*ú} -> {*éo} || .#. ġ _ ,
    {*o} -> {*eo} || .#. ġ _ ,
    {*u} -> {*eo} || .#. ġ _
];
```

The rule rewrites a back vowel after word-initial *ġ* as the digraph spelling, covering both the lowered *o*-cases (*ġeoc* 'yoke') and the retained *u*-cases (*ġeoguþ* 'youth'). Because it is a convention of the written language, it applies after every phonological change; in particular it follows SC017 PNWGmcULowering, which supplies the *o* of *ġeoc*. If the spelling rule were placed before u-lowering, the derivation would have to treat an Old English scribal practice as a Northwest Germanic sound change, an ordering that no source supports. The witnesses *ġeoc* and *ġeoguþ* between them fix both faces of the rule: one shows the convention applied to lowered *o*, the other to unlowered *u*. The handbook domain is broader (it also includes *a*/*ā*/*ō* contexts after word-initial palatals), but this executable rule is intentionally complete for the currently selected corpus witnesses rather than a maximal dialectal enumeration.

7 References

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